TEDDY ROOK BOOK · VOCABULARY LADDER

# 1,000 Words, Pictured

## Volume 1 of 4 · Topics 1–25

Each card gives a word, how to say it (the capital letters are stressed), its meaning, a memory hook with a picture, an example and its Greek or Latin parts. To learn a word: say the hook out loud, picture the scene, then cover the card and try to recall the meaning. Come back to it tomorrow and again next week.


1. Good and Bad: bene- and mal-
2. Kind and Cruel
3. Polite and Rude
4. Saying More or Less
5. Happy
6. Evidence and Proof
7. Fleeting and Lasting
8. Making Things Better
9. Agreeing and Disagreeing
10. Plenty and Scarcity
11. Belief, Trust and Truth: cred, fid and ver
12. Honest and Dishonest
13. Eager and Reluctant
14. Words of Praise
15. Sad
16. Belief and Doubt
17. Changeable
18. Making Things Worse
19. Laws and Rules
20. Ordinary and Overused
21. Looking and Seeing: spec and vid
22. Brave and Fearful
23. Strict and Lenient
24. Words of Blame
25. Angry and Hateful


Free at teddyrookbook.com/vocabulary/, with flashcards, quizzes and practice.

## benevolent buh-**NEV**-uh-lunt *adjective*




**MEANING** kind and wishing good for others

**MEMORY HOOK** **BEN VOLunteers.** Every Saturday, Ben volunteers at the bread table; a man who gives his time to help others is **benevolent**.

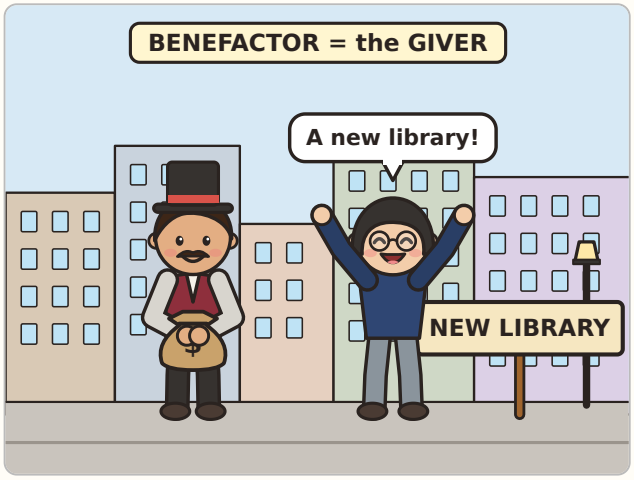
*The **benevolent** neighbor shoveled every driveway on the street after the storm.*

**PARTS** **bene** well + **vol** wish, will + **-ent** being or doing (an adjective ending)

**SIMILAR** kind, charitable, generous, kindly
**OPPOSITE** malevolent, cruel, spiteful



## benefactor **BEN**-uh-fak-ter *noun*




**MEANING** a person who gives money or help to a person or cause

**MEMORY HOOK** **the owner of the BENEFIT FACTORY.** Picture a factory that makes good things for other people: its owner, the **benefactor**, is the one who gives.

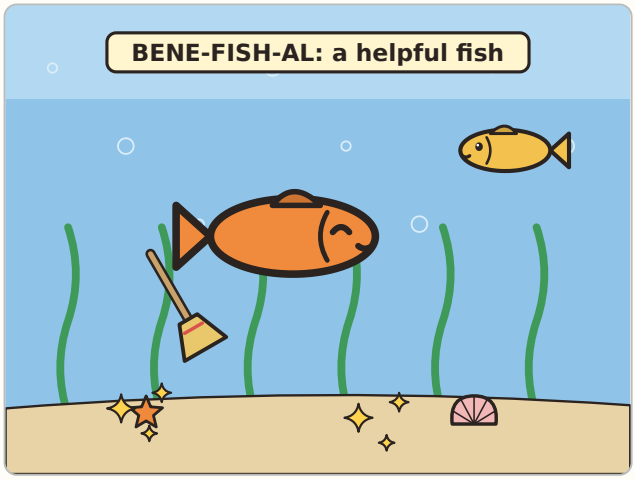
*An unnamed **benefactor** paid for the new playground.*

**PARTS** **bene** well + **fact** do, make + **-or** one who

**SIMILAR** patron, donor, supporter, sponsor
**OPPOSITE** beneficiary, recipient



## beneficial ben-uh-**FISH**-ul *adjective*




**MEANING** helpful; producing good results

**MEMORY HOOK** **a BENE-FISH-al fish.** A fish that sweeps the sea floor clean helps every creature around it; its work is **beneficial**.

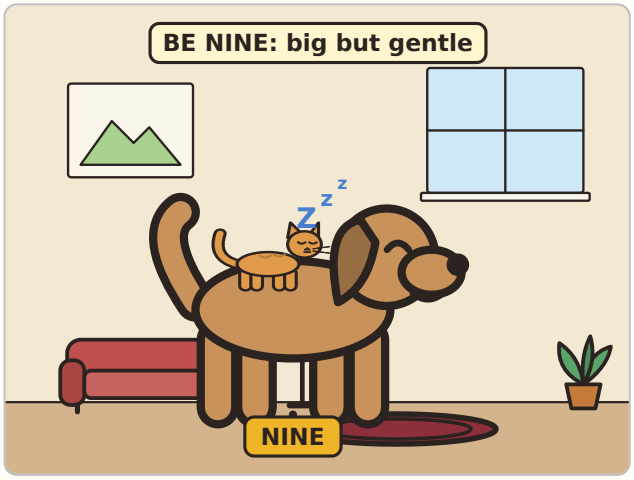
*Reading aloud every evening proved **beneficial** to her spelling.*

**PARTS** **bene** well + **fic** do, make + **-ial** having to do with (an adjective ending)

**SIMILAR** helpful, useful, advantageous, valuable
**OPPOSITE** harmful, detrimental, damaging



## benign bih-**NINE** *adjective*




**MEANING** gentle and kind; also, not harmful

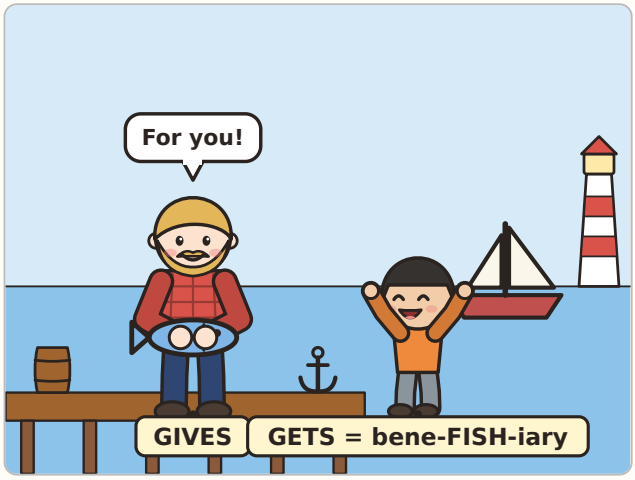
**MEMORY HOOK** **BE NINE: a big dog named Nine.** The family dog, Nine, is huge, but he is **benign**: he lets the kitten nap on his back.

*Despite his size, the farm's old horse was **benign** and let the children brush his mane.*

**PARTS** **bene** well

**SIMILAR** gentle, harmless, kindly, mild
**OPPOSITE** malignant, harmful, hostile

## beneficiary ben-uh-**FISH**-ee-er-ee *noun*




**MEANING** a person who receives a benefit, such as money left in a will

**MEMORY HOOK** **the one who gets the FISH.** The fisherman gives; the boy who gets the fish is the bene-FISH-iary. The **beneficiary** is the one who receives.

*Lila was the* **beneficiary** *of her grandfather's garden and all his tools.*

**PARTS** **bene** well + **fic** do, make + **-iary** one connected with

**SIMILAR** recipient, receiver, heir

**OPPOSITE** benefactor, donor, giver



## malevolent muh-**LEV**-uh-lunt *adjective*




**MEANING** wishing harm to others

**MEMORY HOOK** **MALL EVIL.** An evil villain sneaks through the mall wishing bad luck on every shopper: he is **malevolent**.

*In the old story, a* **malevolent** *sorcerer cast a spell of endless winter on the valley.*

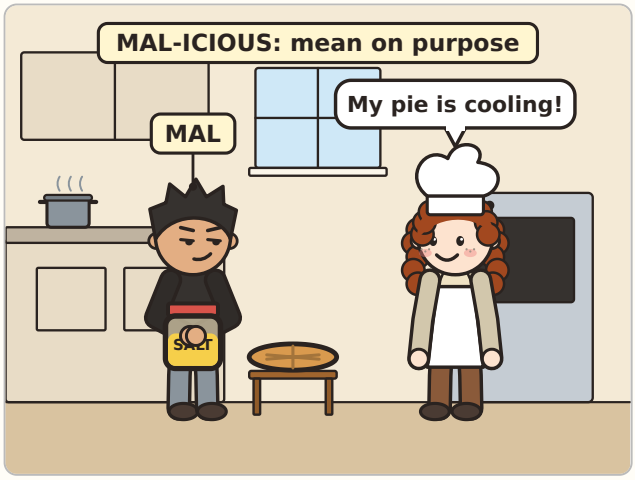
**PARTS** **mal** badly + **vol** wish, will + **-ent** being or doing (an adjective ending)

**SIMILAR** evil, spiteful, malicious, hostile

**OPPOSITE** benevolent, kind, friendly



## malicious muh-**LISH**-us *adjective*




**MEANING** meaning to hurt someone on purpose

**MEMORY HOOK** **MAL spoils your deLICIOUS pie.** Sneaky Mal pours salt into the baker's delicious pie on purpose; spoiling it just to hurt her is **malicious**.

*Spreading a* **malicious** *rumor can hurt a person's friendships for years.*

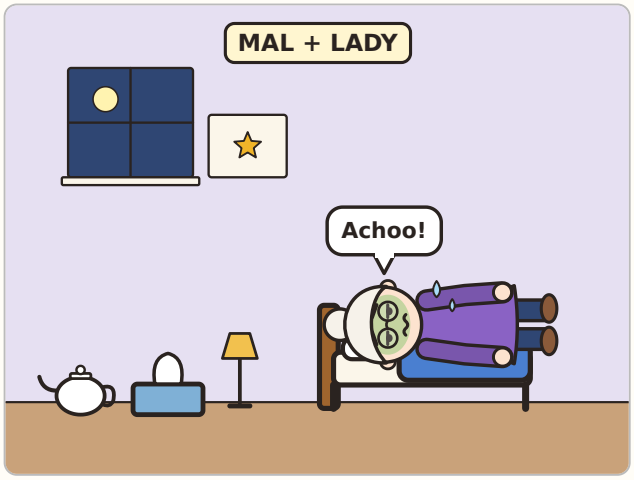
**PARTS** **mal** bad + **-ous** full of

**SIMILAR** spiteful, mean, vicious, malevolent

**OPPOSITE** kind, benevolent, well-meaning



## malady **MAL**-uh-dee *noun*




**MEANING** an illness, or a deep-rooted problem

**MEMORY HOOK** **the LADY has a MALady.** Poor Granny Mae is the lady with the bad cold; her **malady** keeps her in bed.

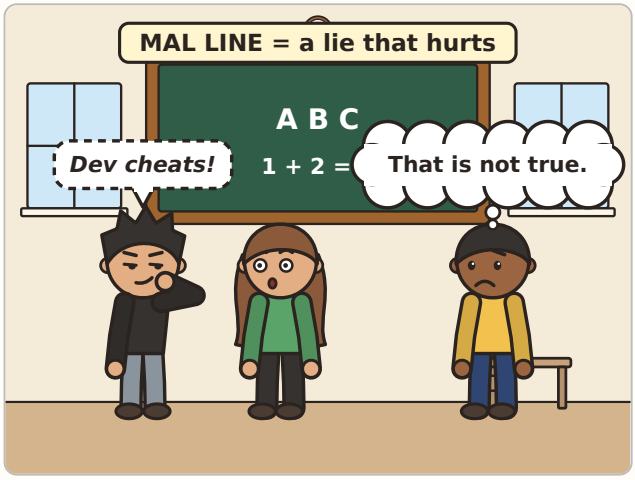
*Boredom is a common* **malady** *on long car trips.*

**PARTS** **mal** badly

**SIMILAR** illness, ailment, disorder, affliction

**OPPOSITE** health, wellness

## malign muh-**LINE** *verb*




**MEANING** to say harmful and untrue things about someone

**MEMORY HOOK** **a MAL LINE.** A mean line about someone that is not true: whispering “Dev cheats!” is a way to **malign** him.

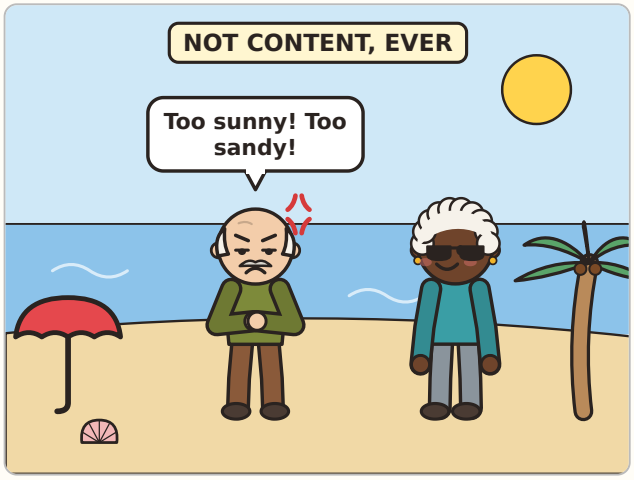
*It is unfair to* **malign** *a teammate who is not there to answer.*

**PARTS** **mal** bad, badly

**SIMILAR** slander, smear, disparage, defame
**OPPOSITE** praise, defend, compliment



## malcontent **MAL**-kun-tent *noun*




**MEANING** a person who is always dissatisfied and complaining

**MEMORY HOOK** **MAL-CONTENT: never content.** Grandpa Gus is never content, not even at the beach: he is a **malcontent**.

*Even on a perfect beach day, the* **malcontent** *found something to grumble about.*

**PARTS** **mal** badly + **content** satisfied

**SIMILAR** grumbler, complainer, grouch



## compassionate kum-**PASH**-uh-nit *adjective*




**MEANING** feeling for others who suffer and wanting to help them

**MEMORY HOOK** **a heart like a COMPASS.** Maya’s heart works like a compass: it always points her toward whoever is hurting. She is **compassionate**.

*The* **compassionate** *nurse held the frightened boy’s hand until his parents arrived.*

**PARTS** **com** with + **pass** suffer (Latin pati) + **-ate** having (an adjective ending)

**SIMILAR** sympathetic, caring, kindhearted, merciful
**OPPOSITE** callous, heartless, cold



## considerate kun-**SID**-er-it *adjective*



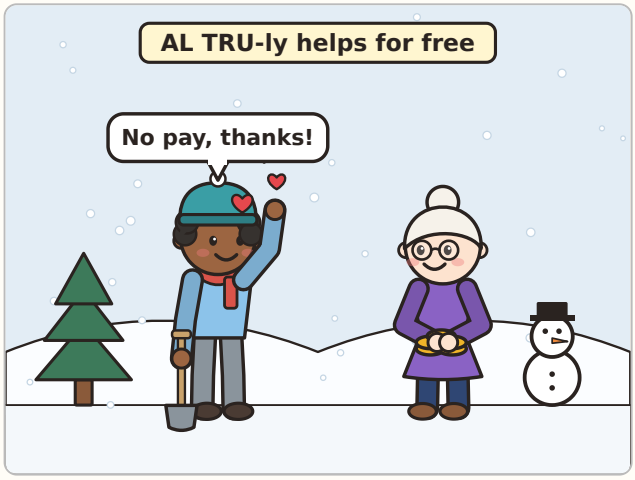

**MEANING** careful not to hurt, bother or inconvenience others

**MEMORY HOOK** **CONSIDER IT first.** Before Jonah bangs his drum, he stops to consider it: is the baby asleep? Thinking of others first makes him **considerate**.

*It was* **considerate** *of Omar to call ahead and say he would be late.*

**SIMILAR** thoughtful, mindful, kind, attentive
**OPPOSITE** inconsiderate, thoughtless, selfish

## altruistic al-troo-**IS**-tik *adjective*




**MEANING** helping others with no thought of reward for oneself

**MEMORY HOOK** **AL TRUly helps for free.** Al shovels every neighbor's walk and waves away their money. Al truly helps for nothing in return: he is **altruistic**.

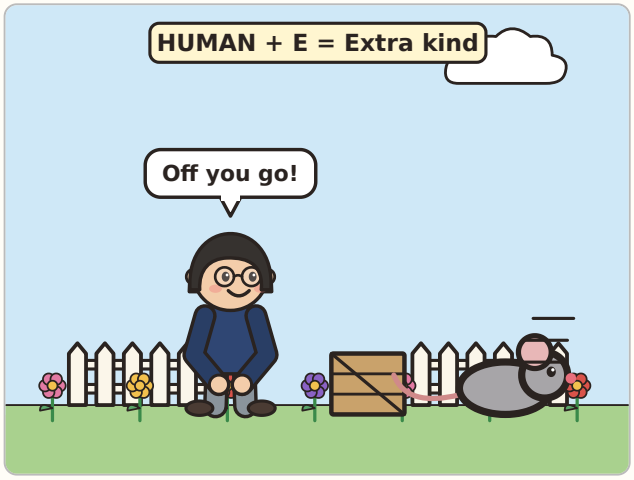
*The **altruistic** teen spent her summer teaching little kids to swim for free.*

**PARTS** **altru** others (from Latin alter, other) + **-istic** having to do with

**SIMILAR** selfless, unselfish, charitable, generous
**OPPOSITE** selfish, self-serving, greedy



## humane hyoo-**MAYN** *adjective*




**MEANING** kind and merciful; causing no needless pain

**MEMORY HOOK** **HUMAN + E = Extra kind.** Add an E to human for Extra kindness: Ada's **humane** trap catches the mouse without a scratch, and she lets it go in the garden.

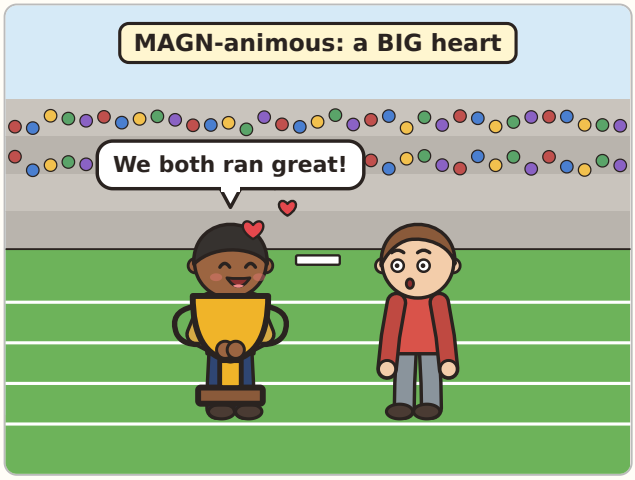
*The shelter found a **humane** way to catch the stray cats without hurting them.*

**PARTS** **human** of people (Latin humanus)

**SIMILAR** kind, merciful, compassionate, gentle
**OPPOSITE** inhumane, cruel, brutal



## magnanimous mag-**NAN**-uh-mus *adjective*




**MEANING** generous and forgiving, especially toward a rival

**MEMORY HOOK** **MAGN = BIG, as in MAGNIFY.** Dev wins the race, then lifts the trophy with the runner-up and cheers for him too. A heart that big toward a rival is **magnanimous**.

*In a **magnanimous** gesture, the champion invited the runner-up to share the stage.*

**PARTS** **magn** great + **anim** mind, spirit + **-ous** full of

**SIMILAR** big-hearted, gracious, generous, forgiving
**OPPOSITE** petty, vindictive, spiteful



## solicitous suh-**LIS**-ih-tus *adjective*




**MEANING** eagerly caring about someone's comfort and well-being

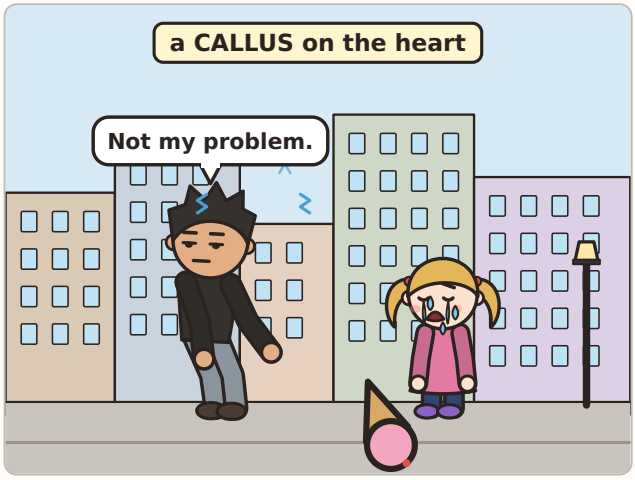
**MEMORY HOOK** **so-LIS-it-us: "SO, LIST US your needs!".** "So, list us your needs: tea? a pillow? another blanket?" Lila fusses over Granny Mae's sniffle. She is **solicitous**.

*The **solicitous** host kept asking whether everyone had enough to eat.*

**PARTS** **solicit** anxious (Latin sollicitus) + **-ous** full of

**SIMILAR** attentive, caring, concerned, thoughtful
**OPPOSITE** neglectful, indifferent, unconcerned

## callous KAL-us *adjective*




**MEANING** unfeeling toward other people's pain or trouble

**MEMORY HOOK** **a CALLUS on the heart.** A callus is hard skin that feels nothing. Rex walks past the crying girl without a glance, as if his heart had a callus: he is **callous**.

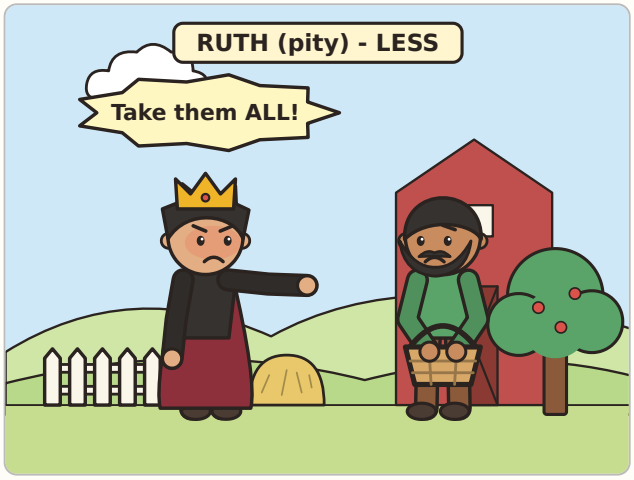
*Laughing at the boy who dropped his lunch tray was a* **callous** *thing to do.*

**PARTS** **call** hard skin (Latin callum) + **-ous** full of, having

**SIMILAR** heartless, unfeeling, insensitive, cold
**OPPOSITE** compassionate, sympathetic, caring



## ruthless ROOTH-lis *adjective*




**MEANING** showing no pity; willing to hurt others to get one's way

**MEMORY HOOK** **RUTH = pity: RUTH-LESS.** Ruth is an old word for pity. The cartoon king who takes the farmers' very last pears has no ruth at all: he is **ruthless**.

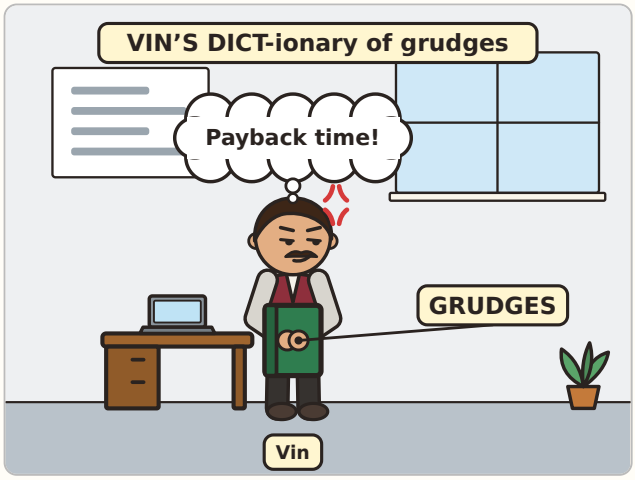
*Lin is a* **ruthless** *checkers player who never lets anyone take back a move.*

**PARTS** **ruth** pity (an old English word) + **-less** without

**SIMILAR** merciless, pitiless, heartless, cruel
**OPPOSITE** merciful, humane, compassionate



## vindictive vin-DIK-tiv *adjective*




**MEANING** wanting revenge; set on paying someone back

**MEMORY HOOK** **VIN's DICTionary of grudges.** Vin keeps a whole dictionary of everyone who ever wronged him, and he plans to pay back every one. Vin is **vindictive**.

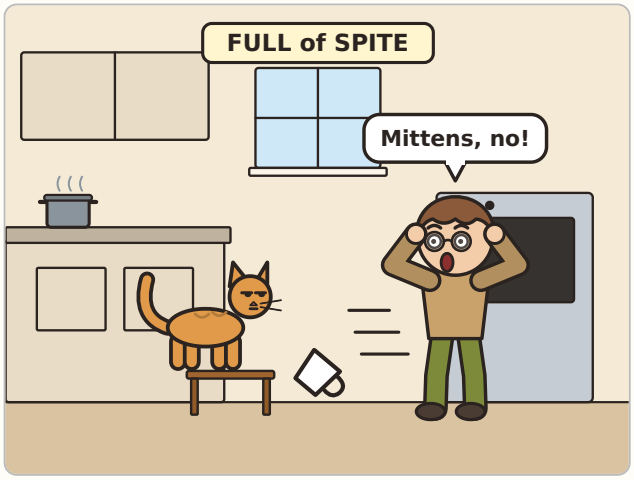
*After losing at checkers, my* **vindictive** *cousin hid the winner's shoes.*

**PARTS** **vindict** revenge (Latin vindicta) + **-ive** tending to

**SIMILAR** vengeful, unforgiving, revengeful, resentful
**OPPOSITE** forgiving, magnanimous, merciful



## spiteful SPITE-ful *adjective*



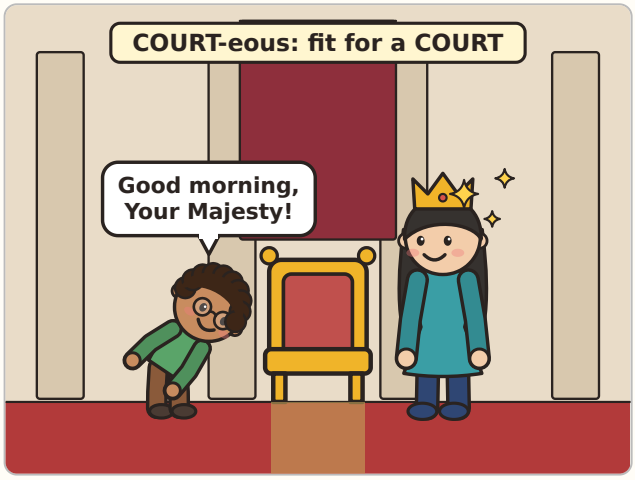

**MEANING** mean on purpose, out of petty ill will

**MEMORY HOOK** **a cat FULL of SPITE.** Dinner was late, so Mittens looks Felix in the eye and slowly pushes his cup off the table: a **spiteful** cat.

*The* **spiteful** *cat stared right at me and pushed my cup off the table.*

**SIMILAR** mean, malicious, nasty, petty
**OPPOSITE** kind, generous, charitable

## courteous KUR-tee-us *adjective*




**MEANING** polite and respectful toward others

**MEMORY HOOK** **manners fit for a royal COURT.** Sami bows to the queen and says, “Good morning, Your Majesty.” Manners fit for a royal court are **courteous**.

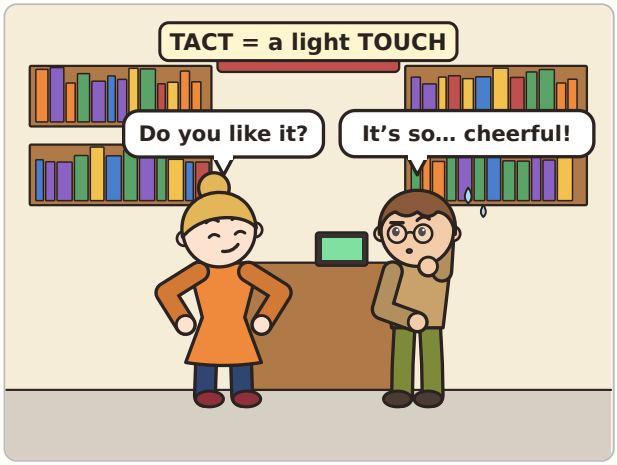
*The* **courteous** *bus driver waited for the running boy and greeted him with a smile.*

**PARTS** **court** a royal court + **-eous** full of, having

**SIMILAR** polite, respectful, gracious, civil
**OPPOSITE** rude, discourteous, impolite



## tactful TAKT-ful *adjective*




**MEANING** careful to say things without hurting anyone’s feelings

**MEMORY HOOK** **TACT = TOUCH: a light touch.** Tact comes from the Latin for touch. Aunt Greta asks if Felix likes her bright orange sweater, and he answers with a light touch: “It’s so cheerful!” He is **tactful**.

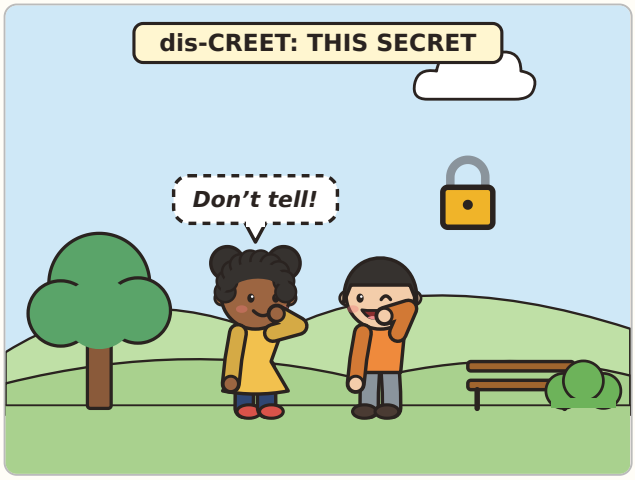
*Felix gave a* **tactful** *answer when his aunt asked whether he liked her very orange sweater.*

**PARTS** **tact** touch (Latin tactus) + **-ful** full of

**SIMILAR** diplomatic, sensitive, thoughtful, considerate
**OPPOSITE** tactless, blunt, insensitive



## discreet dih-SKREET *adjective*




**MEANING** careful in what one says or does, especially in keeping secrets

**MEMORY HOOK** **dis-CREET: “THIS SECRET stays with me”.** Zoe whispers her news, and Kai zips his lips: “This secret stays with me.” He never tells a soul. Kai is **discreet**.

*Be* **discreet** *about the surprise party; Grandma notices everything.*

**PARTS** **dis** apart + **cre** sift, sort (Latin cernere)

**SIMILAR** careful, tactful, guarded, prudent
**OPPOSITE** indiscreet, careless, tactless



## urbane ur-BAYN *adjective*




**MEANING** polished, courteous and at ease in any social setting

**MEMORY HOOK** **URBAN + E: city-polished manners.** At the museum gala, Victor greets each guest by name, bows, and tells just the right joke. His manners are city-polished: he is **urbane**.

*The* **urbane** *host remembered every guest’s name and made each one feel welcome.*

**PARTS** **urb** city

**SIMILAR** polished, sophisticated, refined, worldly
**OPPOSITE** boorish, uncouth, crude

## suave SWAHV *adjective*




**MEANING** charming, confident and smooth in manner

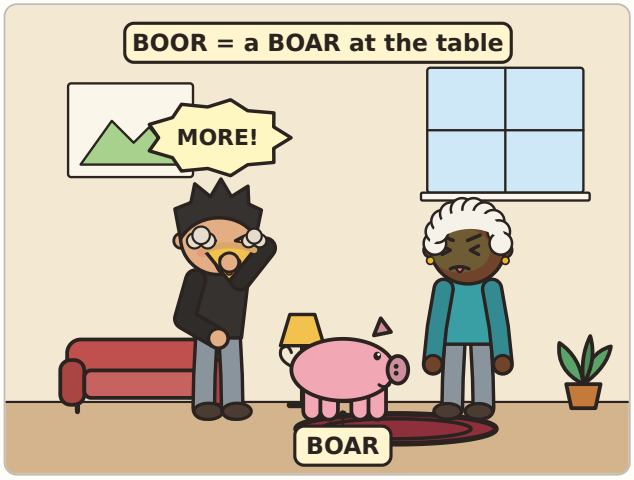
**MEMORY HOOK** **S-U-A-V-E: Smooth, Unruffled, At ease.** Spell it out: Smooth, Unruffled, At ease, Very charming, Elegant. Jamal glides across the stage in his bow tie and never misses a step: he is **suave**.

*The **suave** magician bowed, winked and pulled a rose from behind his hat.*

**SIMILAR** smooth, charming, polished, debonair
**OPPOSITE** awkward, clumsy, graceless



## boorish BOOR-ish *adjective*




**MEANING** rough, loud and bad-mannered

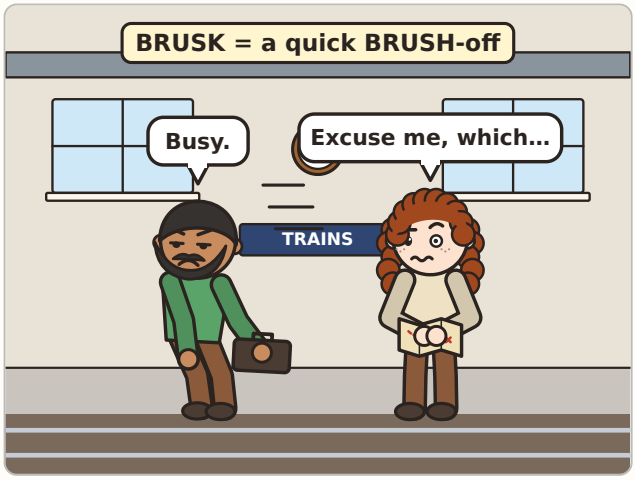
**MEMORY HOOK** **a BOAR at the dinner table.** Picture a wild boar at a dinner party: snorting, grabbing, crumbs everywhere. Rex eats just like one. He is **boorish**.

*His **boorish** habit of talking with his mouth full annoyed everyone at the table.*

**SIMILAR** rude, coarse, crude, loutish
**OPPOSITE** courteous, refined, gracious



## brusque BRUSK *adjective*




**MEANING** abrupt and short in speech or manner

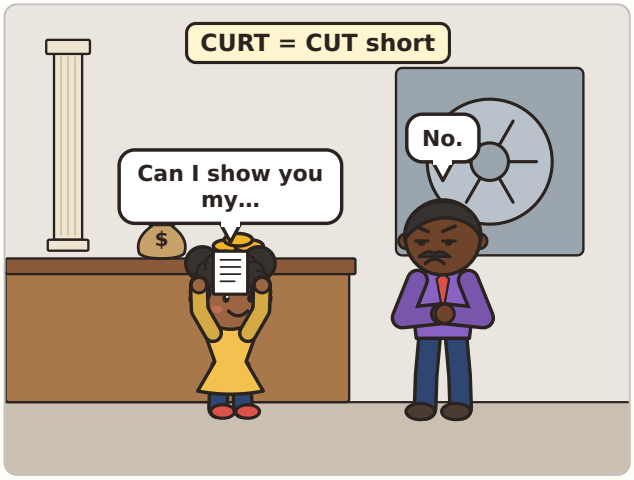
**MEMORY HOOK** **BRUSK: a quick BRUSH-off.** Nell asks a hurrying man for directions, and he brushes her off with one word, “Busy,” and keeps walking. A brush-off that quick is **brusque**.

*The busy clerk gave a **brusque** nod and turned to the next customer.*

**SIMILAR** abrupt, blunt, short, gruff
**OPPOSITE** gracious, warm, courteous



## curt KURT *adjective*



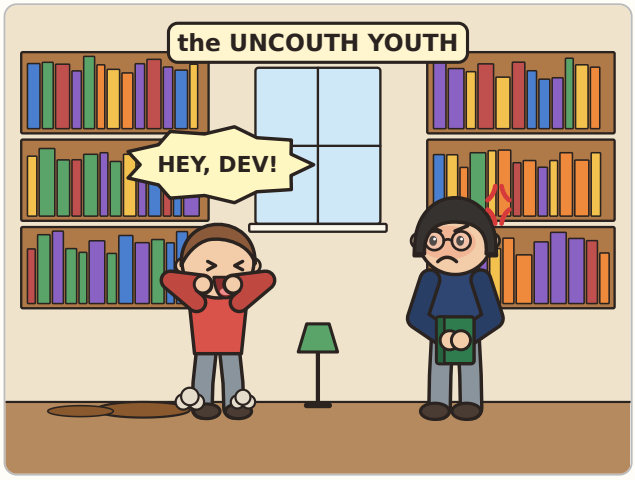

**MEANING** rudely brief

**MEMORY HOOK** **CURT = CUT short.** Zoe starts to show the banker her whole plan for a lemonade stand, and he cuts her short: “No.” A reply cut that short is **curt**.

*Her **curt** reply, “No,” ended the conversation.*

**SIMILAR** short, terse, abrupt, clipped
**OPPOSITE** friendly, gracious, expansive

## uncouth un-**KOOTH** *adjective*




**MEANING** lacking good manners or refinement

**MEMORY HOOK** **the UNCOUTH YOUTH.** It rhymes: the youth with no manners is uncouth. Jonah stomps into the quiet library in muddy boots, yelling for his friend. He is **uncouth**.

*Talking loudly on the phone all through the movie was* **uncouth**.

**PARTS** **un** not + **couth** known (Old English cuth)

**SIMILAR** rude, crude, coarse, ill-mannered
**OPPOSITE** refined, polished, urbane



## churlish **CHUR**-lish *adjective*




**MEANING** rude and mean-spirited; ungracious

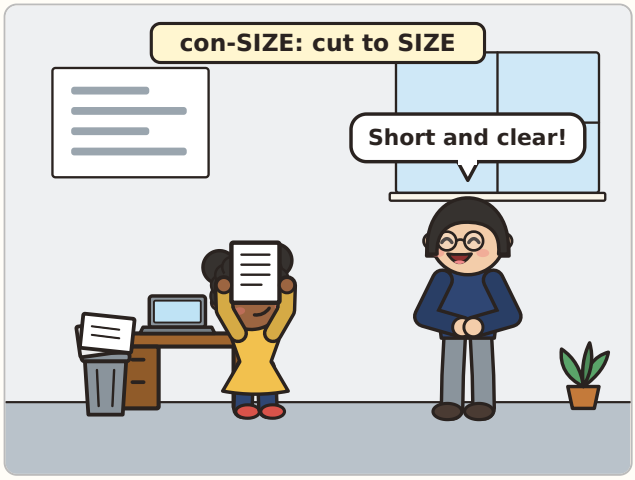
**MEMORY HOOK** **CHURL rhymes with HURL.** Ivy gives Uncle Marcus a scarf she knitted herself, and he hurls it back with a grunt: “Itchy.” Hurling back a kind gift is **churlish**.

*It would be* **churlish** *to refuse a gift from a friend who saved for months to buy it.*

**SIMILAR** ungracious, rude, surly, mean
**OPPOSITE** gracious, courteous, polite



## concise kun-**SICE** *adjective*




**MEANING** giving all the needed information in few words

**MEMORY HOOK** **con-SIZE: CUT TO SIZE.** Zoe’s report ran three pages, so she cut it to size: one tight paragraph that still says it all. Now it is **concise**.

*Her* **concise** *note said everything: “Pizza in the oven. Back at six.”*

**PARTS** **con** thoroughly + **cis** cut (Latin caedere)

**SIMILAR** brief, compact, succinct, to the point
**OPPOSITE** wordy, long-winded, verbose



## succinct suk-**SINKT** *adjective*




**MEANING** brief and clear; said in few words

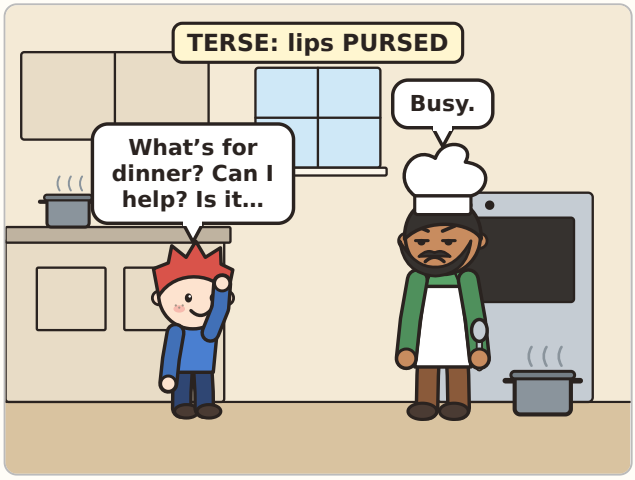
**MEMORY HOOK** **suk-SINKT: SINK it in one shot.** Kai sinks the ball in the bucket with one clean toss: no extra bounces, no wasted moves. A **succinct** answer is like that: it makes its point in one shot.

*When the coach asked what went wrong, Lin gave a* **succinct** *answer: “We stopped passing.”*

**PARTS** **suc** up from under (Latin sub) + **cinct** belted (Latin cingere)

**SIMILAR** brief, concise, crisp, pointed
**OPPOSITE** wordy, rambling, long-winded

## terse TURS *adjective*




**MEANING** brief, sometimes to the point of seeming rude

**MEMORY HOOK** **TERSE: lips PURSED tight.** Chef Omar keeps his lips pursed while he cooks and answers every question with one word: "Busy." "Later." "No." His answers are **terse**.

*The **terse** text, "K," left Jamal wondering whether his sister was upset.*

**SIMILAR** brief, short, clipped, curt
**OPPOSITE** wordy, chatty, expansive



## laconic luh-KON-ik *adjective*




**MEANING** using very few words

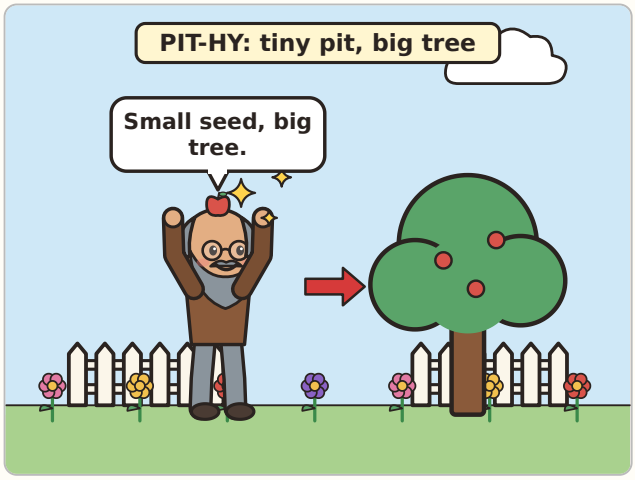
**MEMORY HOOK** **LACK-ONIC: he LACKS words.** Asked how his long, long trip across the desert went, the rancher says only, "Fine." He lacks words to spare: he is **laconic**.

*The **laconic** rancher answered every question with "Yep" or "Nope."*

**PARTS** **Lacon** Laconia, the land around ancient Sparta + **-ic** like
**SIMILAR** brief, terse, of few words
**OPPOSITE** verbose, garrulous, talkative



## pithy PITH-ee *adjective*




**MEANING** short but full of meaning

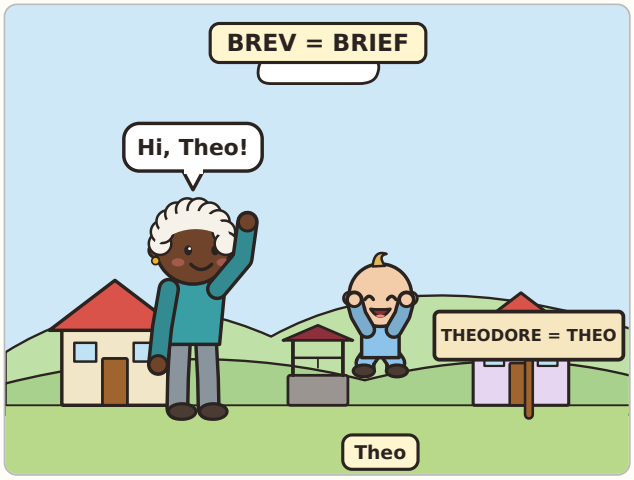
**MEMORY HOOK** **PIT-HY: a tiny PIT, a whole tree.** A tiny peach pit holds a whole tree inside it. A **pithy** saying is the same: a few words with a big idea packed in.

*Grandpa's **pithy** advice fit on a sticky note: "Measure twice, cut once."*

**SIMILAR** meaningful, punchy, concise, telling
**OPPOSITE** wordy, rambling, empty



## brevity BREV-ih-tee *noun*




**MEANING** shortness, especially in speech or writing

**MEMORY HOOK** **BREV = BRIEF: THEODORE becomes THEO.** Nobody calls little Theodore by his whole name; he is just Theo. Brev- means brief, and **brevity** is the art of keeping it short.

*The **brevity** of the speech delighted the hungry dinner guests.*

**PARTS** **brev** short + **-ity** the quality of
**SIMILAR** shortness, conciseness, briefness, terseness
**OPPOSITE** wordiness, length, verbosity

## verbose ver-**BOSE** *adjective*




**MEANING** using more words than are needed

**MEMORY HOOK** **VERB-HOSE: a fire hose of words.** Ask the lawyer a yes-or-no question, and words gush out like water from a fire hose: "Firstly, secondly, furthermore…" He is **verbose**.

*The* **verbose** *instructions took three pages to explain how to plug in a lamp.*

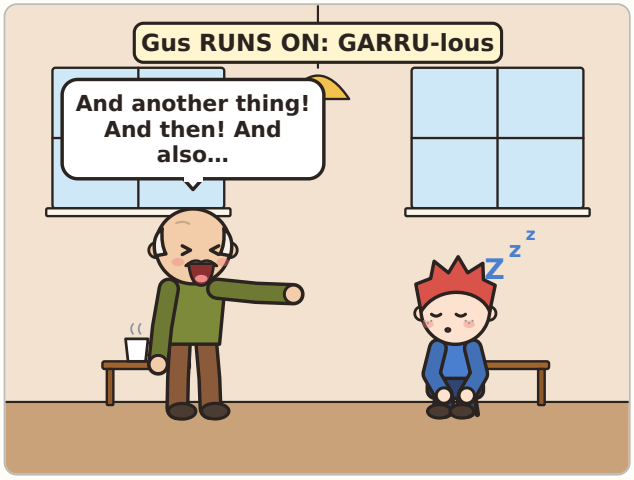
**PARTS** **verb** word + **-ose** full of

**SIMILAR** wordy, long-winded, rambling, windy

**OPPOSITE** concise, succinct, terse



## garrulous **GAIR**-uh-lus *adjective*




**MEANING** talking too much, especially about unimportant things

**MEMORY HOOK** **GARRU-lous: Gus RUNS ON.** Once Grandpa Gus starts talking, he runs on and on: the weather, his knees, the fish he almost caught. Gus is **garrulous**.

*Our* **garrulous** *seatmate told us about every one of her eleven cats.*

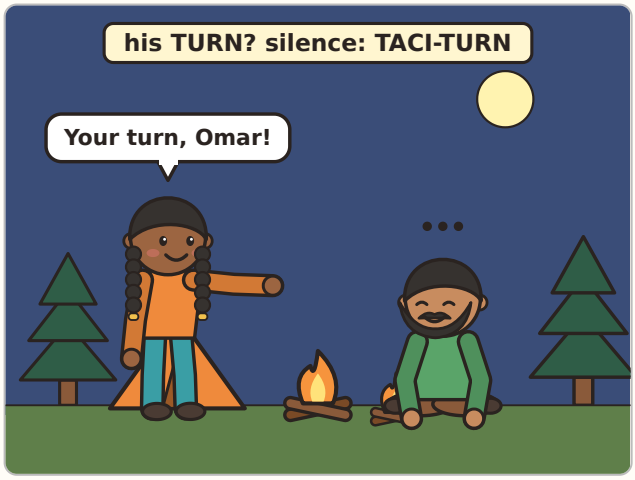
**PARTS** **garrul** chattering (Latin garrire, to chatter) + **-ous** full of

**SIMILAR** talkative, chatty, gabby, long-winded

**OPPOSITE** taciturn, quiet, reticent



## taciturn **TAS**-ih-turn *adjective*




**MEANING** quiet by habit; saying very little

**MEMORY HOOK** **TACIT TURN: his turn, and silence.** Around the campfire everyone takes a turn telling a story. When it is Omar's turn, he just smiles and pokes the fire. He is **taciturn**.

*Her* **taciturn** *uncle spoke perhaps ten words during the whole holiday dinner.*

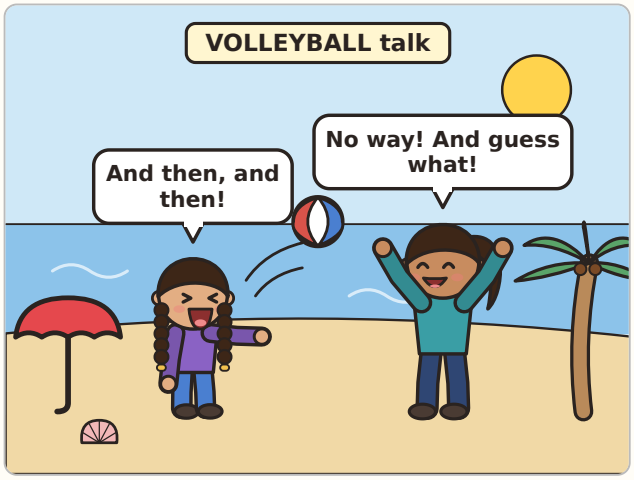
**PARTS** **tacit** silent (Latin tacitus)

**SIMILAR** quiet, reserved, silent, reticent

**OPPOSITE** talkative, garrulous, voluble



## voluble **VOL**-yuh-bul *adjective*




**MEANING** talking easily, quickly and at length

**MEMORY HOOK** **VOL-yuh-bul: VOLLEYBALL talk.** Lila and Maya talk like a volleyball game: words fly fast, bounce right back and never hit the ground. Both girls are **voluble**.

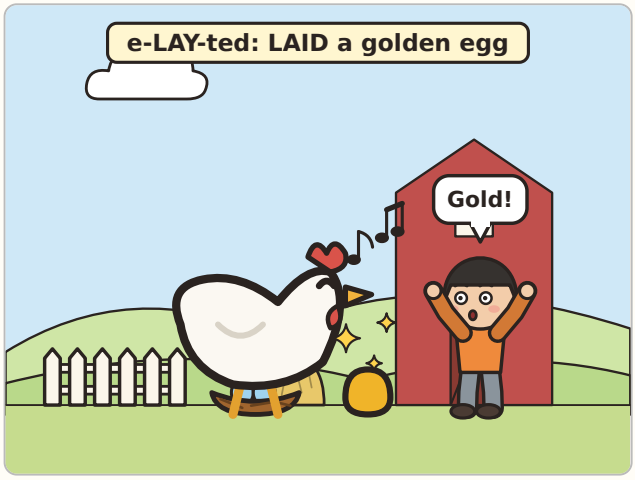
*The* **voluble** *tour guide chatted happily all the way up the mountain.*

**PARTS** **volu** roll (Latin volvere) + **-ble** able to

**SIMILAR** talkative, fluent, chatty, loquacious

**OPPOSITE** taciturn, reticent, quiet

## elated ih-**LAY**-tid *adjective*




**MEANING** very happy and excited about something good

**MEMORY HOOK** **e-LAY-ted: she LAID a golden egg!.** Henrietta the hen has just laid a golden egg, and she flaps and clucks with joy. She is **elated**.

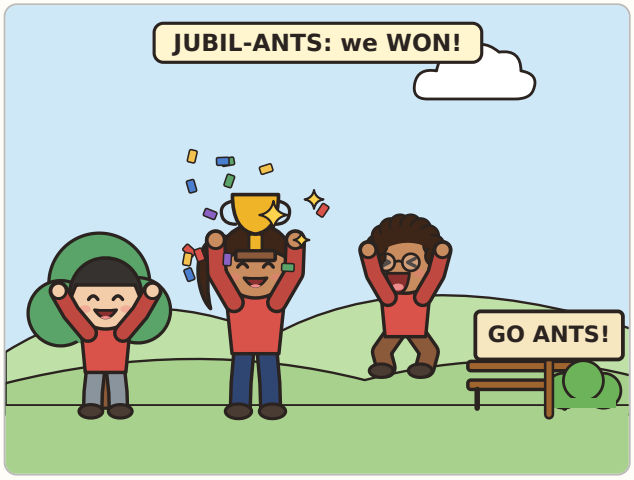
*Maya was* **elated** *when the letter said she had made the team.*

**PARTS** **e** out, up (from ex) + **lat** carried, lifted

**SIMILAR** overjoyed, thrilled, delighted, exhilarated
**OPPOSITE** dejected, crestfallen, despondent



## jubilant JOO-buh-lunt *adjective*




**MEANING** joyful and triumphant, especially after a success

**MEMORY HOOK** **JUBIL-ANTS: the Ants won the cup!.** The Ants, the smallest team in the league, just won the cup, and every player is leaping and cheering. They are **jubilant**.

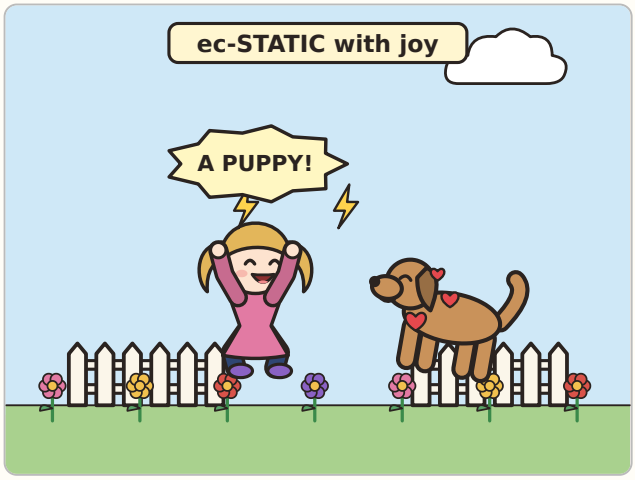
*The* **jubilant** *fans poured onto the field after the final whistle.*

**PARTS** **jubil** shout for joy (Latin jubilare) + **-ant** doing (an adjective ending)

**SIMILAR** triumphant, exultant, joyful, overjoyed
**OPPOSITE** dejected, despondent, defeated



## ecstatic ek-**STAT**-ik *adjective*




**MEANING** overwhelmingly happy and excited

**MEMORY HOOK** **ec-STATIC: crackling with joy.** Ivy is so happy about her new puppy that she crackles like static electricity: she jumps, squeals and sparks with joy. She is **ecstatic**.

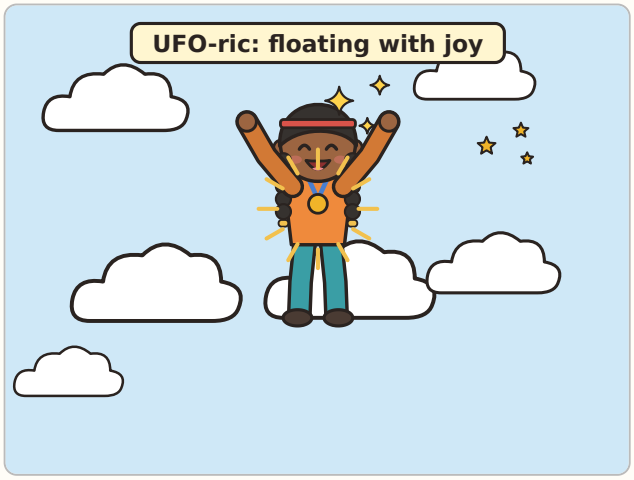
*The puppy was* **ecstatic** *to see its family come home after a week away.*

**PARTS** **ec** out (Greek ek) + **stat** stand, place + **-ic** having to do with

**SIMILAR** overjoyed, thrilled, euphoric, delighted
**OPPOSITE** miserable, devastated, glum



## euphoric yoo-**FOR**-ik *adjective*




**MEANING** intensely happy and excited

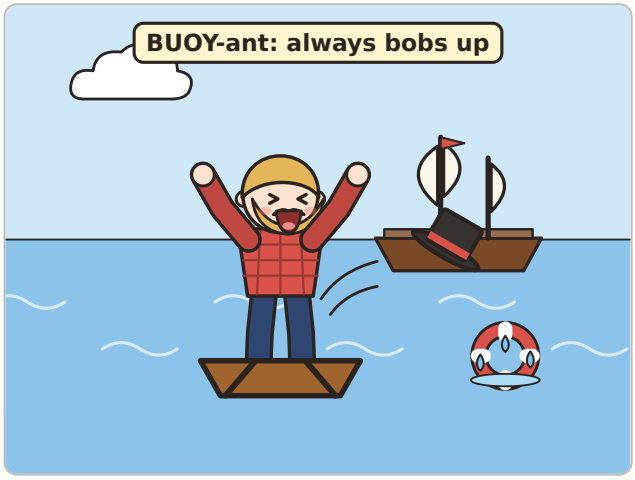
**MEMORY HOOK** **yoo-FOR-ik: floating like a UFO.** Tia finishes her first marathon and feels so light with joy that she could float off into the sky like a UFO. She is **euphoric**.

*The* **euphoric** *climbers hugged and took pictures on the summit.*

**PARTS** **eu** good, well + **phor** bearing, carrying (Greek pherein) + **-ic** having to do with

**SIMILAR** elated, ecstatic, overjoyed, exhilarated
**OPPOSITE** depressed, miserable, gloomy

## buoyant **BOY**-unt *adjective*




**MEANING** cheerful and hopeful; also, able to float

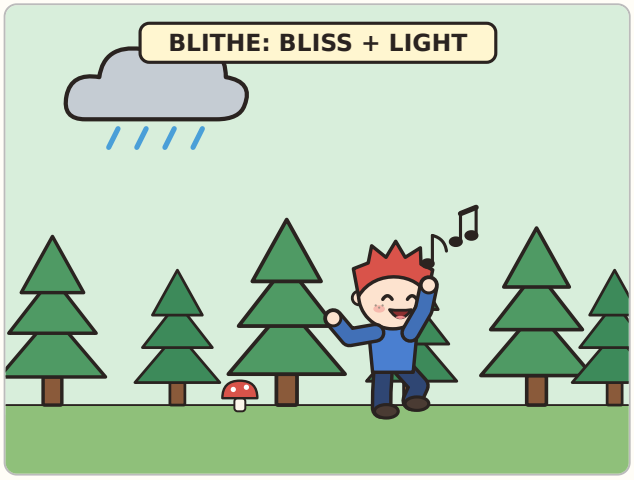
**MEMORY HOOK** **BUOY-ant: bobs up like a BUOY.** A wave knocks Sven's hat into the sea, and he just laughs and bobs along like a buoy. His spirits always float back up: he is **buoyant**.

*Despite the rain, the campers stayed* **buoyant**, *singing all the way back to their cabins.*

**SIMILAR** cheerful, upbeat, lighthearted, optimistic
**OPPOSITE** depressed, gloomy, despondent



## blithe **BLYTHE** *adjective*




**MEANING** cheerful and carefree, sometimes carelessly so

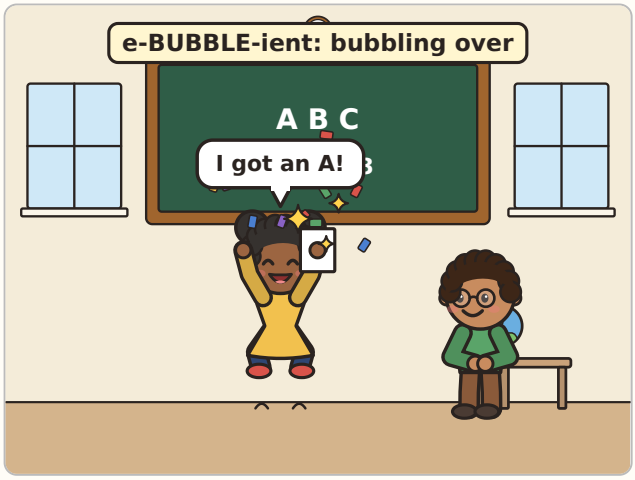
**MEMORY HOOK** **BLITHE = BLISS + LIGHT.** Pip skips home whistling, blissful and light as a feather, without a care in the world, not even for the storm cloud right behind him. He is **blithe**.

*Humming a* **blithe** *tune, Zoe skipped down the lane to the pond.*

**SIMILAR** carefree, lighthearted, breezy, unconcerned
**OPPOSITE** worried, anxious, careful



## ebullient ih-**BUL**-yunt *adjective*




**MEANING** bubbling over with cheerful energy

**MEMORY HOOK** **e-BUBBLE-ient: BUBBLING over.** Like a pot bubbling over, Zoe can't hold in her joy at her first A: she jumps, laughs and hugs the whole class. She is **ebullient**.

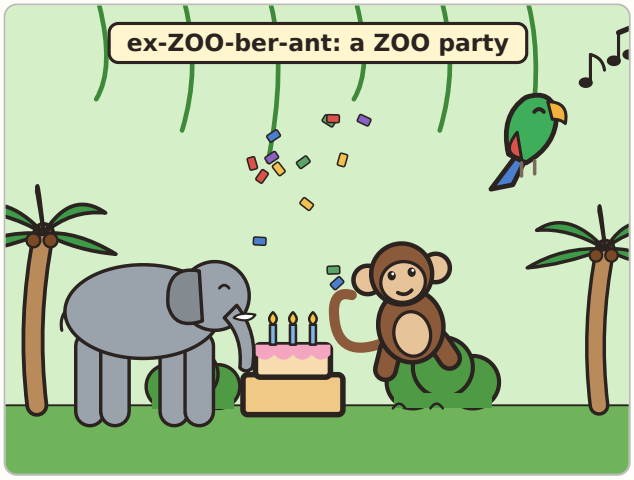
*The* **ebullient** *host greeted every guest with a hug and a joke.*

**PARTS** **e** out (from ex) + **bull** bubble, boil (Latin bullire) + **-ent** being or doing (an adjective ending)

**SIMILAR** exuberant, bubbly, effervescent, buoyant
**OPPOSITE** subdued, gloomy, flat



## exuberant ig-**ZOO**-ber-unt *adjective*




**MEANING** full of energy, excitement and joy

**MEMORY HOOK** **ex-ZOO-ber-ant: a ZOO bursting with joy.** The keeper rolls in a birthday cake, and the whole zoo bursts with joy: the monkey leaps, the parrot sings, the elephant sprays a happy fountain. The animals are **exuberant**.

*The* **exuberant** *puppy raced around the yard, leaping at every leaf.*

**PARTS** **ex** thoroughly + **uber** fruitful, rich (Latin uber) + **-ant** being or doing (an adjective ending)

**SIMILAR** lively, energetic, high-spirited, vivacious
**OPPOSITE** subdued, listless, glum

## mirth MURTH *noun*




**MEANING** laughter, fun and amusement

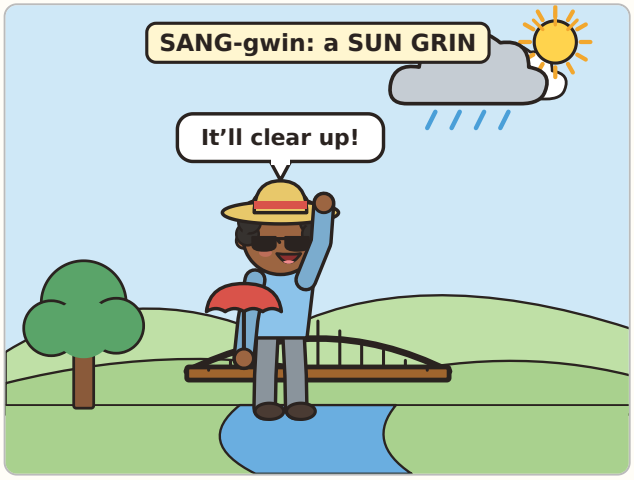
**MEMORY HOOK** **MIRTH rhymes with BIRTHday.** At Theo's birthday party, the puppy steals the party hat and wears it, and the whole room bursts into laughter. Birthdays bring **mirth**.

*The puppet show filled the library with* **mirth**.

**SIMILAR** laughter, merriment, glee, hilarity
**OPPOSITE** gloom, sadness, solemnity

5. Happy

## sanguine SANG-gwin *adjective*




**MEANING** hopeful and confident about the future

**MEMORY HOOK** **SANG-gwin: a SUN GRIN.** The sky is gray, but Jamal wears a sun grin and packs the beach umbrella anyway: "It'll clear up by noon!" He is **sanguine**.

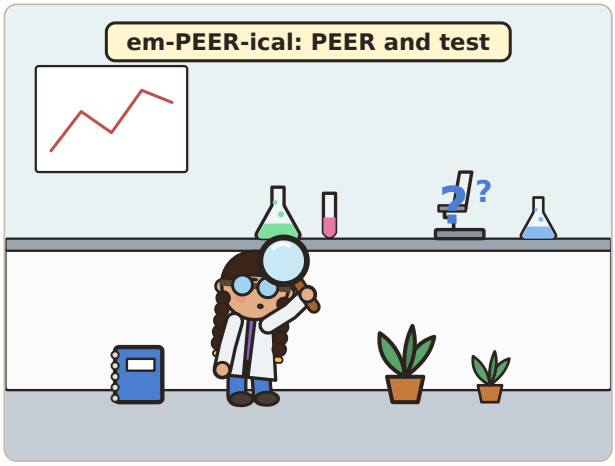
*Despite the gray sky, Dad was* **sanguine** *about our chances for a beach day.*

**PARTS** **sanguin** blood (Latin sanguis)

**SIMILAR** optimistic, hopeful, confident, upbeat
**OPPOSITE** pessimistic, gloomy, despairing

5. Happy

## empirical em-**PEER**-ih-kul *adjective*




**MEANING** based on observation or experiment, not on theory alone

**MEMORY HOOK** **em-PEER-ical: PEER at it yourself.** Don't just guess how many seeds will sprout: peer at them, count them, write it down. Knowledge you get by peering and testing is **empirical**.

*Sami gathered* **empirical** *evidence by timing how long each paper airplane stayed in the air.*

**PARTS** **empir** experience (Greek empeiria) + **-ical** having to do with

**SIMILAR** observed, experimental, evidence-based, firsthand
**OPPOSITE** theoretical, speculative, hypothetical

6. Evidence and Proof

## anecdotal an-ik-**DOH**-tul *adjective*




**MEANING** based on personal stories rather than careful study

**MEMORY HOOK** **ANNIE'S DOTE-TALE: just a story.** Annie swears her lucky socks win every game. Her only proof is Annie's tale about last Saturday, not a count of wins and losses. Her evidence is **anecdotal**.

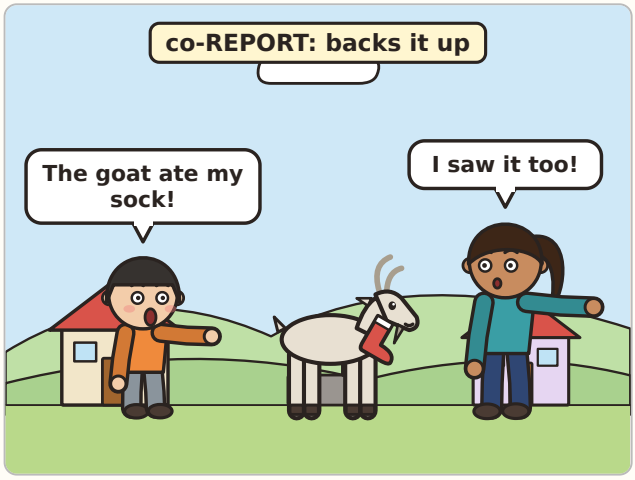
*The only proof that the shortcut was faster was* **anecdotal**: *Dev said it felt quicker.*

**PARTS** **an** not (Greek) + **ekdot** given out, published (Greek ekdotos)

**SIMILAR** story-based, informal, unverified
**OPPOSITE** empirical, scientific, systematic

6. Evidence and Proof

## corroborate kuh-**ROB**-uh-rayt *verb*




**MEANING** to confirm or support with more evidence

**MEMORY HOOK** **co-ROB: a CO-REPORT backs it up.** "The goat ate my sock!" says Kai. "I saw it too!" says Maya, pointing at the sock in the goat's mouth. Her second report helps **corroborate** his story.

*Two neighbors* **corroborated** *the boy's story about the runaway goat.*

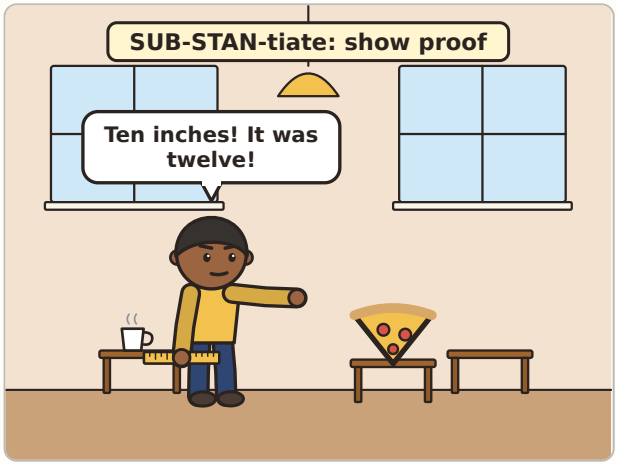
**PARTS** **cor** thoroughly (from con) + **robor** strength (Latin robur, oak) + **-ate** to make

**SIMILAR** confirm, back up, support, bear out

**OPPOSITE** contradict, refute, disprove



## substantiate sub-**STAN**-shee-ayt *verb*




**MEANING** to support a claim with proof

**MEMORY HOOK** **SUB-STAN-tiate: solid ground to STAND on.** A claim needs something solid to stand on. Dev backs up "The pizza shrank!" with a ruler and last month's photo. Now he can **substantiate** it.

*Can you* **substantiate** *your claim that the cafeteria pizza is getting smaller?*

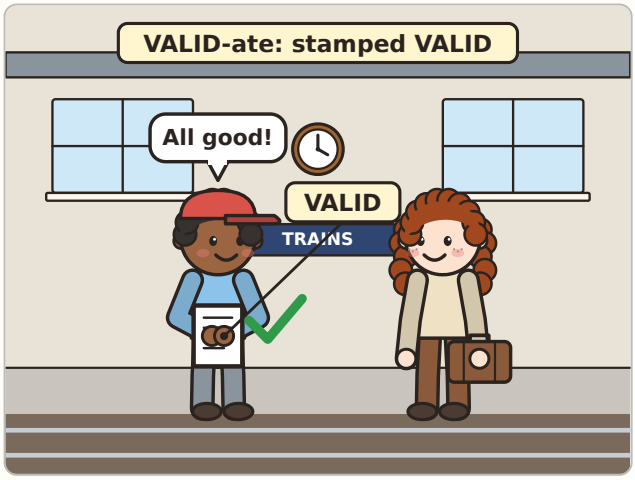
**PARTS** **sub** under + **stant** standing (Latin stare, to stand) + **-iate** to make

**SIMILAR** prove, support, back up, confirm

**OPPOSITE** disprove, refute, discredit



## validate **VAL**-ih-dayt *verb*




**MEANING** to check or prove that something is sound or correct

**MEMORY HOOK** **VALID-ATE: stamped VALID.** The conductor checks Nell's ticket against the schedule and stamps it VALID. To check that something is sound and correct is to **validate** it.

*The lab ran the test three more times to* **validate** *the surprising result.*

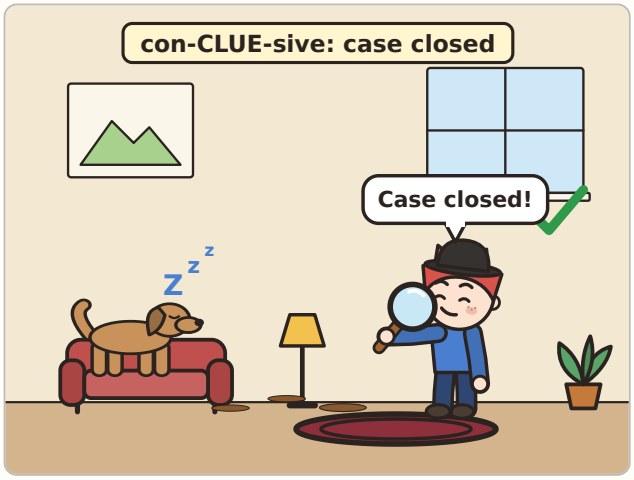
**PARTS** **val** strong, worth (Latin valere) + **-ate** to make

**SIMILAR** confirm, verify, certify, prove

**OPPOSITE** invalidate, disprove, refute



## conclusive kun-**KLOO**-siv *adjective*




**MEANING** settling a question beyond doubt

**MEMORY HOOK** **con-CLUE-sive: the CLUE that closes the case.** Muddy paw prints lead from the door straight to the dog asleep on the sofa: the last clue that closes the case. The evidence is **conclusive**.

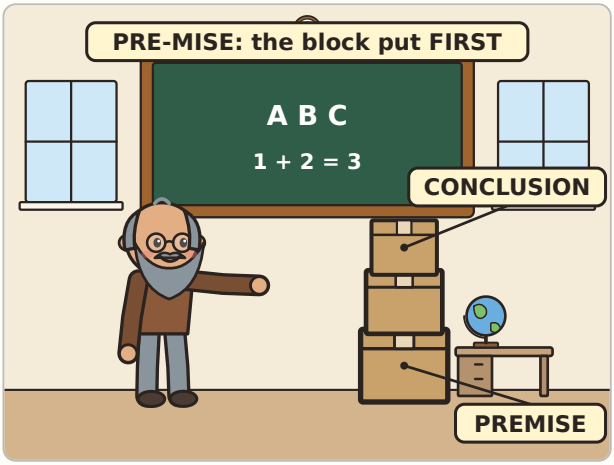
*The muddy paw prints on the sofa were* **conclusive***: the dog had been inside.*

**PARTS** **con** thoroughly + **clus** shut, close + **-ive** tending to

**SIMILAR** decisive, definitive, convincing, final

**OPPOSITE** inconclusive, doubtful, questionable

## premise PREM-is *noun*




**MEANING** a statement assumed true and used as a starting point for reasoning

**MEMORY HOOK** **PRE-MISE: the block that goes FIRST.** An argument is a tower of blocks, and the **premise** is the block at the bottom: set down first, before anything is built on it. If it is wobbly, the whole tower falls.

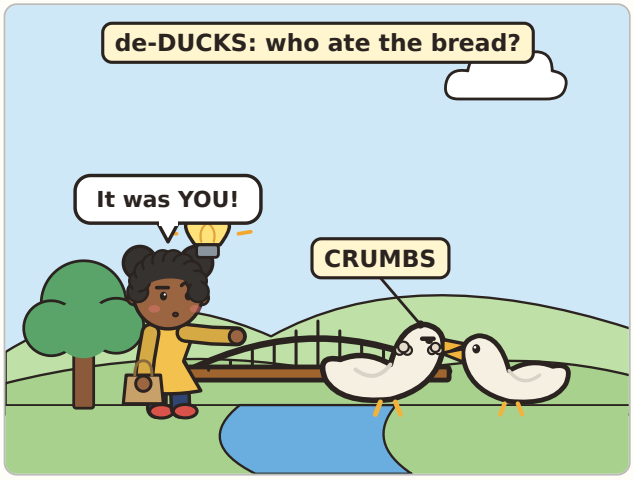
*The whole plan rested on one* **premise***: that the store would still be open at nine.*

**PARTS** **pre** before + **mis** sent, put (Latin mittere)

**SIMILAR** assumption, basis, starting point, supposition
**OPPOSITE** conclusion



## deduce dih-DOOS *verb*




**MEANING** to reach a conclusion by reasoning from facts

**MEMORY HOOK** **de-DUCKS: crumbs on whose beak?.** The bread is gone, and one duck has crumbs all over its beak. Zoe didn't see it happen, but she can **deduce** who ate it.

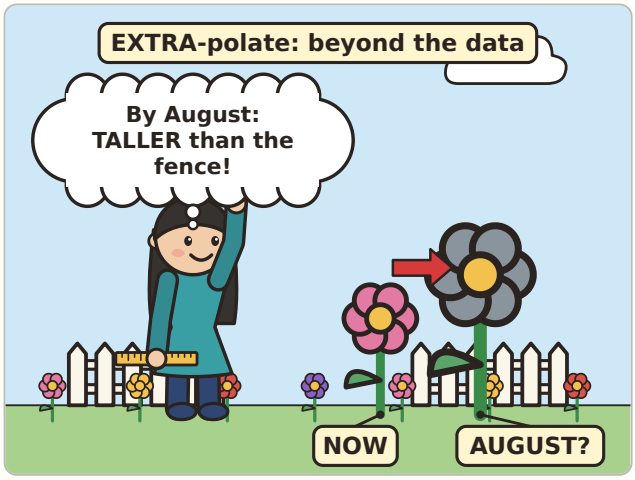
*From the crumbs on his shirt, Mom* **deduced** *who had eaten the last cookie.*

**PARTS** **de** down, from + **duc** lead

**SIMILAR** infer, reason, conclude, work out
**OPPOSITE** guess



## extrapolate ik-STRAP-uh-layt *verb*




**MEANING** to use known facts or trends to predict what lies beyond them

**MEMORY HOOK** **EXTRA-polate: draw the line EXTRA far.** Lin's sunflower grew a foot each week, so she draws the line extra far, past what she has measured: "By August it will beat the fence!" To predict that way is to **extrapolate**.

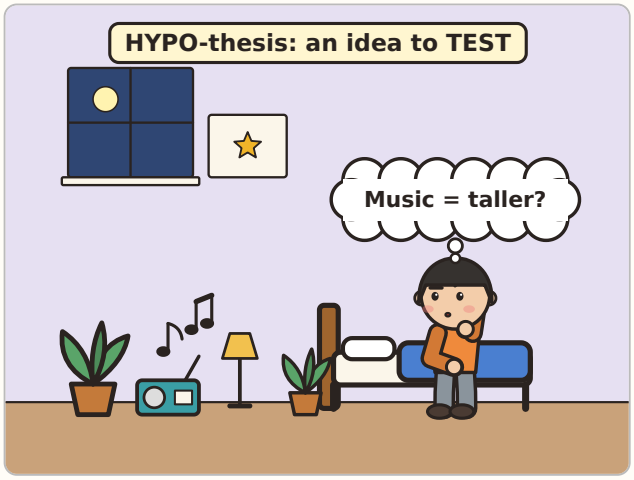
*From three weeks of growth, Lin* **extrapolated** *that her sunflower would top the fence by August.*

**PARTS** **extra** beyond, outside

**SIMILAR** project, extend, predict, infer



## hypothesis hye-POTH-uh-sis *noun*




**MEANING** a proposed explanation that can be tested

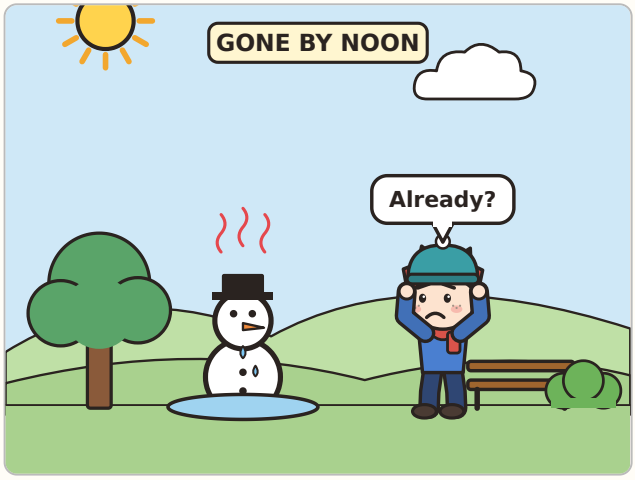
**MEMORY HOOK** **HYPO = UNDER: an idea put UNDER a test.** Kai guesses that music helps plants grow, so he plays songs to one plant and not to the other. A guess that you put under a test is a **hypothesis**.

*Kai's* **hypothesis** *was that plants given music would grow taller.*

**PARTS** **hypo** under + **thesis** a placing, a proposal (Greek)

**SIMILAR** educated guess, proposition, supposition, conjecture
**OPPOSITE** fact, certainty

## ephemeral ih-**FEM**-er-ul *adjective*




**MEANING** lasting a very short time

**MEMORY HOOK** **a snowman in the noon sun.** Pip's snowman stood proud at breakfast; by lunch it was a puddle and a carrot. Its life was **ephemeral**.

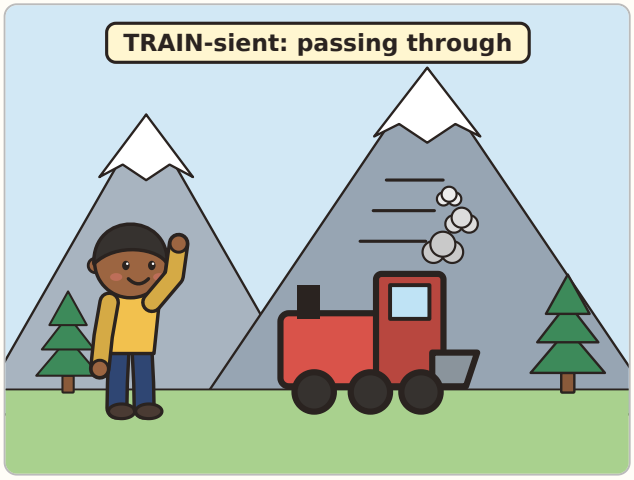
*The rainbow was* **ephemeral**, *gone before Lila could find her camera.*

**PARTS** **epi** upon, for (Greek) + **hemer** day (Greek hemera)

**SIMILAR** short-lived, brief, passing, momentary
**OPPOSITE** lasting, enduring, permanent



## transient **TRAN**-zee-unt *adjective*




**MEANING** lasting only a short time; staying only briefly

**MEMORY HOOK** **TRAIN-sient: a TRAIN passing through.** The express train roars through the mountain valley, toots once and is gone. Its visit is **transient**: here for a moment, then away.

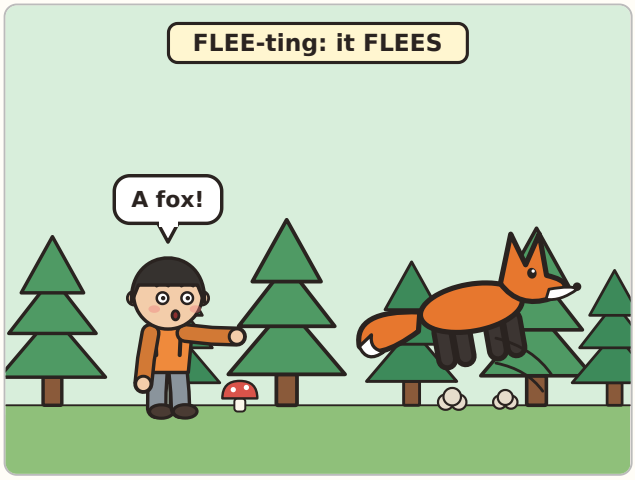
*The* **transient** *storm soaked the picnic and moved on within ten minutes.*

**PARTS** **trans** across, through + **i** go (Latin ire) + **-ent** being or doing (an adjective ending)

**SIMILAR** temporary, passing, brief, short-lived
**OPPOSITE** permanent, lasting, enduring



## fleeting **FLEE**-ting *adjective*




**MEANING** passing very quickly

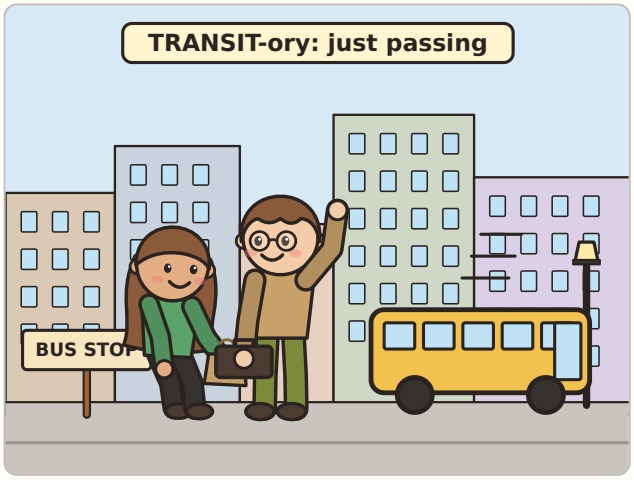
**MEMORY HOOK** **FLEE-ting: it FLEES before you look.** Kai turns, and the fox flees into the trees: one flash of orange tail, and it is gone. His look at it was **fleeting**.

*Kai caught a* **fleeting** *glimpse of the fox before it vanished into the trees.*

**SIMILAR** brief, momentary, passing, quick
**OPPOSITE** lasting, long, enduring



## transitory **TRAN**-sih-tor-ee *adjective*




**MEANING** not permanent; lasting only for a time

**MEMORY HOOK** **TRANSIT-ory: life at a bus stop.** Nobody stays long at a bus stop: people wait a few minutes, then ride away in transit. A stay that short is **transitory**.

*Her disappointment was* **transitory**; *by dinner she was laughing again.*

**PARTS** **trans** across + **it** gone (Latin ire, to go) + **-ory** having to do with

**SIMILAR** temporary, impermanent, short-lived, passing
**OPPOSITE** permanent, lasting, enduring

## evanescent ev-uh-**NES**-unt *adjective*




**MEANING** quickly fading from sight or memory

**MEMORY HOOK** **e-VANISH-ent: blink, and it is gone.** Each firefly glows for a moment, then vanishes into the dark before Zoe can point to it. Their light is **evanescent**.

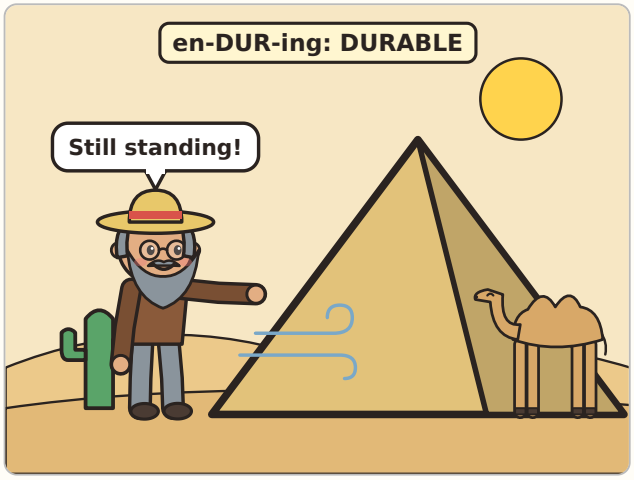
*The **evanescent** glow of the fireflies flickered across the meadow.*

**PARTS** **e** out (from ex) + **vanesc** vanish (Latin vanescere) + **-ent** being or doing (an adjective ending)

**SIMILAR** fading, vanishing, fleeting, ephemeral
**OPPOSITE** permanent, lasting, enduring



## enduring en-**DOOR**-ing *adjective*




**MEANING** lasting a long time

**MEMORY HOOK** **en-DUR-ing: as DURABLE as stone.** The great stone pyramid has stood through thousands of years of sun and sandstorms, and visitors still come to see it. It is **enduring**.

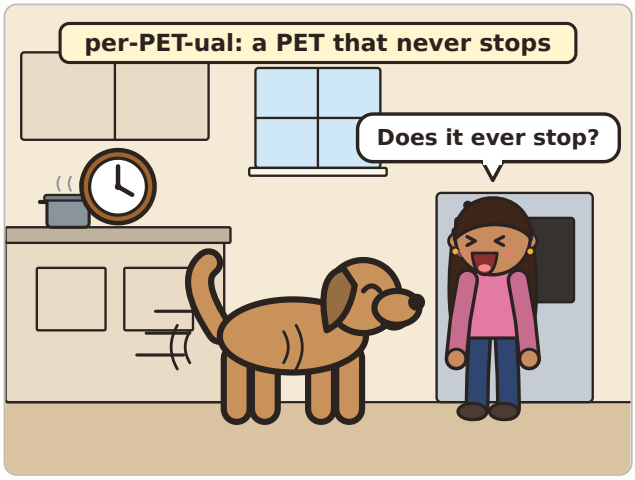
*Their **enduring** friendship began in kindergarten and is still going strong.*

**PARTS** **en** in, thoroughly + **dur** hard, lasting (Latin durus)

**SIMILAR** lasting, long-lived, abiding, durable
**OPPOSITE** fleeting, short-lived, transient



## perpetual per-**PECH**-oo-ul *adjective*




**MEANING** never ending or changing; constant

**MEMORY HOOK** **per-PET-ual: a PET whose tail never stops.** Biscuit the dog wags his tail morning, noon and night; even in his sleep it thumps. His wagging is **perpetual**.

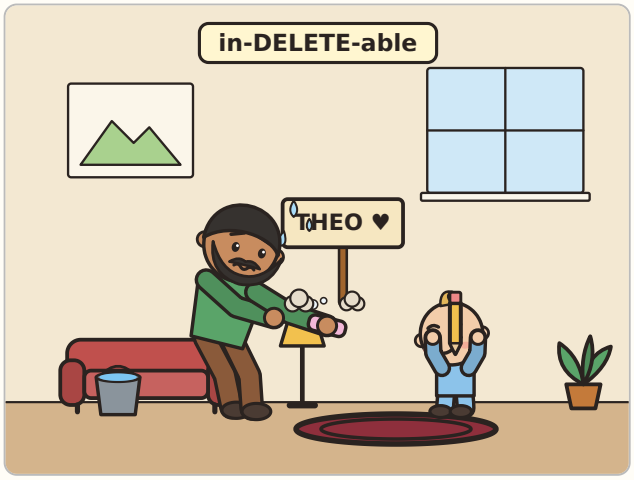
*The **perpetual** drip of the leaky faucet kept Felix awake all night.*

**PARTS** **per** through

**SIMILAR** endless, constant, unending, everlasting
**OPPOSITE** temporary, brief, intermittent



## indelible in-**DEL**-uh-bul *adjective*




**MEANING** impossible to erase, remove or forget

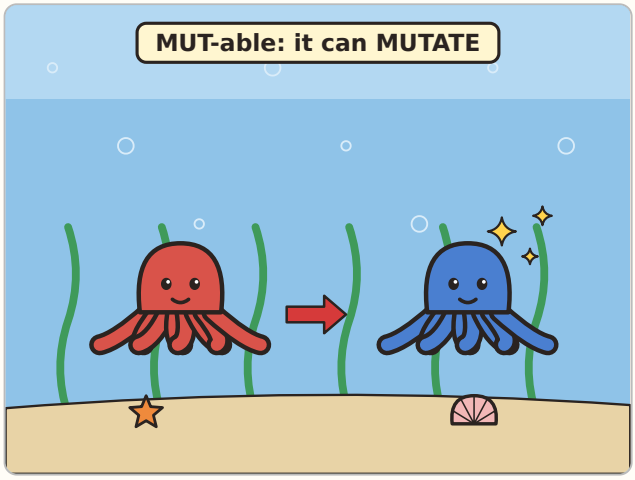
**MEMORY HOOK** **in-DELETE-able: you can't DELETE it.** Theo's marker drawing won't wash off the wall, no matter how hard Dad scrubs: you can't delete it. The ink is **indelible**.

*Theo drew on the wall with **indelible** marker, and no amount of scrubbing helped.*

**PARTS** **in** not + **del** wipe out (Latin delere) + **-ible** able to be

**SIMILAR** permanent, lasting, unforgettable, ineradicable
**OPPOSITE** erasable, temporary, fleeting

## mutable MYOO-tuh-bul *adjective*




**MEANING** able or likely to change

**MEMORY HOOK** **MUT = MUTATE: able to change.** The octopus turns red, then blue, then sandy brown to match whatever it touches. A creature that changes that easily is **mutable**.

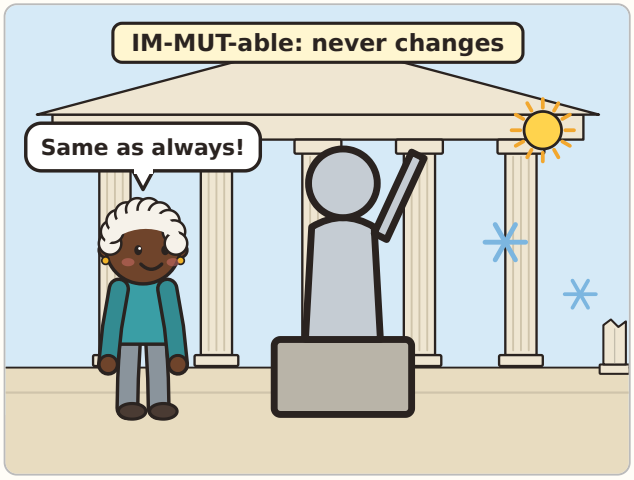
*Spring weather is* **mutable***: sunshine at noon, hail by three.*

**PARTS** **mut** change (Latin mutare) + **-able** able to be

**SIMILAR** changeable, variable, alterable, fluid
**OPPOSITE** immutable, fixed, constant



## immutable ih-MYOO-tuh-bul *adjective*




**MEANING** never changing; unable to be changed

**MEMORY HOOK** **IM-MUT-able: the statue never changes.** Sun, snow, rain or wind, the old stone statue in the square keeps the very same pose year after year. It is **immutable**.

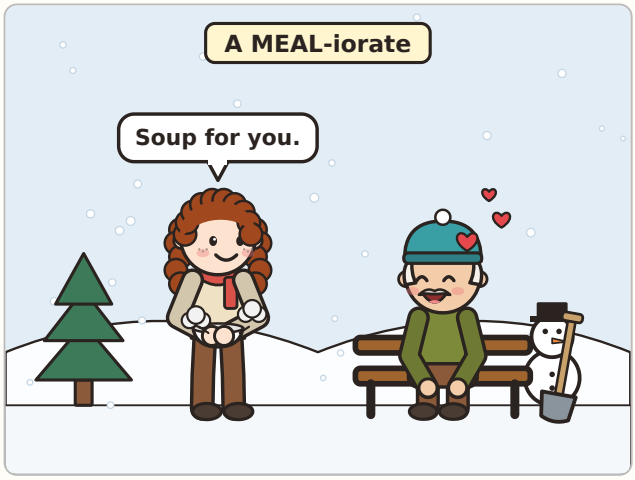
*For Grandma, Sunday dinner at five o'clock was an* **immutable** *rule.*

**PARTS** **im** not (in- before m) + **mut** change + **-able** able to be

**SIMILAR** unchangeable, fixed, permanent, constant
**OPPOSITE** mutable, changeable, variable



## ameliorate uh-MEEL-yuh-rayt *verb*




**MEANING** to make a bad situation better

**MEMORY HOOK** **A MEAL-iorate: a MEAL makes it better.** Grandpa Gus is cold, tired and cranky after shoveling, until Nell brings him a hot bowl of soup. A good meal can **ameliorate** a gloomy afternoon.

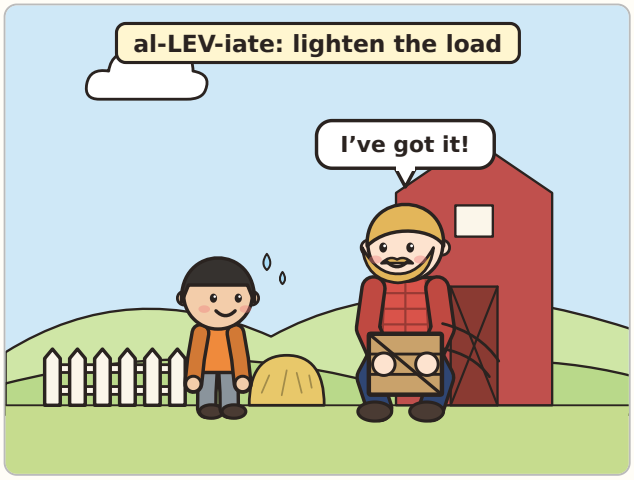
*New streetlights helped* **ameliorate** *the problem of dark, lonely corners.*

**PARTS** **a** to (from ad) + **melior** better (Latin melior) + **-ate** to make

**SIMILAR** improve, better, ease, relieve
**OPPOSITE** worsen, aggravate, exacerbate



## alleviate uh-LEE-vee-ayt *verb*




**MEANING** to make pain or trouble easier to bear

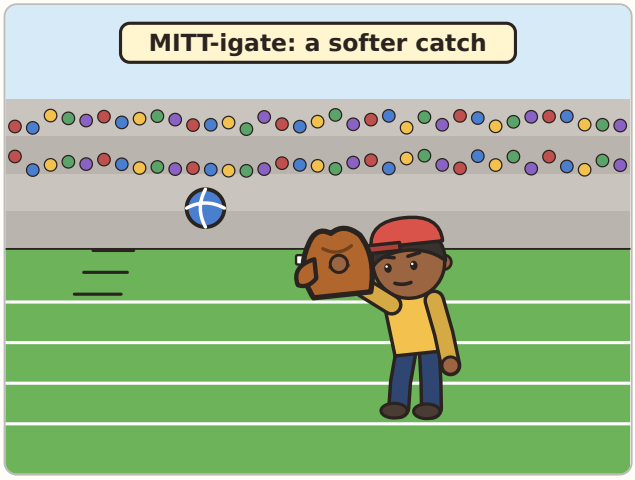
**MEMORY HOOK** **al-LEV-iate: LIGHTEN the load.** Kai staggers under a heavy crate until Sven lifts it onto his own broad shoulders. Taking some of the weight is a way to **alleviate** a burden.

*An extra checkout lane helped* **alleviate** *the long lines at the store.*

**PARTS** **al** to (from ad) + **lev** light (not heavy), lift + **-iate** to make

**SIMILAR** ease, relieve, lessen, lighten
**OPPOSITE** aggravate, worsen, intensify

## mitigate **MIT**-ih-gayt *verb*




**MEANING** to make less severe or harmful

**MEMORY HOOK** **MITT-igate: a big MITT softens the blow.** A fast ball stings a bare hand, but a thick padded mitt softens the catch. The mitt helps **mitigate** the sting.

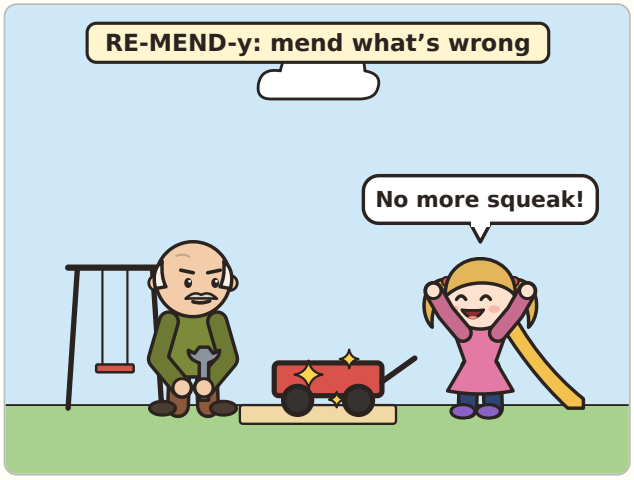
*Planting trees along the river helped* **mitigate** *the spring floods.*

**PARTS** **mitig** soft, mild (Latin mitis) + **-ate** to make

**SIMILAR** lessen, reduce, soften, ease
**OPPOSITE** worsen, intensify, aggravate



## remedy **REM**-ih-dee *verb*




**MEANING** to fix or correct something that is wrong

**MEMORY HOOK** **RE-MEND-y: MEND what's wrong.** The wagon wheel squeaks and wobbles until Grandpa Gus mends it with a wrench and a drop of oil. To mend what's wrong is to **remedy** it.

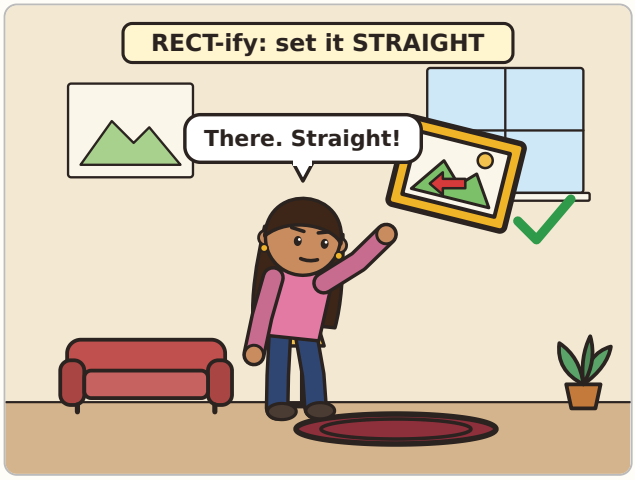
*The mechanic* **remedied** *the squeak with a single drop of oil.*

**PARTS** **re** back, again + **med** heal (Latin mederi)

**SIMILAR** fix, correct, repair, cure
**OPPOSITE** worsen, aggravate



## rectify **REK**-tuh-fye *verb*




**MEANING** to put right; to correct

**MEMORY HOOK** **RECT = straight, as in RECTangle.** The family photo hangs crooked, so Priya nudges it until every corner is square, like a rectangle. To set something straight is to **rectify** it.

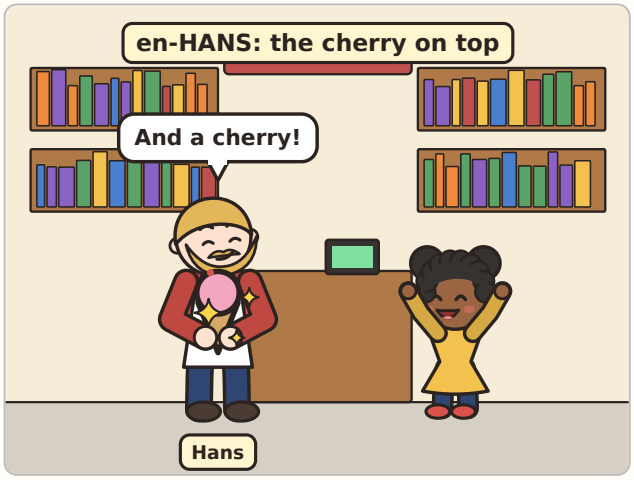
*The store* **rectified** *its mistake by refunding the extra charge.*

**PARTS** **rect** straight, right + **-ify** to make

**SIMILAR** correct, fix, put right, amend
**OPPOSITE** worsen



## enhance en-**HANS** *verb*



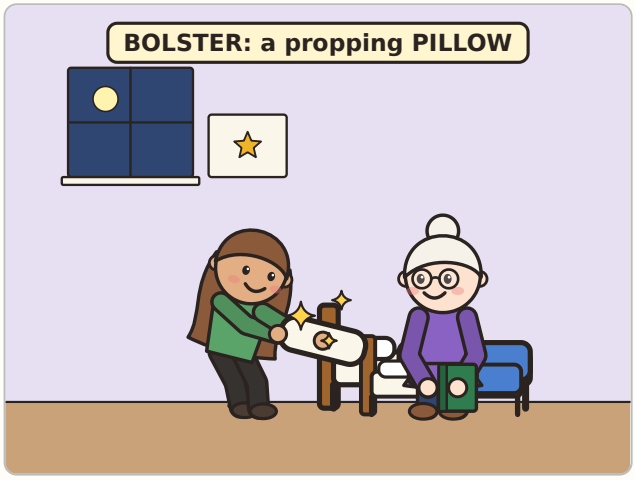

**MEANING** to improve the quality, value or appeal of

**MEMORY HOOK** **en-HANS: Hans adds the cherry on top.** The sundae is already good, but Hans adds whipped cream and a cherry on top. Little touches like that **enhance** it.

*A pinch of salt will* **enhance** *the sweetness of the caramel.*

**SIMILAR** improve, boost, heighten, strengthen
**OPPOSITE** diminish, reduce, worsen

## bolster **BOHL**-ster *verb*




**MEANING** to support or strengthen

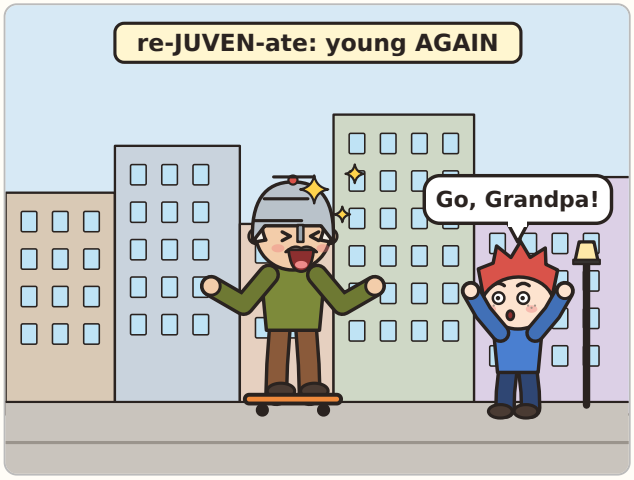
**MEMORY HOOK** **a BOLSTER is a propping PILLOW.** Granny Mae keeps slumping on the bed until Rosa props her up with a long, firm pillow called a bolster. To prop up and support something is to **bolster** it.

*Winning the first game* **bolstered** *the team's confidence.*

**SIMILAR** strengthen, support, reinforce, boost
**OPPOSITE** weaken, undermine



## rejuvenate rih-**JOO**-vuh-nayt *verb*




**MEANING** to make young, fresh or lively again

**MEMORY HOOK** **re-JUVEN-ate: JUVENILE again.** Grandpa Gus borrows Pip's skateboard and rolls down the sidewalk laughing like a ten-year-old. The ride seems to **rejuvenate** him.

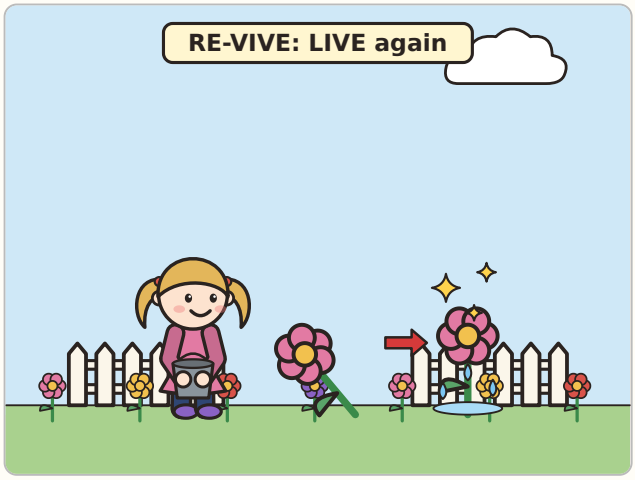
*A week at the lake* **rejuvenated** *the whole family.*

**PARTS** **re** again + **juven** young (Latin juvenis) + **-ate** to make

**SIMILAR** refresh, renew, revitalize, restore
**OPPOSITE** age, exhaust, drain



## revive rih-**VIVE** *verb*




**MEANING** to bring back to life, strength or use

**MEMORY HOOK** **RE-VIVE: make it LIVE again.** The droopy flowers perk right up after Ivy gives them a long drink: they live again! Water can **revive** a wilted plant.

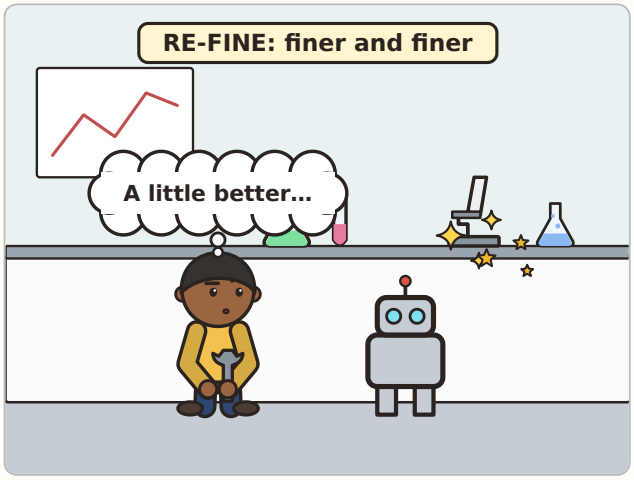
*A bucket of water* **revived** *the wilted tomato plants.*

**PARTS** **re** again + **viv** live, life

**SIMILAR** restore, renew, bring back, resuscitate
**OPPOSITE** extinguish, abandon



## refine rih-**FINE** *verb*




**MEANING** to improve by making small changes; also, to purify

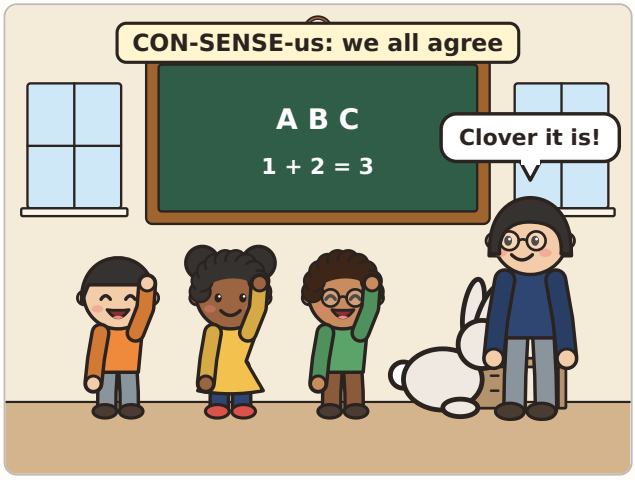
**MEMORY HOOK** **RE-FINE: fine, then FINER.** Dev's robot rolls, but it wobbles. He tightens one gear, then another, making it a little finer each time. Little by little, he will **refine** it.

*Lila* **refined** *her essay through five careful drafts.*

**PARTS** **re** again + **fine** fine, pure

**SIMILAR** polish, perfect, improve, hone
**OPPOSITE** coarsen, worsen

## consensus kun-**SEN**-sus *noun*




**MEANING** general agreement among a group

**MEMORY HOOK** **CON-SENSE-us: we all SENSE the same.** The class votes on a name for the new bunny, and almost every hand goes up for “Clover.” When nearly everyone senses the same, the group has a **consensus**.

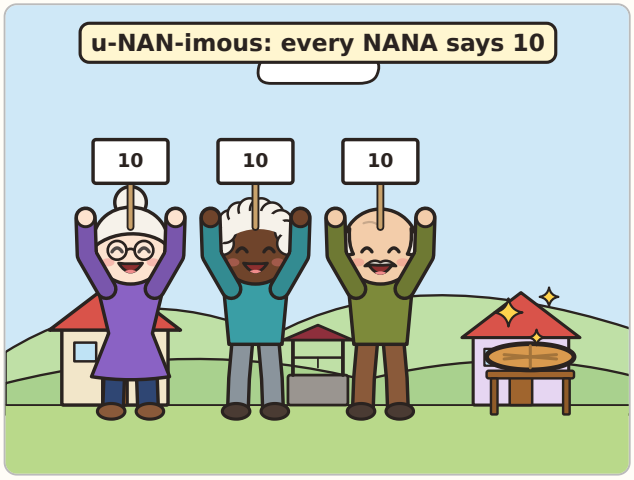
*After a long debate, the club reached a* **consensus** *: pizza on Fridays.*

**PARTS** **con** together + **sens** feel, think

**SIMILAR** agreement, accord, harmony, unity
**OPPOSITE** disagreement, dissent, discord



## unanimous yoo-**NAN**-uh-mus *adjective*




**MEANING** agreed on by everyone

**MEMORY HOOK** **u-NAN-imous: every NANA votes 10.** Nana Mae, Nana Lou and Grandpa Gus judge the pie contest, and all three hold up a perfect 10 for the cherry pie. Every vote the same: the decision is **unanimous**.

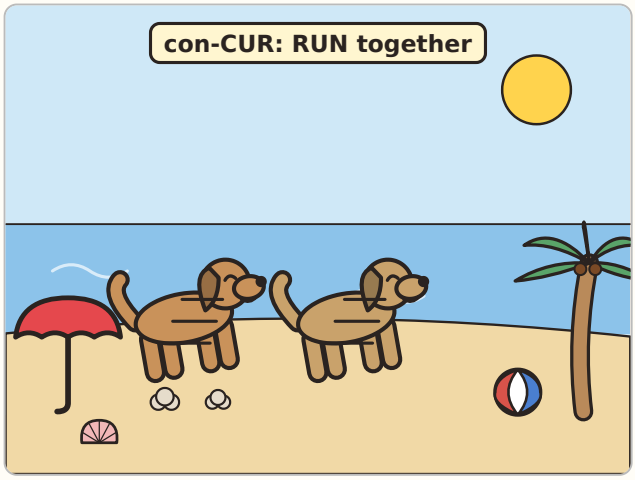
*The vote was* **unanimous** *: all twelve players wanted the blue jerseys.*

**PARTS** **un** one (Latin unus) + **anim** mind, spirit + **-ous** having

**SIMILAR** united, undivided, of one mind
**OPPOSITE** divided, split



## concur kun-**KUR** *verb*




**MEANING** to agree

**MEMORY HOOK** **con-CUR: minds that RUN together.** Two dogs spot the same ball and race for it side by side, of one mind. When two people’s thoughts run together like that, they **concur**.

*Both coaches* **concurred** *that the game should wait until the storm passed.*

**PARTS** **con** together + **cur** run

**SIMILAR** agree, assent, see eye to eye
**OPPOSITE** disagree, dissent, differ



## accord uh-**KORD** *noun*




**MEANING** agreement; harmony

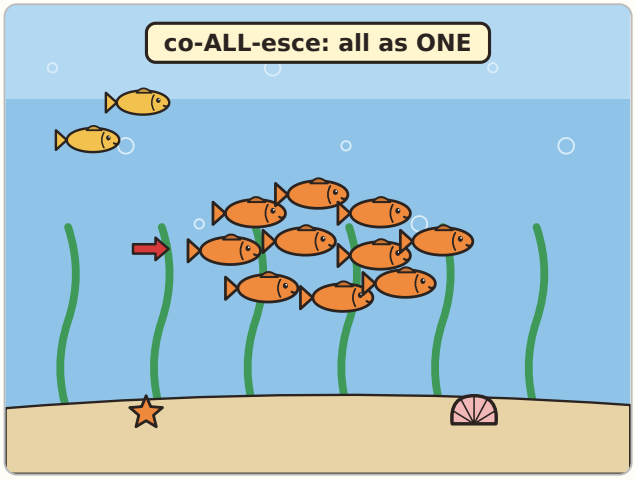
**MEMORY HOOK** **ac-CHORD: notes in harmony.** Lin plays three notes at once on the piano, and they sound lovely together: a chord. People who get along in harmony like that are in **accord**.

*The neighbors reached an* **accord** *about where to build the shared fence.*

**PARTS** **ac** to (from ad) + **cord** heart

**SIMILAR** agreement, harmony, pact, treaty
**OPPOSITE** discord, conflict, disagreement

## coalesce koh-uh-**LES** *verb*




**MEANING** to come together to form one whole

**MEMORY HOOK** **co-ALL-esce: ALL together as one.** Dozens of little fish swim closer and closer until they move like one big fish. When separate parts join into a single whole, they **coalesce**.

*Tiny raindrops* **coalesced** *into one fat drop at the edge of the roof.*

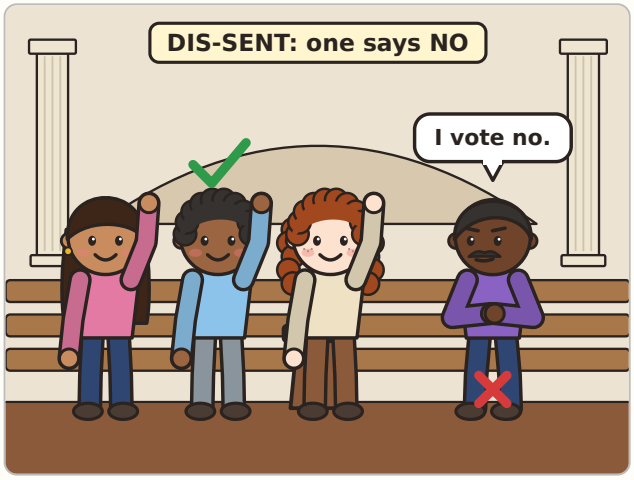
**PARTS** **co** together (from con) + **alesc** grow (Latin alescere)

**SIMILAR** merge, unite, combine, fuse

**OPPOSITE** separate, divide, split



## dissent dih-**SENT** *noun*




**MEANING** disagreement with an official or majority view

**MEMORY HOOK** **DIS-SENT: one vote SENT the other way.** Every hand goes up for the new rule except Marcus's; he sends his vote the other way and says why. His "no" is a **dissent**.

*Only one hand went up in* **dissent** *when the class voted for the zoo trip.*

**PARTS** **dis** apart + **sent** feel, think

**SIMILAR** disagreement, objection, opposition, protest

**OPPOSITE** agreement, consensus, assent



## discord **DIS**-kord *noun*




**MEANING** disagreement; a lack of harmony

**MEMORY HOOK** **DIS-CHORD: notes that clash.** Kai strums one song on the guitar while Lila plays a different one on the violin, and the dog howls. Sounds that clash, like people who clash, are in **discord**.

*A quarrel over the last pancake brought* **discord** *to the breakfast table.*

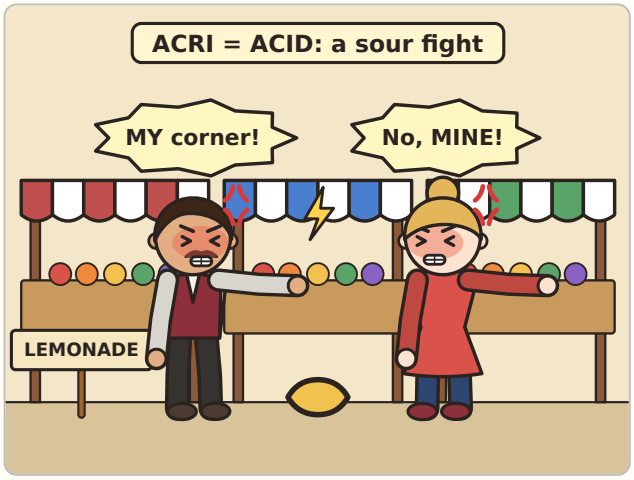
**PARTS** **dis** apart + **cord** heart

**SIMILAR** conflict, strife, friction, disharmony

**OPPOSITE** harmony, accord, agreement



## acrimonious ak-ruh-**MOH**-nee-us *adjective*




**MEANING** angry and bitter in tone

**MEMORY HOOK** **ACRI = ACID: a sour, bitter fight.** The two lemonade sellers argue over the best corner until their words turn as sour as acid. Their quarrel is **acrimonious**.

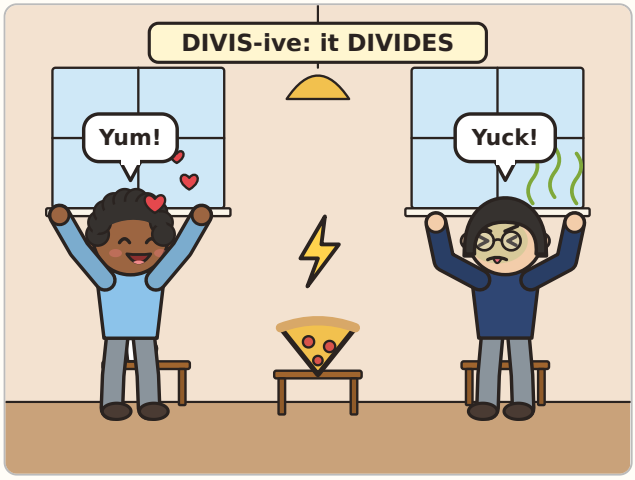
*The* **acrimonious** *argument over the parking space lasted twenty minutes.*

**PARTS** **acri** sharp, sour (Latin acer) + **-mony** the state of + **-ous** full of

**SIMILAR** bitter, hostile, angry, rancorous

**OPPOSITE** friendly, cordial, harmonious

## divisive dih-**VYE**-siv *adjective*




**MEANING** causing disagreement or splitting people into sides

**MEMORY HOOK** **DIVIS-ive: it DIVIDES the table.** Put a pineapple pizza on the table, and the family splits in two: half cheer, half groan. A topic that divides people is **divisive**.

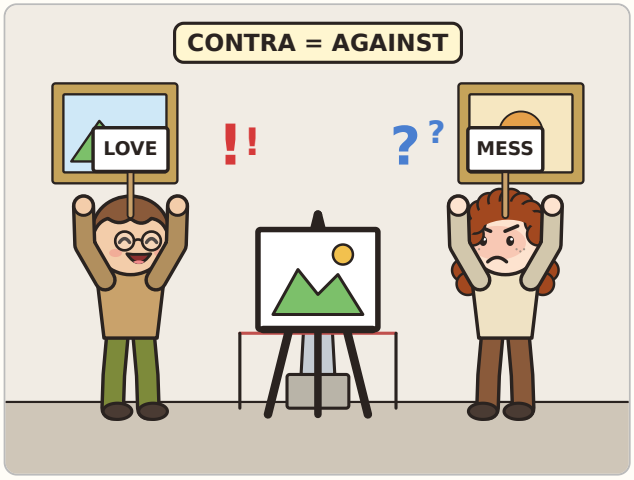
*Pineapple on pizza is a surprisingly* **divisive** *topic in our family.*

**PARTS** **divis** divided (Latin dividere) + **-ive** tending to

**SIMILAR** polarizing, controversial, contentious
**OPPOSITE** unifying, uniting



## controversy **KON**-truh-vur-see *noun*




**MEANING** a long public disagreement

**MEMORY HOOK** **CONTRA-VERSE: views turned AGAINST.** At the museum, half the crowd loves the new painting and half calls it a mess, and the argument goes on for weeks in public. Views turned against each other make a **controversy**.

*The new school mascot stirred up a* **controversy** *on the letters page of the local paper.*

**PARTS** **contro** against (from contra) + **vers** turn

**SIMILAR** dispute, debate, argument, quarrel
**OPPOSITE** agreement, consensus, accord



## abundant uh-**BUN**-dunt *adjective*




**MEANING** existing in large amounts; more than enough

**MEMORY HOOK** **a-BUN-dant: a BUN DANCE.** The baker made so many buns that they cover every shelf and table, and he does a happy bun dance. Buns are **abundant**.

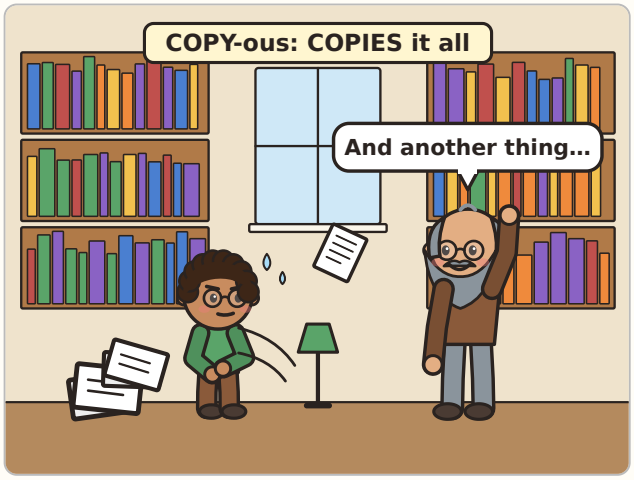
*Blackberries were* **abundant** *along the creek that summer.*

**PARTS** **ab** off, away + **und** wave (Latin unda) + **-ant** being or doing (an adjective ending)

**SIMILAR** plentiful, ample, bountiful, copious
**OPPOSITE** scarce, sparse, meager



## copious **KOH**-pee-us *adjective*




**MEANING** plentiful; in large amounts

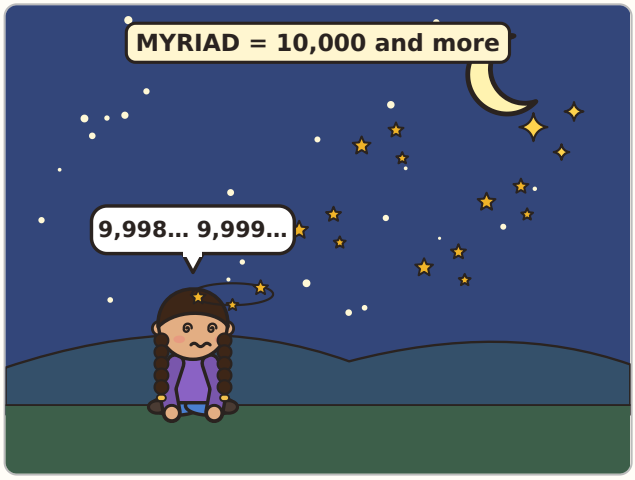
**MEMORY HOOK** **COPY-ous: he COPIES down everything.** Sami copies down every word the guide says, page after page after page. His notes are **copious**.

*Sami took* **copious** *notes on the museum tour, filling half his notebook.*

**PARTS** **copi** plenty (Latin copia) + **-ous** full of

**SIMILAR** plentiful, abundant, ample, profuse
**OPPOSITE** scant, meager, sparse

## myriad **MEER**-ee-ud *adjective*




**MEANING** countless; extremely many

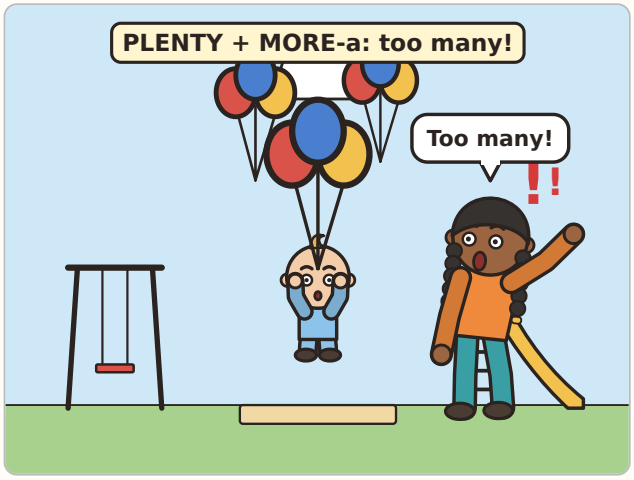
**MEMORY HOOK** **MYRIAD: Greek for TEN THOUSAND.** Lila tries to count the stars above the campsite and gives up after ten thousand. There are **myriad** stars.

*On a clear night in the desert,* **myriad** *stars fill the sky.*

**SIMILAR** countless, innumerable, numerous, untold
**OPPOSITE** few



## plethora **PLETH**-er-uh *noun*




**MEANING** too many; a great excess

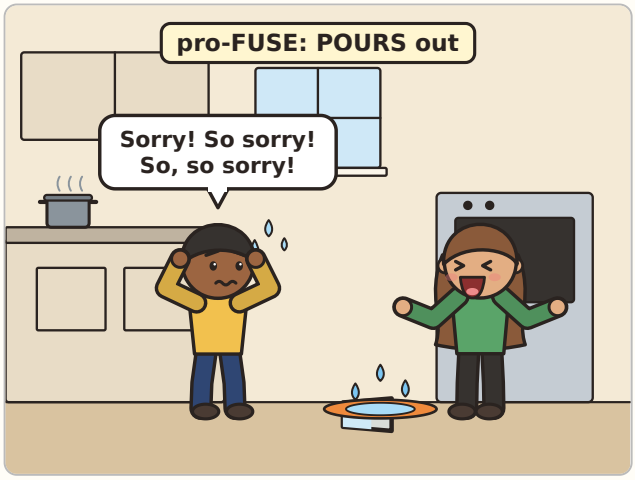
**MEMORY HOOK** **PLETH-ora: PLENTY and then MORE-a.** Theo asked for one balloon and got sixty, so many that his toes leave the ground. Sixty is a **plethora** of balloons.

*The new phone came with a* **plethora** *of settings that no one ever used.*

**SIMILAR** excess, glut, surplus, overabundance
**OPPOSITE** dearth, shortage, paucity



## profuse pruh-**FYOOS** *adjective*




**MEANING** pouring out in great amounts

**MEMORY HOOK** **pro-FUSE: FUS = POUR.** Dev knocks over the juice, and apologies pour out of him: “Sorry! So sorry! I’m so, so sorry!” His apologies are **profuse**.

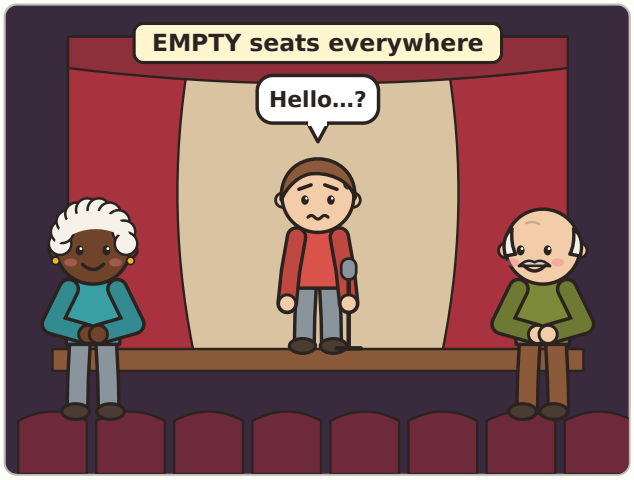
*The roses grew in* **profuse** *clusters, spilling over the fence onto the sidewalk.*

**PARTS** **pro** forth + **fus** poured (Latin fundere)

**SIMILAR** abundant, lavish, plentiful, copious
**OPPOSITE** scant, meager, sparse



## sparse **SPARSS** *adjective*




**MEANING** thinly scattered; few and far between

**MEMORY HOOK** **SPARSE: lots of SPARE seats.** On the night of the big storm, nearly every seat at Jonah’s concert is spare; just two fans sit far apart. The crowd is **sparse**.

*The desert’s* **sparse** *bushes offered little shade.*

**SIMILAR** scattered, thin, scanty, meager
**OPPOSITE** dense, thick, abundant

## scant SKANT *adjective*




**MEANING** barely enough; very little

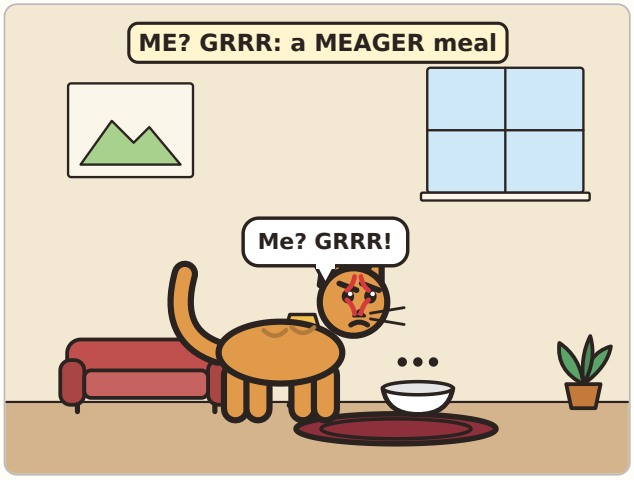
**MEMORY HOOK** **S-CAN'T: can't call that enough.** Zoe shakes the cereal box and gets five flakes and some dust. You can't call that breakfast: the cereal is **scant**.

*The recipe calls for a* **scant** *teaspoon of salt.*

**SIMILAR** little, limited, meager, insufficient
**OPPOSITE** ample, abundant, plentiful



## meager MEE-ger *adjective*




**MEANING** too small in amount or quality; skimpy

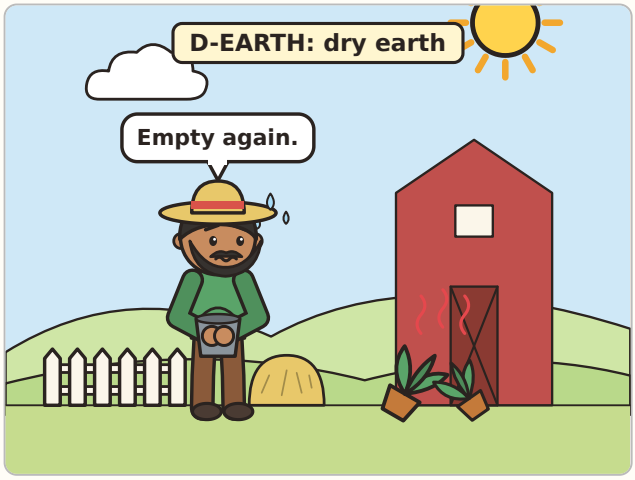
**MEMORY HOOK** **MEE-GRRR: "Is that all?".** The cat stares at the three tiny crumbs in its bowl and growls, "Me? Grrr! That's all?" Its dinner is **meager**.

*The hikers shared a* **meager** *lunch of two pears and a granola bar.*

**SIMILAR** scanty, paltry, skimpy, inadequate
**OPPOSITE** generous, ample, abundant



## dearth DURTH *noun*




**MEANING** a lack or shortage

**MEMORY HOOK** **D-EARTH: DRY EARTH.** No rain for months, and the field is nothing but dry, cracked earth. The dry earth shows a **dearth** of rain.

*There is a* **dearth** *of good pizza places in our small town.*

**SIMILAR** lack, shortage, scarcity, absence
**OPPOSITE** abundance, plenty, surplus



## paucity PAW-sih-tee *noun*



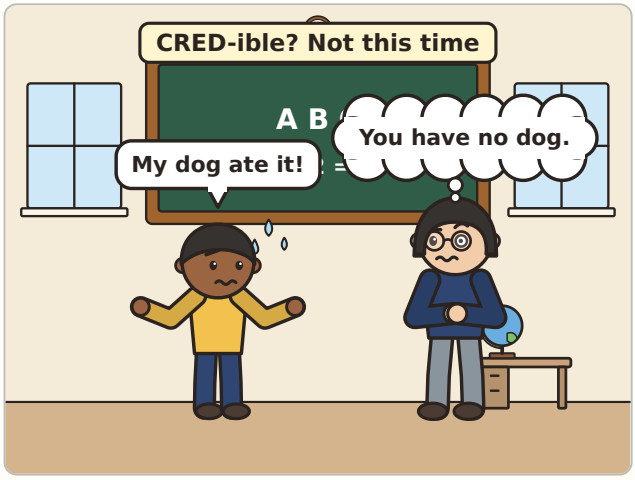

**MEANING** a very small amount; scarcity

**MEMORY HOOK** **PAW-CITY: hardly any PAWS.** Paw City built a giant dog park, and on opening day just one dog showed up. With so few paws, the park suffers a **paucity** of dogs.

*The report's* **paucity** *of facts made it hard to believe.*

**PARTS** **pauc** few (Latin paucus) + **-ity** the state of
**SIMILAR** scarcity, lack, shortage, dearth
**OPPOSITE** abundance, plethora, profusion

## credible **KRED**-uh-bul *adjective*




**MEANING** believable; worthy of trust

**MEMORY HOOK** **CRED-ible: can you give it CREDIT?.** Dev says the dog ate his homework, but Dev has no dog. His teacher gives the story no credit at all: it isn't **credible**.

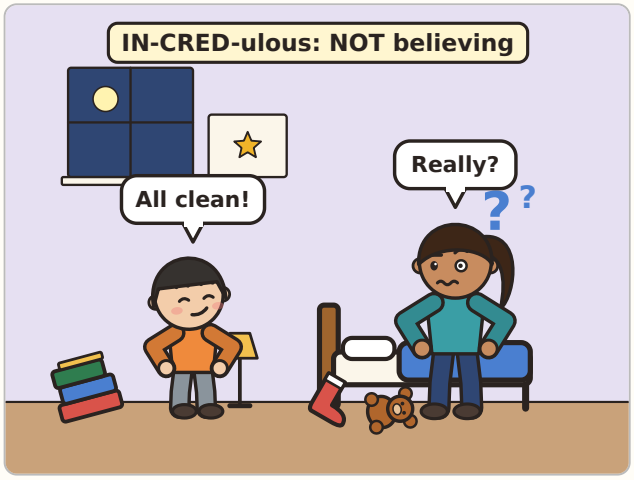
*Dev's excuse was hardly* **credible***: a dog ate his homework, and he has no dog.*

**PARTS** **cred** believe + **-ible** able to be

**SIMILAR** believable, plausible, convincing, trustworthy
**OPPOSITE** incredible, unbelievable, implausible



## incredulous in-**KREJ**-uh-lus *adjective*




**MEANING** unwilling or unable to believe something

**MEMORY HOOK** **IN-CRED-ulous: "I can't believe it!".** Kai says he cleaned his room, but Maya can see socks on the floor and books on the bed. Her raised eyebrows are **incredulous**.

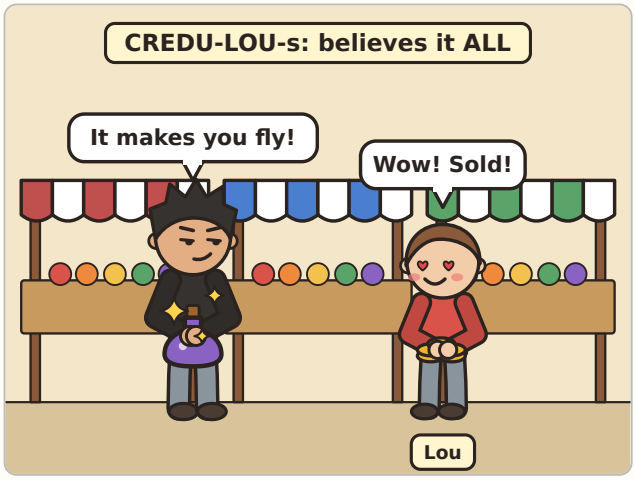
*Maya gave an* **incredulous** *laugh when her little brother said he had cleaned his room.*

**PARTS** **in** not + **cred** believe + **-ulous** inclined to

**SIMILAR** disbelieving, doubtful, skeptical, unconvinced
**OPPOSITE** credulous, believing, trusting



## credulous **KREJ**-uh-lus *adjective*




**MEANING** too ready to believe things; easily fooled

**MEMORY HOOK** **CREDU-LOU-s: Lou believes ANYTHING.** Rex sells young Lou a "flying potion," and Lou pays him on the spot without a single question. Lou believes anything: he is **credulous**.

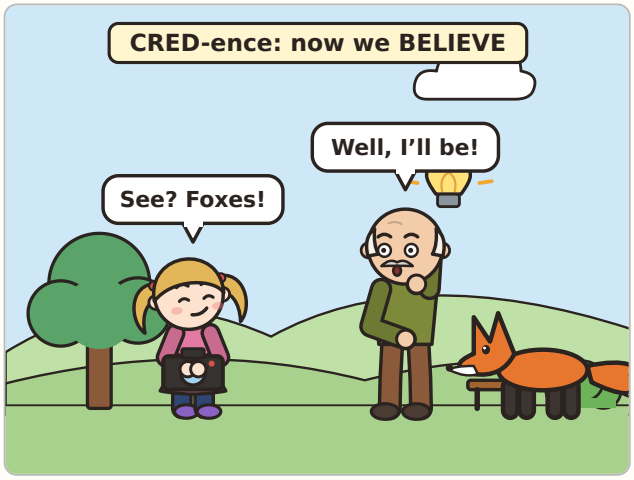
*The* **credulous** *tourist paid ten dollars for a "real" moon rock.*

**PARTS** **cred** believe + **-ulous** inclined to

**SIMILAR** gullible, naive, trusting, unsuspecting
**OPPOSITE** skeptical, incredulous, suspicious



## credence **KREED**-uns *noun*




**MEANING** belief or acceptance that something is true

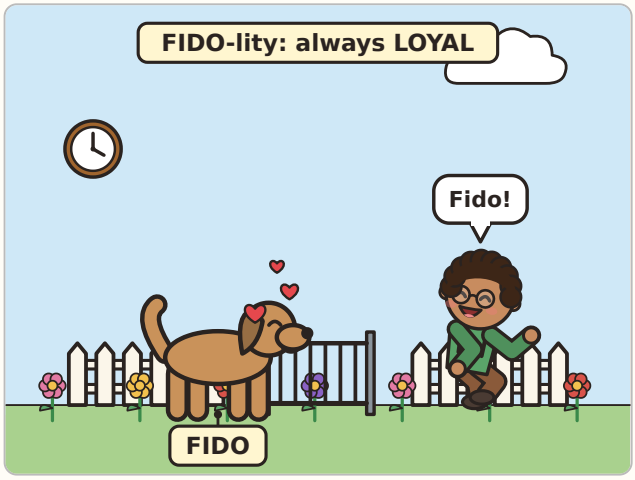
**MEMORY HOOK** **CRED-ence: give it CREDIT, believe it.** Nobody believed Ivy's story about a fox family in the park, until she showed her photos. The pictures lend **credence** to her story.

*Nobody gave much* **credence** *to the rumor that school would close for a month.*

**PARTS** **cred** believe + **-ence** the state of

**SIMILAR** belief, acceptance, trust, faith
**OPPOSITE** disbelief, doubt, skepticism

## fidelity fih-**DEL**-ih-tee *noun*




**MEANING** faithfulness and loyalty; also, accuracy

**MEMORY HOOK** **FIDO-lity: loyal as a dog named FIDO.** Every afternoon at three, Fido waits at the gate for Sami to come home from school, rain or shine. Fido's **fidelity** never wavers.

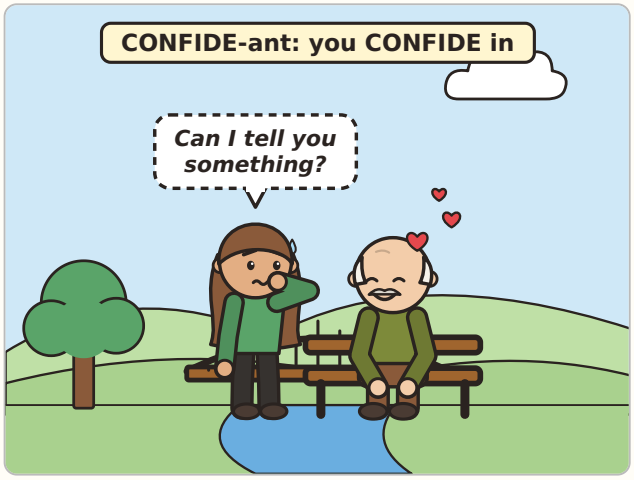
*The old dog's* **fidelity** *was famous: he waited at the gate every afternoon for his boy.*

**PARTS** **fid** trust, faith + **-ity** the quality of

**SIMILAR** loyalty, faithfulness, devotion, accuracy
**OPPOSITE** disloyalty, betrayal, inaccuracy



## confidant **KON**-fih-dahnt *noun*




**MEANING** a trusted friend you can share secrets with

**MEMORY HOOK** **CONFIDE-ANT: the one you CONFIDE in.** Rosa confides her biggest worries to Grandpa Gus on the park bench, and he never tells a soul. The person you confide in is your **confidant**.

*Grandpa was Rosa's* **confidant**; *she told him things she told no one else.*

**PARTS** **con** thoroughly + **fid** trust

**SIMILAR** close friend, trusted friend, intimate



## diffident **DIF**-ih-dunt *adjective*




**MEANING** shy and lacking confidence in oneself

**MEMORY HOOK** **DIF-fident: the opposite of conFIDENT.** Lin sings beautifully, but she hides behind the curtain and lets someone else take the solo. She is the opposite of confident: **diffident**.

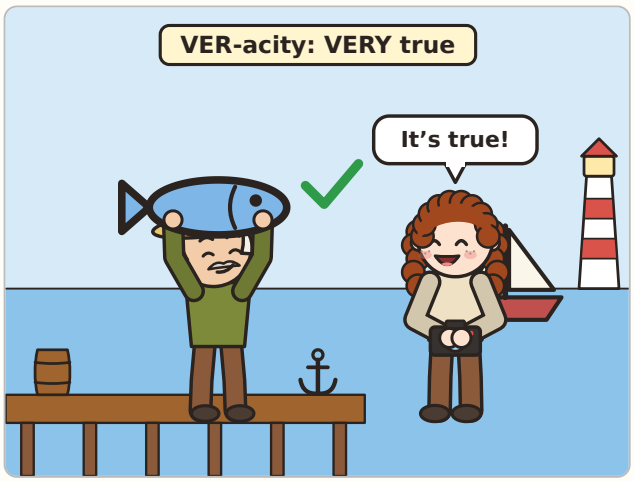
*The* **diffident** *new student spoke so softly that the teacher asked her to repeat her name.*

**PARTS** **dif** not (from dis) + **fid** trust + **-ent** being or doing (an adjective ending)

**SIMILAR** shy, timid, bashful, self-doubting
**OPPOSITE** confident, self-assured, bold



## veracity vuh-**RAS**-ih-tee *noun*




**MEANING** truthfulness; accuracy

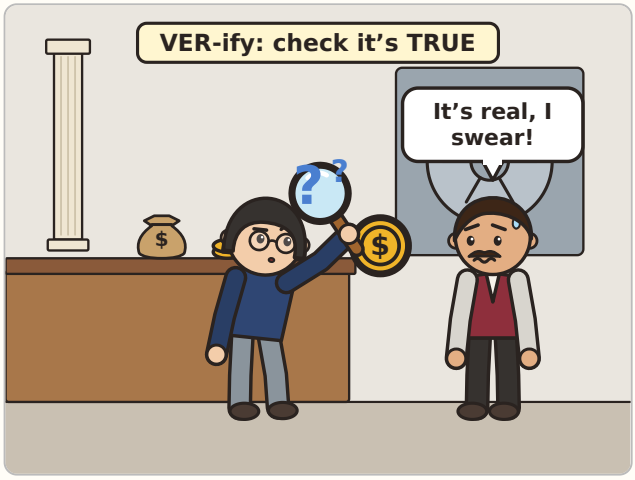
**MEMORY HOOK** **VER-acity: VERY true.** Grandpa Gus swears he caught a fish as long as his arm, and this time the photo proves every word. The **veracity** of his story is beyond doubt.

*No one doubted the* **veracity** *of Nana's story; she had the photos to prove it.*

**PARTS** **ver** true + **-acity** the quality of

**SIMILAR** truthfulness, accuracy, honesty, truth
**OPPOSITE** falsehood, dishonesty, inaccuracy

## verify VAIR-uh-fye *verb*




**MEANING** to check or prove that something is true

**MEMORY HOOK** **VER-ify: make sure it's VERY true.** Before she buys the old coin, Ada studies it under her magnifying glass, front and back. She wants to **verify** that it is real gold.

*Please **verify** your address before you click send.*

**PARTS** **ver** true + **-ify** to make

**SIMILAR** confirm, check, prove, validate
**OPPOSITE** disprove, refute



## verdict VUR-dikt *noun*




**MEANING** a decision or judgment, especially a jury's

**MEMORY HOOK** **VER + DICT = TRUE + SAID.** In the case of the missing cake, the jury says what it truly believes: "Not guilty!" The dog wags happily at the **verdict**.

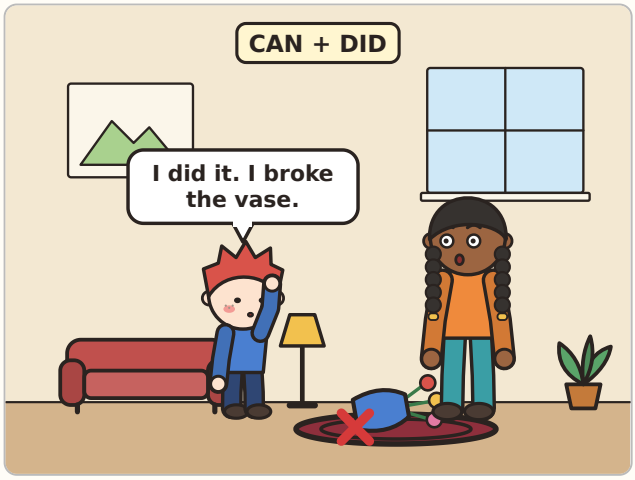
*After one bite, Grandpa gave his **verdict**: the best chili he had ever tasted.*

**PARTS** **ver** true + **dict** say, speak

**SIMILAR** judgment, decision, ruling, finding



## candid KAN-did *adjective*




**MEANING** open and honest in what one says

**MEMORY HOOK** **CAN + DID: I CAN tell what I DID.** "I did it. I broke the vase," says Pip, before anyone even asks. He can tell what he did: he is **candid**.

*In a **candid** interview, the coach admitted the team had played badly.*

**SIMILAR** frank, honest, open, forthright
**OPPOSITE** guarded, evasive, deceitful



## frank FRANK *adjective*



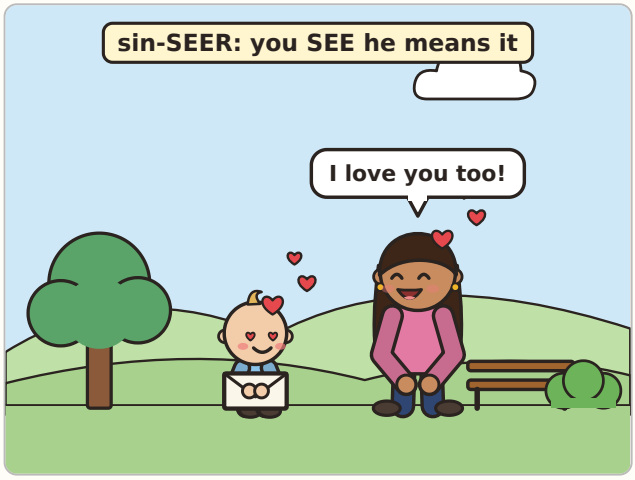

**MEANING** direct and honest, even when it is uncomfortable

**MEMORY HOOK** **FRANK: straight as a PLANK.** Nana Lou tastes the soup and gives it to you straight as a plank: "Needs salt. Lots of salt." No sugarcoating: she is **frank**.

*Dad was **frank** with us: the car needed repairs, and the trip would have to wait.*

**SIMILAR** blunt, direct, candid, outspoken
**OPPOSITE** evasive, guarded, indirect

## sincere sin-**SEER** *adjective*




**MEANING** meaning what one says; free of pretense

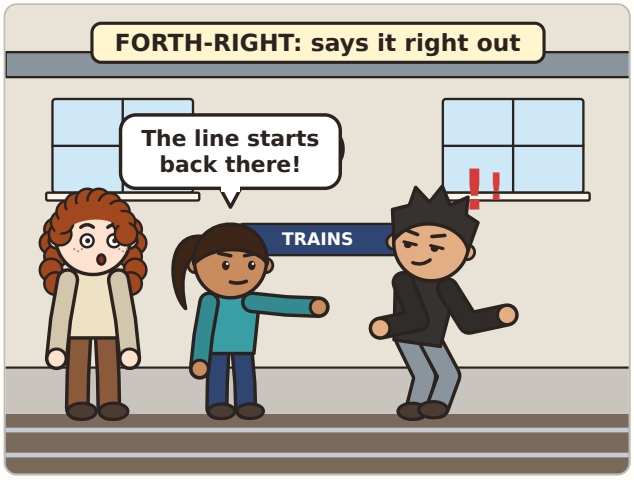
**MEMORY HOOK** **sin-SEER: you can SEE he means it.** Theo hands Mom a crumpled crayon card that says "I LUV U," and she can see he means every word. His card is **sincere**.

*Her apology was* **sincere***; she had tears in her eyes.*

**SIMILAR** heartfelt, honest, earnest, wholehearted
**OPPOSITE** insincere, false, fake



## forthright **FORTH**-rite *adjective*




**MEANING** direct and outspoken; saying plainly what one thinks

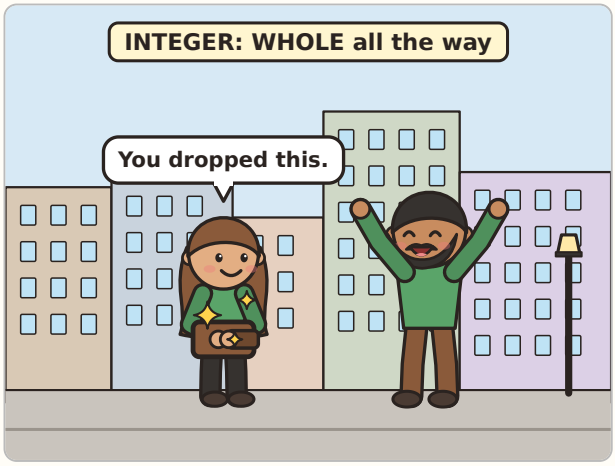
**MEMORY HOOK** **FORTH-RIGHT: steps FORTH, says it RIGHT.** When Rex cuts into the ticket line, Maya steps forth and says it right out: "That's not fair. The line starts back there." She is **forthright**.

*The* **forthright** *referee explained exactly why the goal did not count.*

**PARTS** **forth** forward + **right** straight
**SIMILAR** direct, frank, outspoken, plainspoken
**OPPOSITE** evasive, indirect, devious



## integrity in-**TEG**-rih-tee *noun*




**MEANING** the quality of being honest and having strong moral principles

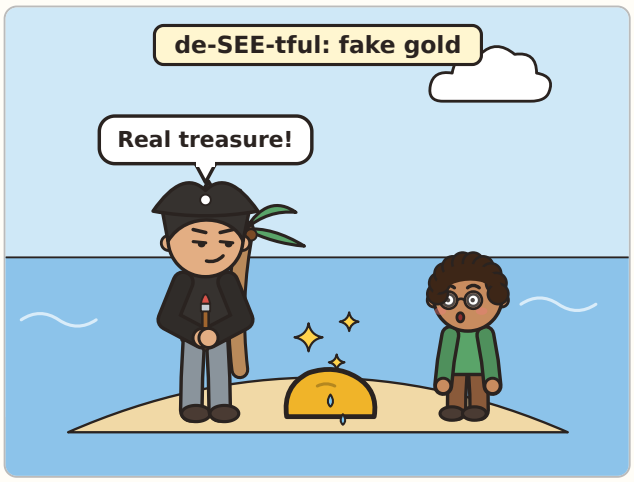
**MEMORY HOOK** **INTEGER = WHOLE: honest all through.** Like a whole number, Rosa is honest all the way through: she finds a wallet full of cash and returns every dollar to its owner. She has **integrity**.

*A person of* **integrity** *keeps a promise even when no one would ever find out.*

**PARTS** **integr** whole, untouched (Latin integer) + **-ity** the quality of
**SIMILAR** honesty, honor, uprightness, principle
**OPPOSITE** dishonesty, corruption, deceit



## deceitful dih-**SEET**-ful *adjective*



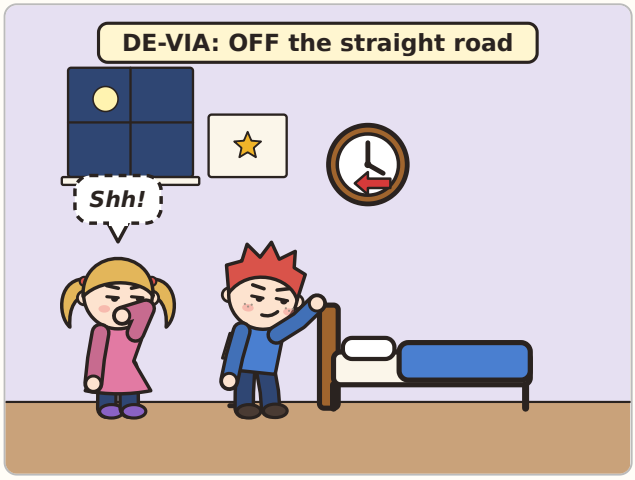

**MEANING** trying to make others believe what is false

**MEMORY HOOK** **de-SEE-tful: you SEE what isn't there.** Rex paints a plain rock gold and tells the tourists it is pirate treasure. Making people see what isn't there is **deceitful**.

*The* **deceitful** *player pretended to be hurt so the referee would call a foul.*

**SIMILAR** dishonest, lying, deceptive, false
**OPPOSITE** honest, truthful, candid

## devious **DEE**-vee-us *adjective*




**MEANING** sly and tricky in getting one's way

**MEMORY HOOK** **DE-VIA: OFF the straight road.** Instead of asking for a later bedtime, Pip and Ivy take the sneaky road: they tiptoe in and turn the clock back an hour. That trick is **devious**.

*The cat came up with a* **devious** *plan to reach the fish tank.*

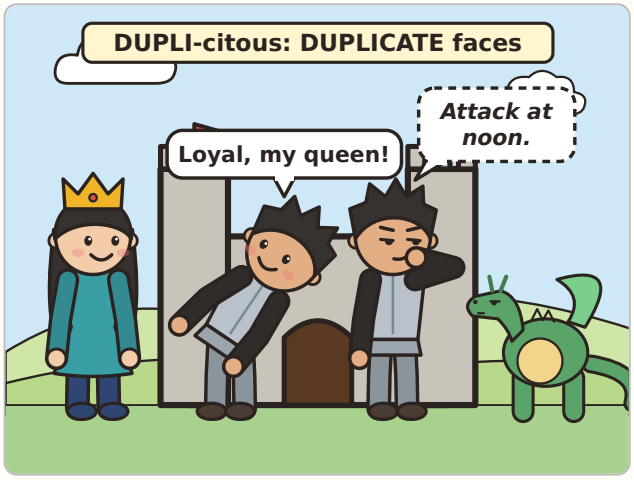
**PARTS** **de** away from + **vi** way, road (Latin via) + **-ous** full of

**SIMILAR** sly, sneaky, scheming, cunning

**OPPOSITE** honest, direct, forthright



## duplicitous doo-**PLIS**-ih-tus *adjective*




**MEANING** two-faced; saying one thing and doing another

**MEMORY HOOK** **DUPLI-citous: a DUPLICATE face.** Rex smiles at the queen, "I'm your loyal knight!", then turns around and whispers plans to the dragon. Two faces, like a duplicate: he is **duplicitous**.

*The* **duplicitous** *spy smiled at both sides while secretly working for neither.*

**PARTS** **dupl** double (Latin duplex) + **-ous** full of

**SIMILAR** double-dealing, two-faced, deceitful, treacherous

**OPPOSITE** honest, sincere, aboveboard



## disingenuous dis-in-**JEN**-yoo-us *adjective*




**MEANING** insincere; pretending to be more innocent or less informed than one is

**MEMORY HOOK** **DIS-INGENUOUS: fake innocence.** "What cookies?" asks Dev, wide-eyed, with chocolate all over his chin and an empty jar behind him. Pretending to be innocent like that is **disingenuous**.

*It was* **disingenuous** *of Dev to ask "What cookies?" with chocolate on his chin.*

**PARTS** **dis** not + **ingenu** innocent, frank (Latin ingenuus) + **-ous** full of

**SIMILAR** insincere, misleading, feigned, hypocritical

**OPPOSITE** sincere, candid, honest



## guileless **GYLE**-lis *adjective*




**MEANING** innocent and without tricks; open and honest

**MEMORY HOOK** **GUILE-LESS: no tricks at all.** Theo plays cards holding his hand face out so everyone can see it: no tricks, no secrets, no bluffing. He is **guileless**.

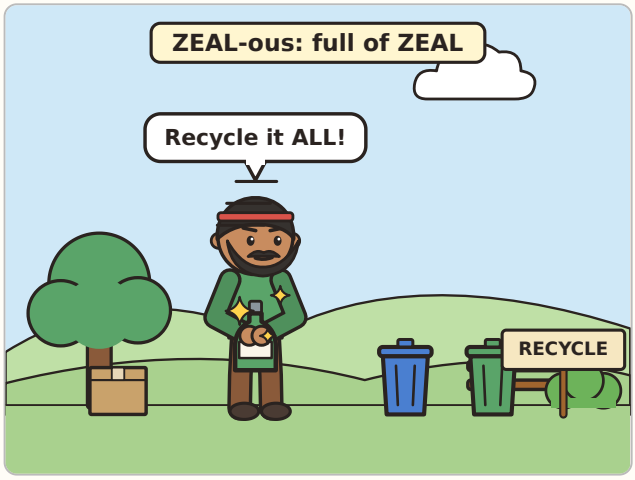
*The puppy's* **guileless** *eyes made it impossible to stay angry.*

**PARTS** **guile** sly trickery + **-less** without

**SIMILAR** innocent, naive, artless, trusting

**OPPOSITE** sly, cunning, devious

## zealous ZEL-us *adjective*




**MEANING** full of eager devotion to a cause or task

**MEMORY HOOK** **ZEAL-ous: full of ZEAL, A to Z.** Omar sorts every can, bottle and scrap of paper into the right bin and cheers each one in. His zeal for recycling makes him **zealous**.

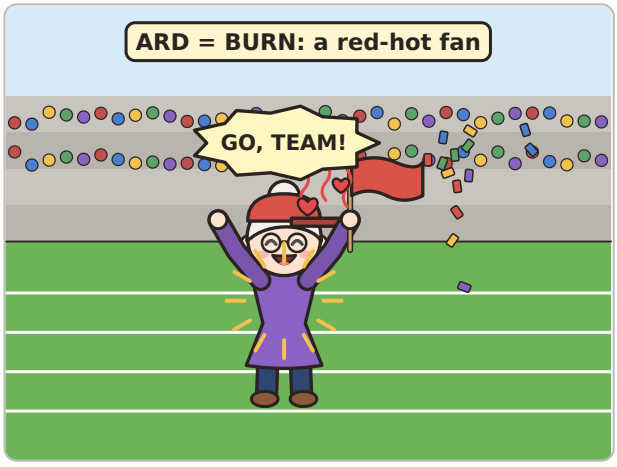
*The **zealous** volunteers cleaned the whole beach before breakfast.*

**PARTS** **zeal** eager devotion (Greek zelos) + **-ous** full of

**SIMILAR** devoted, passionate, fervent, enthusiastic
**OPPOSITE** apathetic, indifferent, halfhearted



## ardent AHR-dunt *adjective*




**MEANING** passionate and enthusiastic

**MEMORY HOOK** **ARD = BURN: a red-hot fan.** Granny Mae has cheered for the home team for forty years, and her love still burns hot: cap, flag and a voice you can hear in the parking lot. She is an **ardent** fan.

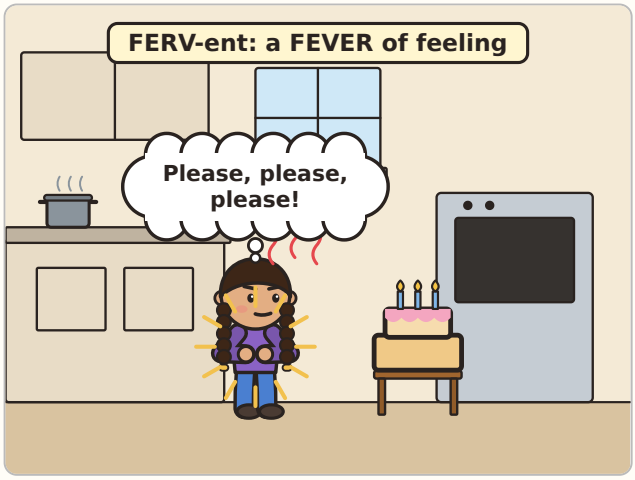
*Grandma is an **ardent** baseball fan; she has not missed a home game in forty years.*

**PARTS** **ard** burn (Latin ardere) + **-ent** being or doing (an adjective ending)

**SIMILAR** passionate, fervent, devoted, enthusiastic
**OPPOSITE** indifferent, apathetic, lukewarm



## fervent FUR-vunt *adjective*




**MEANING** showing strong, warm feeling

**MEMORY HOOK** **FERV-ent: a FEVER of feeling.** Lila squeezes her eyes shut and wishes so hard over her birthday candles that she glows as if she had a fever. Her wish is **fervent**.

*Lila made a **fervent** wish as she blew out the candles.*

**PARTS** **ferv** boil, glow (Latin fervere) + **-ent** being or doing (an adjective ending)

**SIMILAR** passionate, intense, heartfelt, ardent
**OPPOSITE** halfhearted, cool, indifferent



## avid AV-id *adjective*




**MEANING** very eager and enthusiastic

**MEMORY HOOK** **AV-id: "I have to HAVE it!".** The moment the new book arrives, Zoe grabs it: "I have to have it!" She has read it twice by Sunday. She is an **avid** reader.

*Zoe is an **avid** reader who finishes a book every two days.*

**PARTS** **av** crave (Latin avere) + **-id** having the quality of

**SIMILAR** eager, keen, enthusiastic, passionate
**OPPOSITE** indifferent, apathetic, uninterested

## keen KEEN *adjective*




**MEANING** eager and enthusiastic; also, sharp

**MEMORY HOOK** **a KEEN TEEN.** Dev, the keen teen, is first in line at the climbing rock, helmet on, an hour before it opens. He is **keen** to climb.

*Dev was **keen** to try the new climbing wall.*

**SIMILAR** eager, enthusiastic, avid, sharp
**OPPOSITE** reluctant, unwilling, dull



## alacrity uh-**LAK**-rih-tee *noun*




**MEANING** cheerful readiness and speed

**MEMORY HOOK** **AL-ACRO-ity: up like an ACROBAT.** When Grandpa asks who wants to help build the treehouse, Kai springs off the couch like an acrobat: “Me! Now!” He answers with **alacrity**.

*When Mom asked who wanted ice cream, the kids answered with **alacrity**.*

**PARTS** **alacr** lively, brisk (Latin alacer) + **-ity** the quality of
**SIMILAR** eagerness, readiness, willingness, promptness
**OPPOSITE** reluctance, hesitation, sluggishness



## reluctant rih-**LUK**-tunt *adjective*




**MEANING** unwilling and hesitant

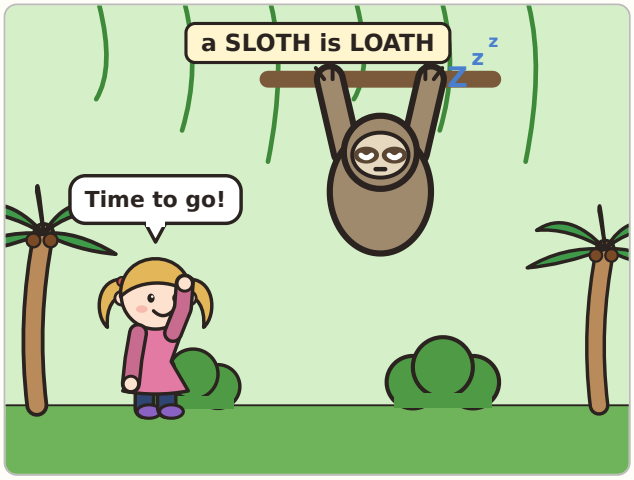
**MEMORY HOOK** **re-LUCK-tant: no LUCK getting him to go.** Maya tugs Kai toward the dance floor, but he leans back with all his weight: no luck. He is **reluctant** to dance.

*The **reluctant** puppy had to be carried into the bath.*

**PARTS** **re** back, against + **luct** struggle (Latin luctari) + **-ant** being or doing (an adjective ending)
**SIMILAR** unwilling, hesitant, disinclined, loath
**OPPOSITE** eager, willing, keen



## loath LOHTH *adjective*



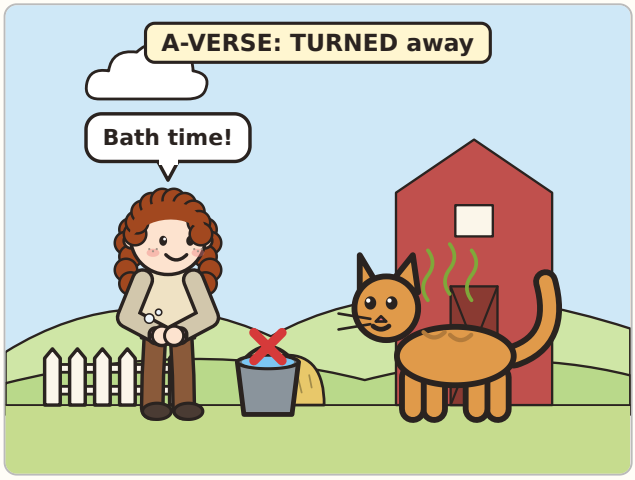

**MEANING** unwilling; reluctant

**MEMORY HOOK** **a SLOTH is LOATH to let go.** Time to climb down? The sloth hugs its cozy branch and won’t budge an inch. A sloth is always **loath** to let go.

*Grandpa was **loath** to sell the old truck he had driven for forty years.*

**SIMILAR** unwilling, reluctant, disinclined, averse
**OPPOSITE** eager, willing, keen

## averse uh-**VURS** *adjective*




**MEANING** strongly opposed or unwilling

**MEMORY HOOK** **A-VERSE: TURNED AWAY.** Show Mittens the washtub, and she turns her whole body away, nose in the air. She is **averse** to baths.

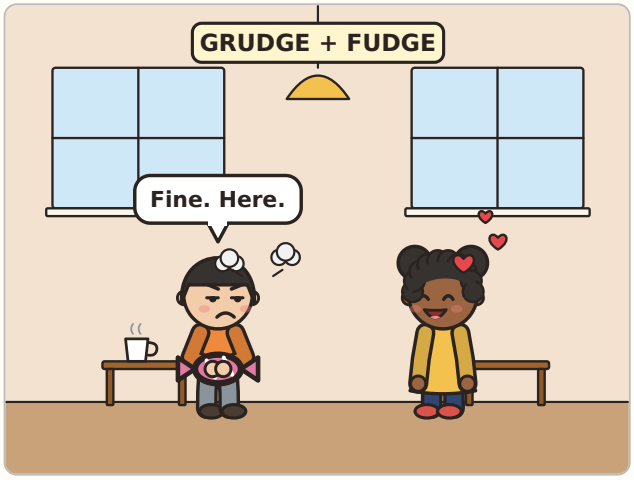
*Our cat is* **averse** *to baths.*

**PARTS** **a** away (from ab) + **vers** turn

**SIMILAR** opposed, unwilling, disinclined, reluctant
**OPPOSITE** eager, keen, inclined



## grudging **GRUJ**-ing *adjective*




**MEANING** given or done unwillingly

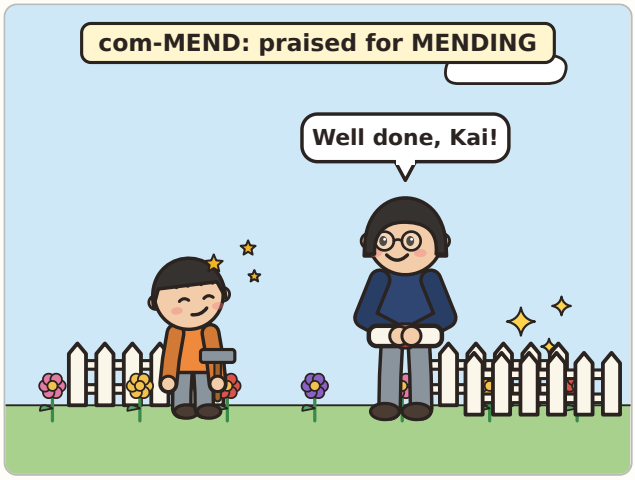
**MEMORY HOOK** **GRUDGE + FUDGE.** Mom says Kai must share, so he hands his sister half of his fudge with a scowl and a long sigh. His sharing is **grudging**.

*Kai gave a* **grudging** *apology to his sister, staring at his shoes the whole time.*

**SIMILAR** reluctant, unwilling, halfhearted, resentful
**OPPOSITE** wholehearted, willing, generous



## commend kuh-**MEND** *verb*




**MEANING** to praise formally or officially

**MEMORY HOOK** **com-MEND: praised for MENDING it.** Kai mends the broken garden fence all by himself, and the principal hands him a certificate in front of the whole school. To praise someone formally like that is to **commend** him.

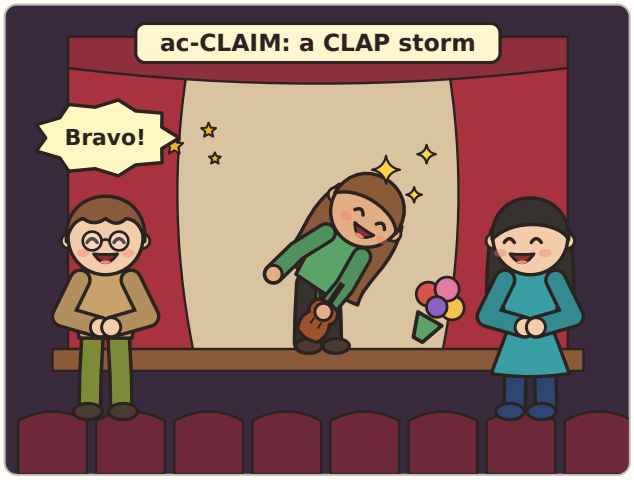
*The principal* **commended** *the students who organized the food drive.*

**PARTS** **com** thoroughly (from con) + **mend** entrust (Latin mandare)

**SIMILAR** praise, compliment, applaud
**OPPOSITE** criticize, condemn, censure



## acclaim uh-**KLAYM** *noun*




**MEANING** enthusiastic public praise

**MEMORY HOOK** **ac-CLAIM: a CLAP storm.** Rosa plays her last note, and the whole hall rises, clapping and calling out “Bravo!” That storm of public praise is **acclaim**.

*Her first novel won wide* **acclaim**.

**PARTS** **ac** to (from ad) + **claim** shout, call out (Latin clamare)

**SIMILAR** applause, acclamation, ovation, approval
**OPPOSITE** criticism, disapproval, censure

## laud LAWD *verb*




**MEANING** to praise highly

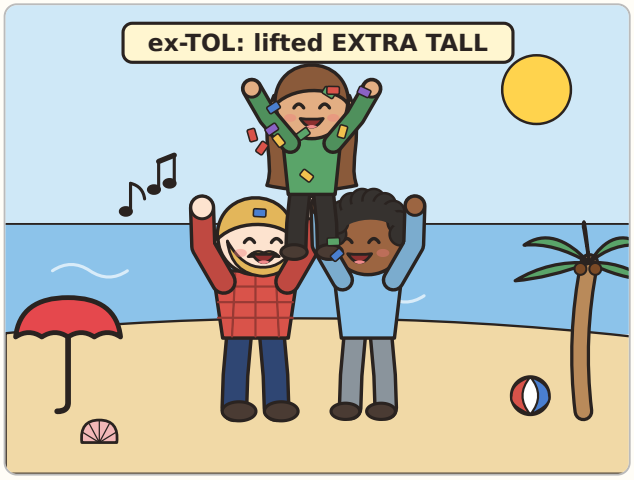
**MEMORY HOOK** **LAUD = praise out LOUD.** Grandpa Gus reads Pip's poem and praises it so loud the whole street can hear: "Best poem ever written!" To praise that highly is to **laud**.

*Critics* **lauded** *the new bridge as a work of art.*

**SIMILAR** praise, hail, acclaim
**OPPOSITE** criticize, condemn, belittle



## extol ik-STOHL *verb*




**MEANING** to praise enthusiastically

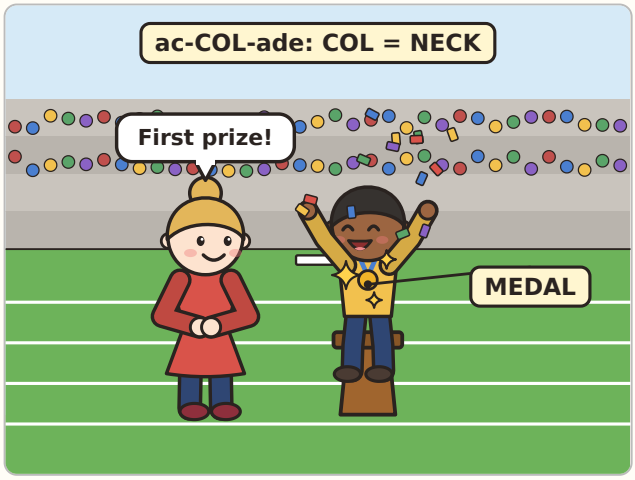
**MEMORY HOOK** **ex-TOL: lifted up EXTRA TALL.** After the beach volleyball final, the team lifts Rosa onto their shoulders and sings her praises. To lift someone up with praise is to **extol** her.

*Nana never stops* **extolling** *the virtues of a good night's sleep.*

**PARTS** **ex** out, up + **tol** lift (Latin tollere)
**SIMILAR** celebrate, rave about, sing the praises of
**OPPOSITE** criticize, disparage, belittle



## accolade AK-uh-layd *noun*




**MEANING** an award, honor or expression of praise

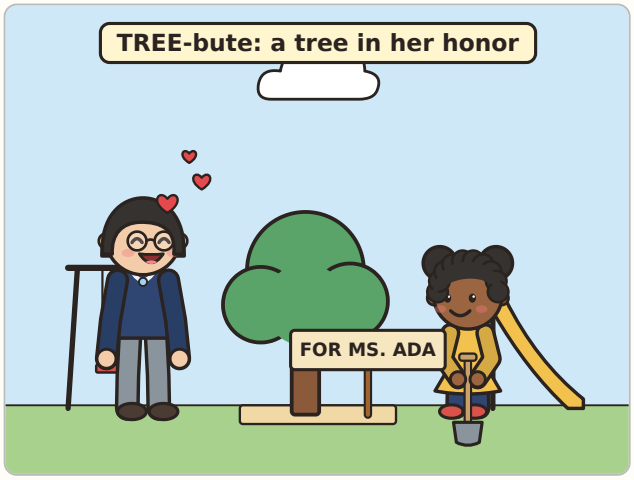
**MEMORY HOOK** **ac-COL-ade: COL = NECK, a medal.** The judge hangs a gold medal around Dev's neck for his science project. Col means neck, and an **accolade** is an honor like that.

*The firefighter received the town's highest* **accolade** *for bravery.*

**PARTS** **ac** to (from ad) + **col** neck (Latin collum)
**SIMILAR** award, honor, distinction
**OPPOSITE** criticism, censure



## tribute TRIB-yoot *noun*




**MEANING** an act, statement or gift that shows respect or admiration

**MEMORY HOOK** **TREE-bute: a TREE planted in her honor.** When Ms. Ada retires, her students plant an oak in the schoolyard with a sign: "For Ms. Ada, who taught us to wonder." The tree is a **tribute** to her.

*The concert was a* **tribute** *to the town's beloved music teacher.*

**PARTS** **tribut** paid, given (Latin tribuere)
**SIMILAR** homage, salute, testimonial
**OPPOSITE** insult, slight

## revere rih-**VEER** *verb*




**MEANING** to feel deep respect and admiration for

**MEMORY HOOK** **re-VEER: every eye VEERS toward her.** When Coach Tia walks onto the field, every player's eyes veer toward her with awe: she once played for the national team. They **revere** her.

*The young players* **revere** *their coach, who once played for the national team.*

**PARTS** **re** thoroughly + **ver** stand in awe (Latin vereri)

**SIMILAR** admire, respect, esteem
**OPPOSITE** scorn, despise, disdain



## venerate **VEN**-er-ayt *verb*




**MEANING** to regard with deep respect, often for age or wisdom

**MEMORY HOOK** **ven-ERA-te: honored from an old ERA.** Every spring the town gathers under the five-hundred-year-old oak, a survivor from a long-ago era, and leaves flowers at its roots. The townspeople **venerate** it.

*The villagers* **venerate** *the ancient oak that has shaded their square for five hundred years.*

**PARTS** **vener** honor, love (Latin venerari) + **-ate** to do

**SIMILAR** revere, deeply respect, look up to
**OPPOSITE** scorn, despise, disrespect



## exalt ig-**ZAWLT** *verb*




**MEANING** to raise high in rank, power or praise

**MEMORY HOOK** **ex-ALT: to a high ALTitude.** The village lifts its brave baker onto the tallest platform in the square, as high as the rooftops. To raise someone high in honor is to **exalt** her.

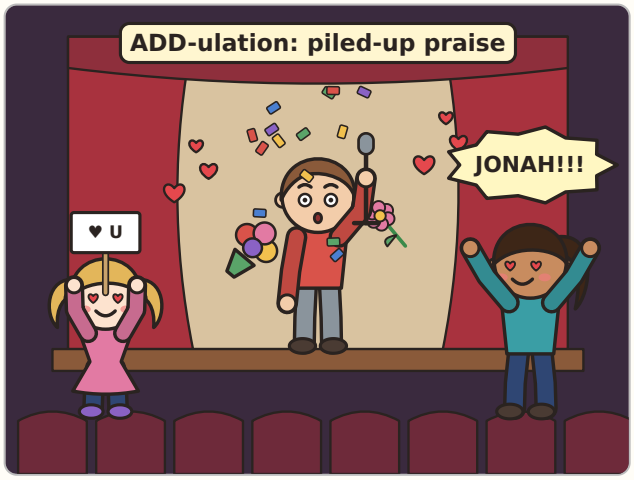
*The old legends* **exalt** *the village baker who fed everyone through the long winter.*

**PARTS** **ex** out, up + **alt** high

**SIMILAR** glorify, elevate, raise up
**OPPOSITE** humble, degrade, belittle



## adulation aj-uh-**LAY**-shun *noun*




**MEANING** excessive praise or admiration

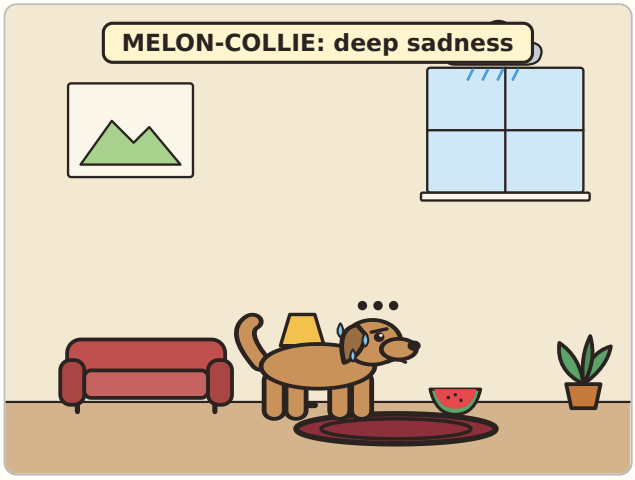
**MEMORY HOOK** **ADD-ulation: ADD praise on praise.** The fans scream, wave signs and toss flowers, adding praise upon praise until the young singer can barely be seen. That flood of admiration is **adulation**.

*The young singer was overwhelmed by the* **adulation** *of her fans.*

**PARTS** **adul** fawn, flatter (Latin adulari) + **-ation** the act of

**SIMILAR** adoration, idolization, hero worship, flattery
**OPPOSITE** scorn, criticism, contempt

## melancholy **MEL**-un-kol-ee *noun*




**MEANING** a deep, lasting sadness

**MEMORY HOOK** **a MELON-COLLIE.** Ever since his melon ball rolled into the river, the old collie lies by the window and sighs all day. Poor melon-collie: he is full of **melancholy**.

*A gentle* **melancholy** *settled over the house after the last guests drove away.*

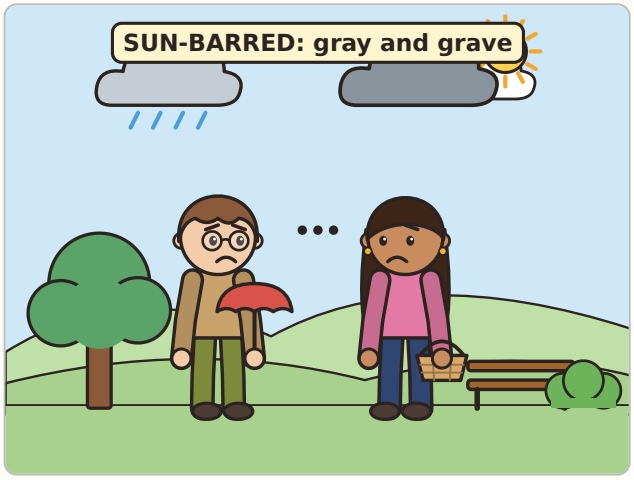
**PARTS** **melan** black (Greek melas) + **chol** bile (Greek chole)

**SIMILAR** sadness, sorrow, gloom, despondency

**OPPOSITE** happiness, cheer, joy

15. Sad

## somber **SOM**-ber *adjective*




**MEANING** dark and gloomy; serious

**MEMORY HOOK** **SOM-BER: SUN-BARRED, gray and grave.** Clouds bar the sun, the sky turns gray, and the picnic goes quiet and serious. With the sun barred, the mood is **somber**.

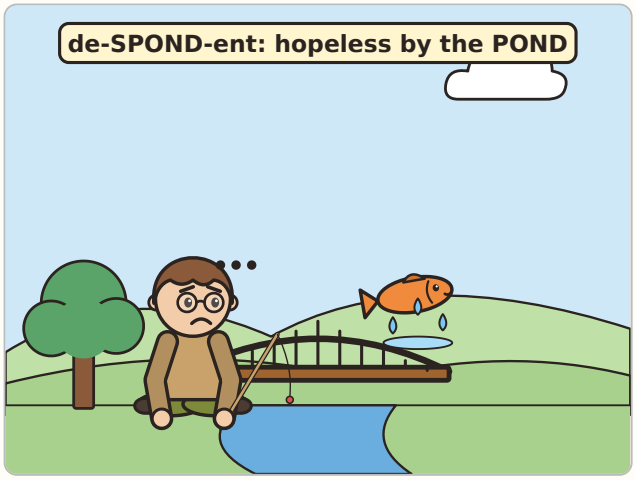
*The* **somber** *gray sky matched our mood on the last day of vacation.*

**SIMILAR** gloomy, dark, grave, serious

**OPPOSITE** cheerful, bright, lighthearted

15. Sad

## despondent dih-**SPON**-dunt *adjective*




**MEANING** in low spirits from loss of hope

**MEMORY HOOK** **de-SPOND-ent: no hope by the POND.** Felix has fished the pond all day without a single nibble, and now he slumps on the bank, all hope gone. He is **despondent**.

*After the third rejection letter, Felix was* **despondent**.

**PARTS** **de** away + **spond** promise (Latin spondere)

**SIMILAR** hopeless, dejected, downcast, discouraged

**OPPOSITE** hopeful, cheerful, optimistic

15. Sad

## forlorn fer-**LORN** *adjective*




**MEANING** sad and lonely; abandoned

**MEMORY HOOK** **for-LORN: left all a-LONE.** Everyone has gone home from the playground, and one little teddy bear sits all alone on the bench in the rain. It looks **forlorn**.

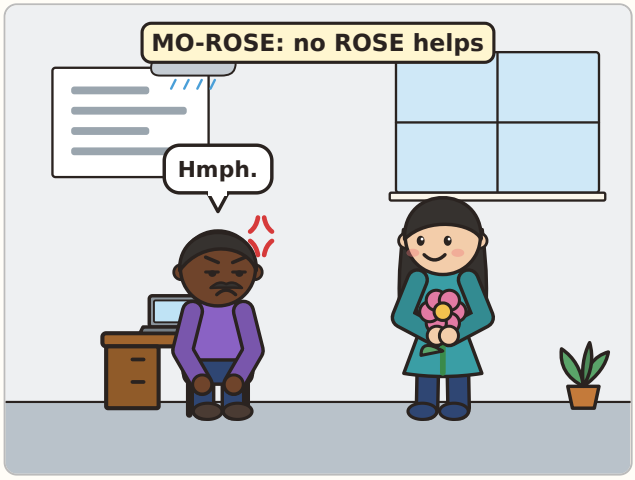
*A* **forlorn** *teddy bear sat in the rain beside the empty swing.*

**SIMILAR** lonely, abandoned, desolate, wretched

**OPPOSITE** cheerful, joyful

15. Sad

## morose muh-**ROHS** *adjective*




**MEANING** sullen, gloomy and bad-tempered

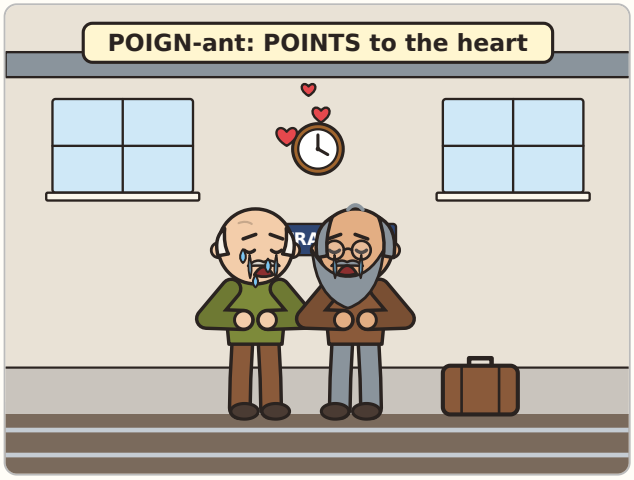
**MEMORY HOOK** **MO-ROSE: no ROSE can cheer him.** Lin brings Marcus a rose to cheer him up, and he only scowls and grunts. No rose can brighten his sullen mood: he is **morose**.

*The* **morose** *goalie barely spoke during the long bus ride home.*

**SIMILAR** sullen, gloomy, glum, surly
**OPPOSITE** cheerful, sunny, jovial

15. Sad

## poignant **POIN**-yunt *adjective*




**MEANING** deeply moving; stirring sadness or tender regret

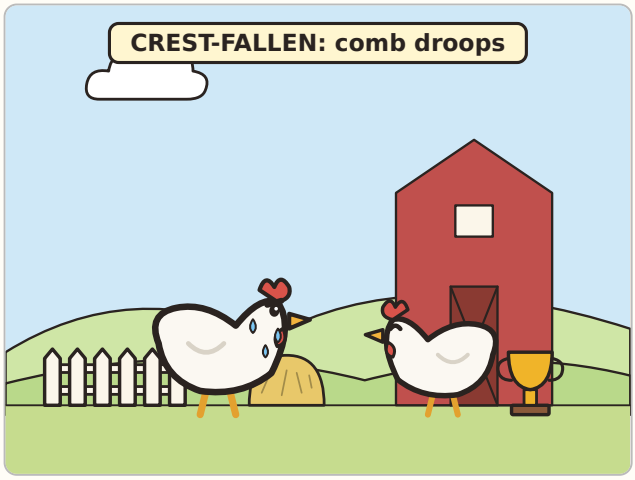
**MEMORY HOOK** **POIGN-ant: POINTS straight at the heart.** Two old friends meet again on the platform where they said goodbye sixty years before, and the moment points straight at your heart. It is **poignant**.

*Grandpa's* **poignant** *letter to his younger self made the whole family cry.*

**SIMILAR** moving, touching, affecting, tender
**OPPOSITE** unmoving, trivial

15. Sad

## crestfallen **KREST**-faw-lun *adjective*




**MEANING** disappointed and downcast

**MEMORY HOOK** **CREST-FALLEN: the comb droops.** Rocky the rooster loses the crowing contest, and his proud red comb flops down over one eye. He is **crestfallen**.

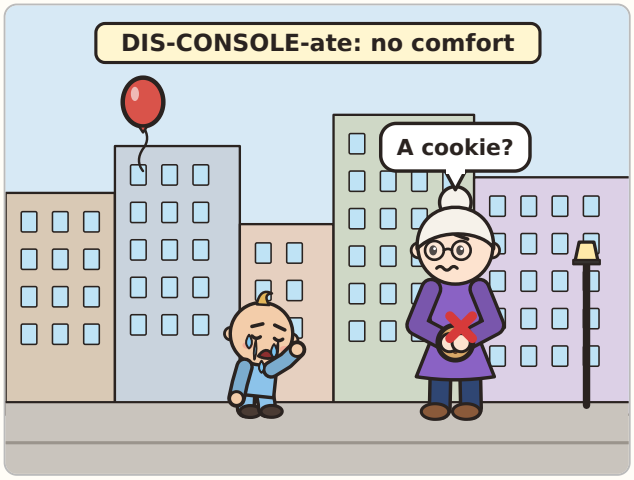
*Kai was* **crestfallen** *when the trip to the lake was canceled.*

**PARTS** **crest** the comb or plume on top of the head + **fallen** dropped

**SIMILAR** disappointed, dejected, downcast, deflated
**OPPOSITE** elated, jubilant, cheerful

15. Sad

## disconsolate dis-**KON**-suh-lit *adjective*




**MEANING** so sad that nothing can comfort

**MEMORY HOOK** **DIS-CONSOLE-ate: can't be CONSOLED.** Theo's balloon floats away, and nothing helps: not a hug, not a cookie, not even a new balloon. He cannot be consoled; he is **disconsolate**.

*The* **disconsolate** *toddler cried for an hour after his balloon floated away.*

**PARTS** **dis** not + **consol** comfort (Latin consolari) + **-ate** having (an adjective ending)

**SIMILAR** inconsolable, heartbroken, miserable, desolate
**OPPOSITE** cheerful, comforted, consoled

15. Sad

## wistful **WIST**-ful *adjective*




**MEANING** sadly longing for something past or out of reach

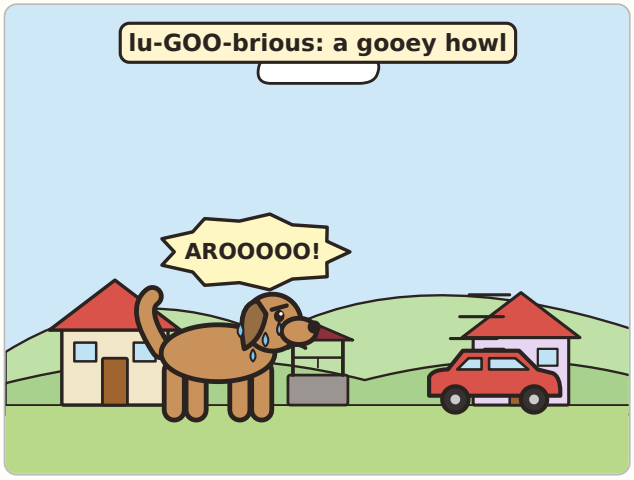
**MEMORY HOOK** **WIST-ful ~ WISH-ful.** Granny Mae turns the pages of her old dance photos, smiling but a little sad, wishing she could dance like that once more. Her smile is **wistful**.

*Grandma gave a* **wistful** *smile as she looked through her old dance photos.*

**SIMILAR** longing, yearning, nostalgic, pensive
**OPPOSITE** content, satisfied



## lugubrious loo-**GOO**-bree-us *adjective*




**MEANING** mournful, often in an exaggerated way

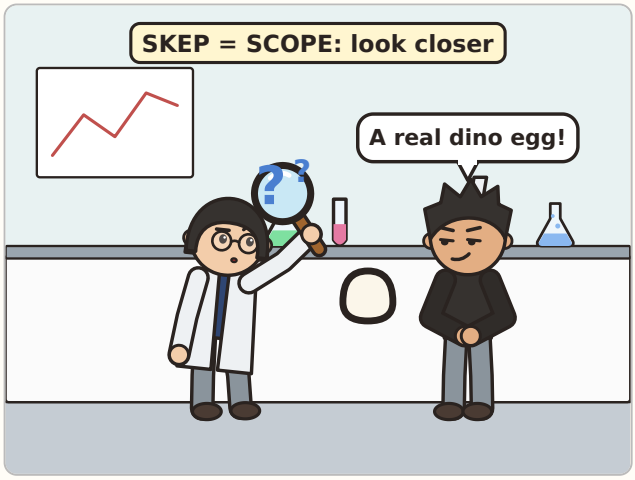
**MEMORY HOOK** **lu-GOO-brious: a howl as slow as GOO.** Every time the car pulls away, Biscuit the hound lets out a howl as slow and droopy as goo: “Aroooooo.” It is over the top, and it is **lugubrious**.

*The hound gave a* **lugubrious** *howl whenever the family left the house.*

**PARTS** **lugubr** mournful (Latin lugere, to mourn) + **-ious** full of
**SIMILAR** mournful, doleful, gloomy, sorrowful
**OPPOSITE** cheerful, merry, upbeat



## skeptical **SKEP**-tih-kul *adjective*




**MEANING** doubting; not easily convinced

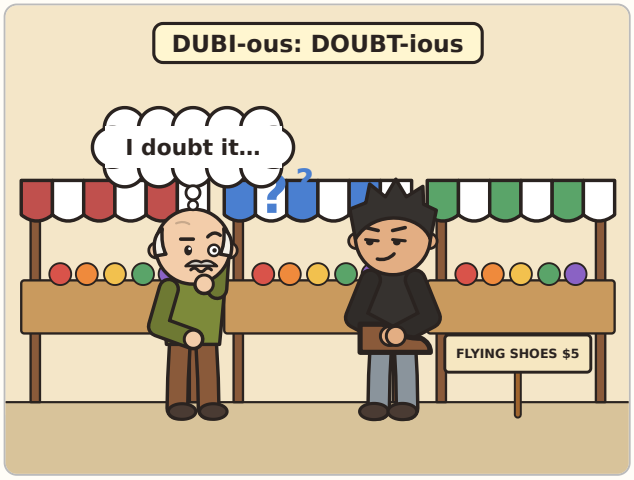
**MEMORY HOOK** **SKEP = SCOPE: look closer first.** Rex claims his round rock is a dinosaur egg, so Ada pulls out her magnifying glass and looks very closely before believing a word. She is **skeptical**.

*Dad was* **skeptical** *when the ad promised a car that would never need a single repair.*

**PARTS** **skept** look at, examine (Greek) + **-ical** having to do with
**SIMILAR** doubtful, dubious, unconvinced, questioning
**OPPOSITE** credulous, trusting, convinced



## dubious **DOO**-bee-us *adjective*



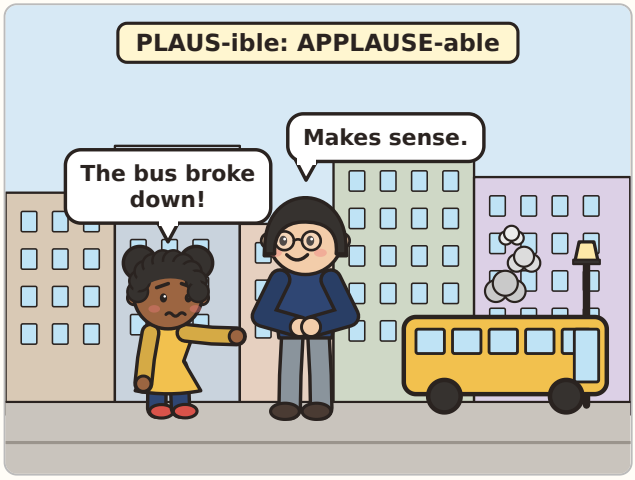

**MEANING** doubtful; also, possibly dishonest

**MEMORY HOOK** **DOO-bee-us = DOUBT-ious.** A sign promises shoes that let you fly for five dollars. Grandpa Gus squints at it, full of doubt, and the seller looks shady too. Gus is **dubious**.

*Ivy was* **dubious** *about her brother’s promise to clean the kitchen by himself.*

**PARTS** **dubi** doubt (Latin dubius) + **-ous** full of
**SIMILAR** doubtful, questionable, suspicious, uncertain
**OPPOSITE** certain, trustworthy, reliable

## plausible **PLAW**-zuh-bul *adjective*




**MEANING** seeming reasonable or likely

**MEMORY HOOK** **PLAUS-ible: worth a little APPLAUSE.** Zoe says she is late because the bus broke down, and there it sits, steaming at the corner. Her excuse earns a nod and a clap: it is **plausible**.

*Zoe's excuse was* **plausible***: the bus really had broken down that morning.*

**PARTS** **plaus** applaud (Latin plaudere) + **-ible** able to be

**SIMILAR** believable, reasonable, credible, likely

**OPPOSITE** implausible, unlikely, far-fetched



## conviction kun-**VIK**-shun *noun*




**MEANING** a firmly held belief; also, a finding of guilt in court

**MEMORY HOOK** **con-VICT-ion: a belief that WINS you.** Everyone laughs at Tia's plan to turn the empty lot into a garden, but she plants her flag and won't budge. She speaks with **conviction**.

*Nell spoke with* **conviction** *about saving the old oak trees.*

**PARTS** **con** thoroughly + **vict** conquered (Latin vincere) + **-ion** the act or state of

**SIMILAR** belief, certainty, confidence, principle

**OPPOSITE** doubt, uncertainty



## tenet **TEN**-it *noun*




**MEANING** a principle or belief held as true by a group

**MEMORY HOOK** **TEN = HOLD: a belief the club HOLDS.** The hiking club's sign lists the beliefs its members hold to, and number one is "Leave no trash." Each rule they hold is a **tenet**.

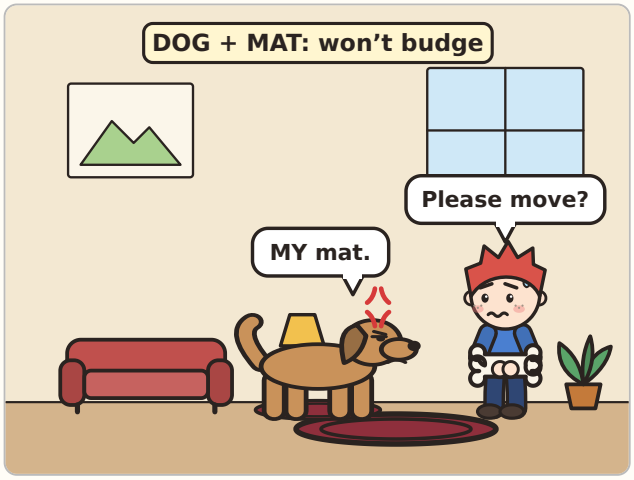
*A basic* **tenet** *of the hiking club is to leave no trash behind.*

**PARTS** **ten** hold

**SIMILAR** principle, belief, rule, doctrine



## dogmatic dawg-**MAT**-ik *adjective*




**MEANING** insisting one's opinions are true without considering evidence

**MEMORY HOOK** **DOG + MAT: a dog that won't budge.** Rufus has decided that the doormat is his, and no treat, toy or argument will move him an inch. Stuck to an opinion like a dog on its mat is **dogmatic**.

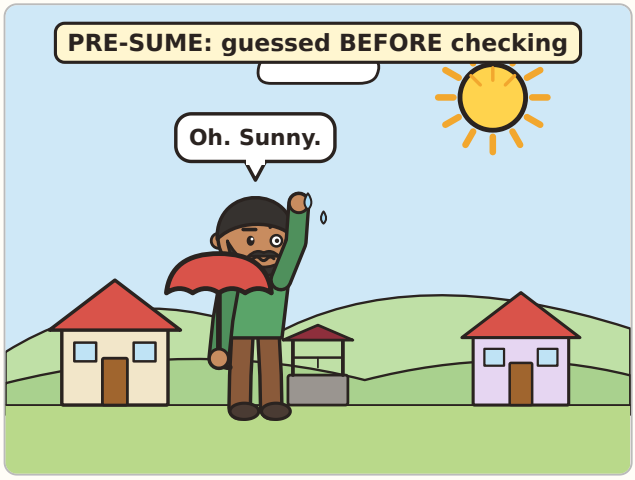
*Our* **dogmatic** *neighbor insists there is only one right way to mow a lawn.*

**PARTS** **dogma** opinion, belief (Greek) + **-tic** having to do with

**SIMILAR** opinionated, rigid, inflexible, closed-minded

**OPPOSITE** open-minded, flexible

## presume prih-**ZOOM** *verb*




**MEANING** to suppose something is true without proof

**MEMORY HOOK** **PRE-SUME: take it as true BEFORE checking.** Omar sees wet umbrellas by the door and pops his own open before stepping out, into blazing sunshine. He did not check; he chose to **presume**.

*I* **presume** *you've already eaten, since there are crumbs on your shirt.*

**PARTS** **pre** before + **sum** take (Latin sumere)

**SIMILAR** assume, suppose, take for granted, guess



## speculate **SPEK**-yuh-layt *verb*




**MEANING** to form ideas or theories without firm evidence

**MEMORY HOOK** **SPEC-ulate: look and guess, no peeking.** The kids stare at the big wrapped box and guess: a bike? a puppy? a robot? With no way to peek inside, all they can do is **speculate**.

*Fans* **speculated** *about who would win the baking contest.*

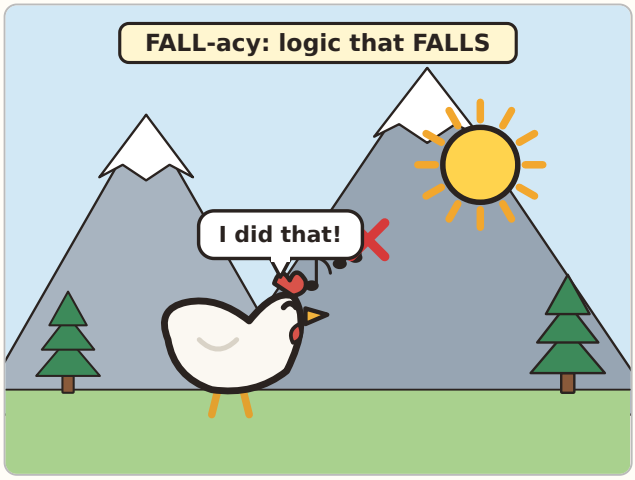
**PARTS** **spec** look + **-ate** to do

**SIMILAR** guess, theorize, hypothesize, conjecture

**OPPOSITE** know, prove



## fallacy **FAL**-uh-see *noun*




**MEANING** a mistaken belief, or a flaw in reasoning

**MEMORY HOOK** **FALL-acy: reasoning that FALLS apart.** The rooster crows, the sun comes up, and he proudly believes his crowing made it rise. That reasoning falls apart: it is a **fallacy**.

*"Everyone I know likes pizza, so everyone in the world must like pizza" is a* **fallacy**.

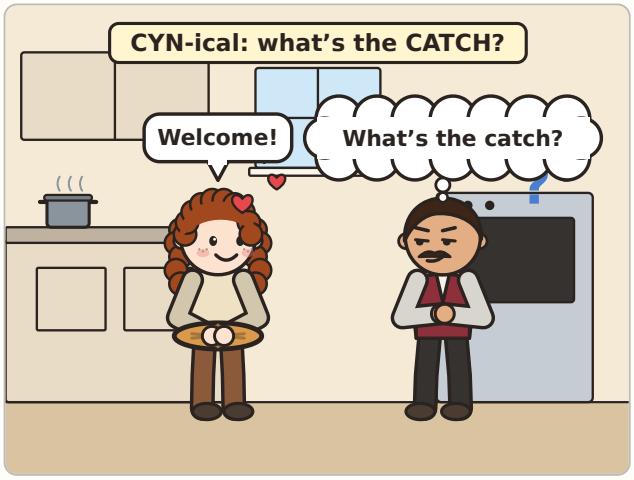
**PARTS** **fall** deceive (Latin fallere) + **-acy** the quality of

**SIMILAR** misconception, error, myth, false belief

**OPPOSITE** truth, fact



## cynical **SIN**-ih-kul *adjective*




**MEANING** believing that people act only out of self-interest

**MEMORY HOOK** **CYN-ical: "What's the CATCH?".** Nell brings her new neighbor a pie, and Victor squints: "What's the catch? What do you want?" He thinks every kindness hides a selfish reason. Victor is **cynical**.

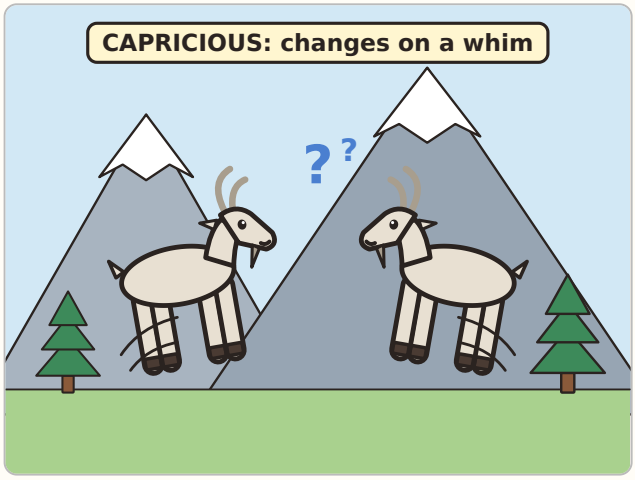
*The* **cynical** *shopper assumed the free samples must be some kind of trick.*

**PARTS** **cyn** dog (Greek kyon) + **-ical** having to do with

**SIMILAR** distrustful, suspicious, jaded, skeptical

**OPPOSITE** trusting, idealistic, naive

## capricious kuh-**PRISH**-us *adjective*




**MEANING** changing suddenly and without reason

**MEMORY HOOK** **a goat on a whim: this way, then that.** The little goat leaps left, then right, then left again, for no reason at all: just a whim. Its leaping is **capricious**.

*The* **capricious** *weather switched from sunshine to hail three times in one afternoon.*

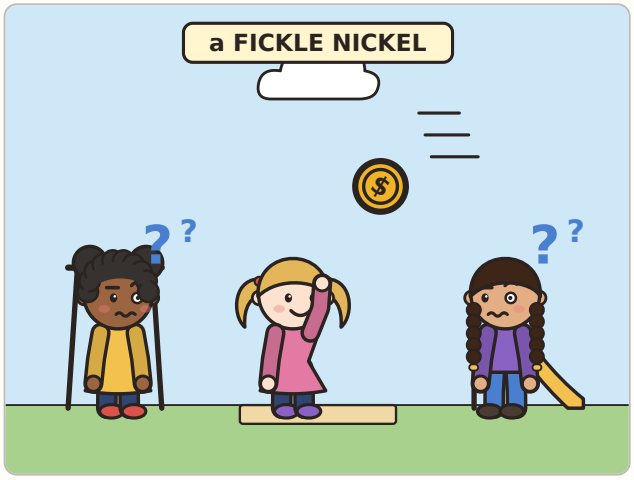
**PARTS** **capric** a whim (Italian capriccio) + **-ious** full of

**SIMILAR** fickle, unpredictable, changeable, whimsical

**OPPOSITE** steady, consistent, predictable



## fickle **FIK**-ul *adjective*




**MEANING** changing loyalties or feelings often

**MEMORY HOOK** **a FICKLE NICKEL: flips like a coin.** Ivy picks her best friend by flipping a nickel: heads it's Zoe, tails it's Lila, and tomorrow she flips again. Loyalty that flips like a coin is **fickle**.

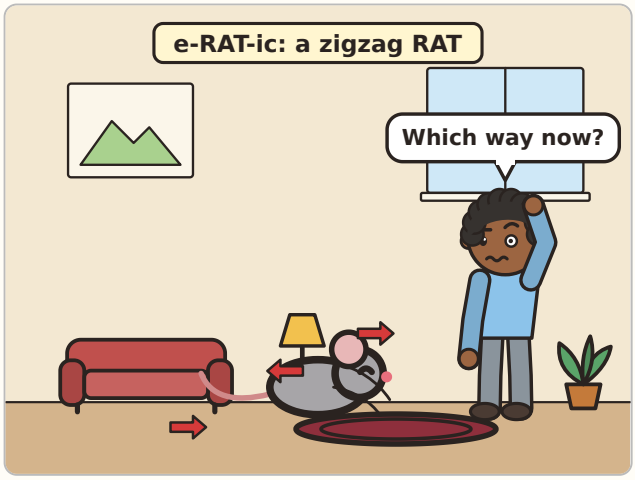
*The* **fickle** *cat loved me on Monday and ignored me by Tuesday.*

**SIMILAR** changeable, inconstant, unreliable, capricious

**OPPOSITE** loyal, faithful, constant



## erratic ih-**RAT**-ik *adjective*




**MEANING** not regular or predictable

**MEMORY HOOK** **e-RAT-ic: a RAT that zigzags.** The pet rat zigzags across the floor, left, right, back, around the sofa, so no one can guess where it will go next. Its path is **erratic**.

*The old car's* **erratic** *engine coughed, roared and then went silent.*

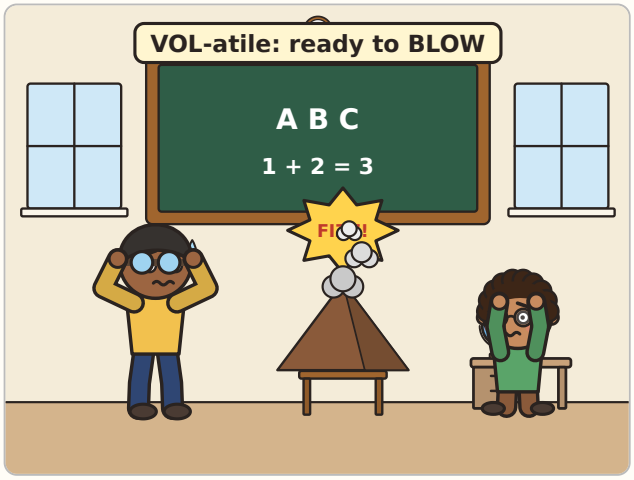
**PARTS** **err** wander (Latin errare) + **-atic** having to do with

**SIMILAR** unpredictable, irregular, inconsistent, uneven

**OPPOSITE** steady, regular, consistent



## volatile **VOL**-uh-tul *adjective*




**MEANING** likely to change suddenly, often for the worse

**MEMORY HOOK** **VOL-atile: a VOLCANO ready to blow.** Dev's science-fair volcano rumbles and fizzes, and no one knows when it will blow. Anything ready to erupt or change suddenly is **volatile**.

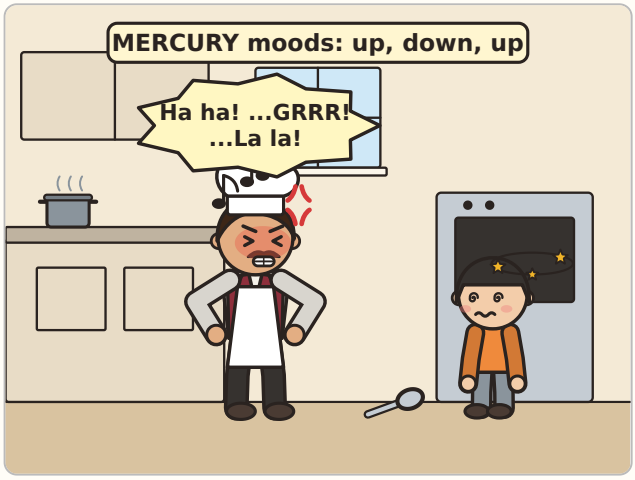
*The* **volatile** *stock market rose sharply in the morning and fell by afternoon.*

**PARTS** **vol** fly (Latin volare) + **-atile** able to

**SIMILAR** unstable, explosive, unpredictable, changeable

**OPPOSITE** stable, steady, calm

## mercurial mer-**KYOOR**-ee-ul *adjective*




**MEANING** subject to sudden, unpredictable changes of mood

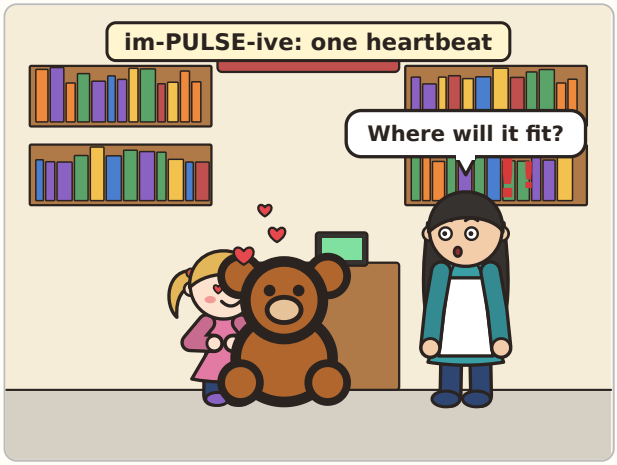
**MEMORY HOOK** **moods as quick as MERCURY.** Chef Victor laughs at a joke, roars at a dropped spoon, then hums happily, all in one minute. His moods slip and dart like quick, silvery mercury: he is **mercurial**.

*The* **mercurial** *chef was laughing one minute and shouting the next.*

**SIMILAR** temperamental, moody, volatile, changeable
**OPPOSITE** stable, steady, even-tempered

17. Changeable

## impulsive im-**PUL**-siv *adjective*




**MEANING** acting suddenly without thinking first

**MEMORY HOOK** **im-PULSE-ive: decided in one PULSE.** Ivy spots a giant teddy bear at the checkout and buys it in one heartbeat, without a thought about where it will fit. Her purchase is **impulsive**.

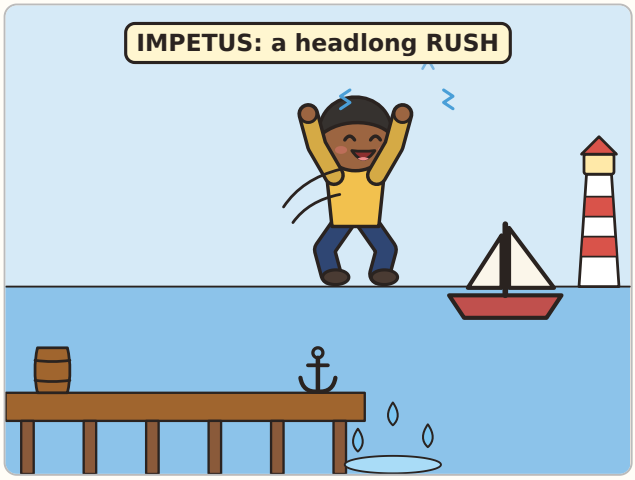
*In an* **impulsive** *moment, Jonah dyed his hair green the night before school photos.*

**PARTS** **im** on (from in-) + **puls** push, drive (Latin pellere) + **-ive** tending to

**SIMILAR** rash, hasty, spontaneous, reckless
**OPPOSITE** cautious, deliberate, careful

17. Changeable

## impetuous im-**PECH**-oo-us *adjective*




**MEANING** acting quickly and rashly, without thought

**MEMORY HOOK** **IMPETUS: a headlong RUSH.** Dev races down the dock and leaps into the lake without checking how cold it is. Splash! Brrr! His headlong leap was **impetuous**.

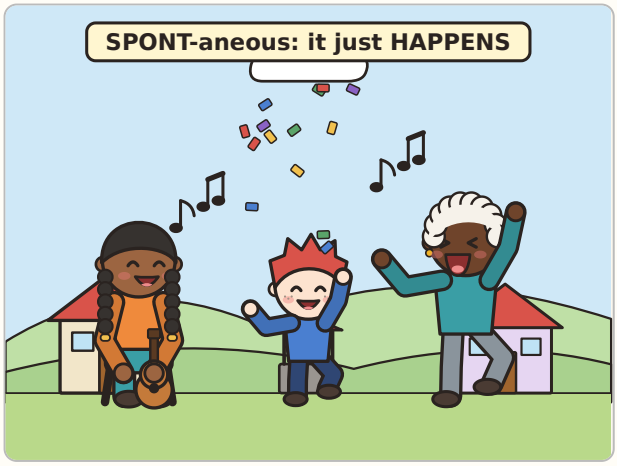
*The* **impetuous** *knight charged across the river without checking how deep it was.*

**PARTS** **im** on, against + **pet** rush at (Latin petere) + **-uous** full of

**SIMILAR** rash, hasty, impulsive, headlong
**OPPOSITE** cautious, careful, deliberate

17. Changeable

## spontaneous spon-**TAY**-nee-us *adjective*




**MEANING** happening naturally, without planning

**MEMORY HOOK** **SPONT-aneous: it just HAPPENS.** One neighbor starts strumming a guitar on her steps, and soon the whole street is dancing, with no plan at all. The party is **spontaneous**.

*The crowd broke into* **spontaneous** *applause when the puppy crossed the finish line.*

**PARTS** **spont** of one's own accord (Latin sponte) + **-aneous** having the quality of

**SIMILAR** unplanned, impromptu, natural, unrehearsed
**OPPOSITE** planned, rehearsed, deliberate

17. Changeable

## vacillate **VAS**-uh-layt *verb*




**MEANING** to waver back and forth between choices

**MEMORY HOOK** **VAS-illate: VANILLA? chocolate? VANILLA?.** Kai stares at the menu: vanilla? chocolate? vanilla? He sways back and forth so long that the shop closes. To waver like that is to **vacillate**.

*Kai* **vacillated** *between chocolate and vanilla until the shop closed.*

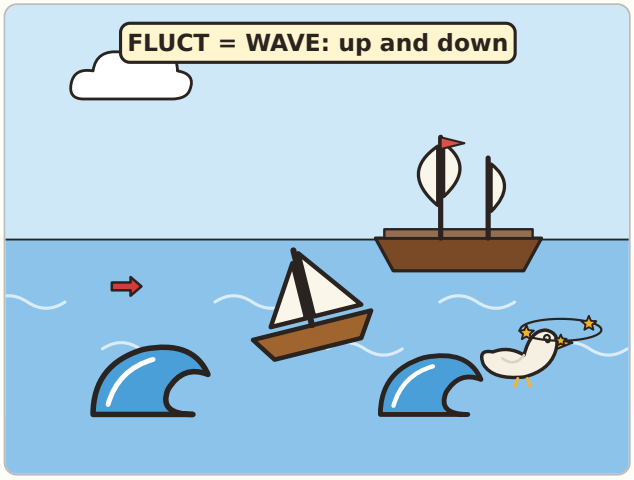
**PARTS** **vacill** sway, totter (Latin vacillare) + **-ate** to do

**SIMILAR** waver, dither, hesitate, seesaw

**OPPOSITE** decide, commit



## fluctuate **FLUK**-choo-ayt *verb*




**MEANING** to rise and fall irregularly

**MEMORY HOOK** **FLUCT = WAVE: up and down.** The little boat rides the waves up, down, up, down, never level for a moment. Things that rise and fall like waves **fluctuate**.

*The price of strawberries* **fluctuates** *with the seasons.*

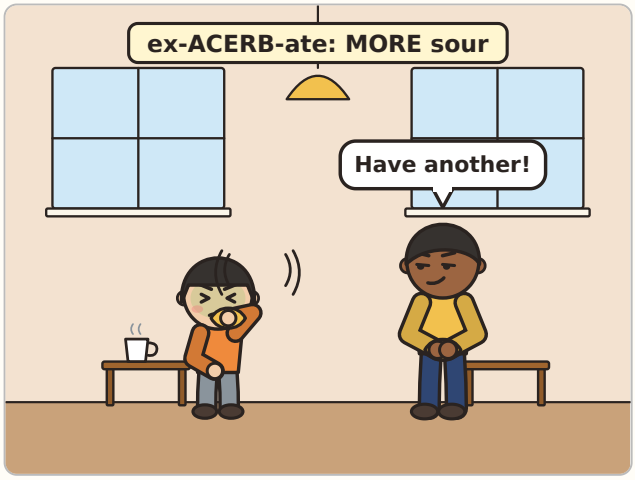
**PARTS** **fluct** wave (Latin fluctus) + **-uate** to do

**SIMILAR** vary, rise and fall, swing, seesaw

**OPPOSITE** stabilize, hold steady



## exacerbate ig-**ZAS**-er-bayt *verb*




**MEANING** to make a problem or pain worse

**MEMORY HOOK** **ex-ACERB-ate: add more SOUR to the sour.** Kai is already puckering from one lemon, and his brother hands him another. Adding sour to sour is how you **exacerbate** a problem.

*Scratching a mosquito bite only* **exacerbates** *the itch.*

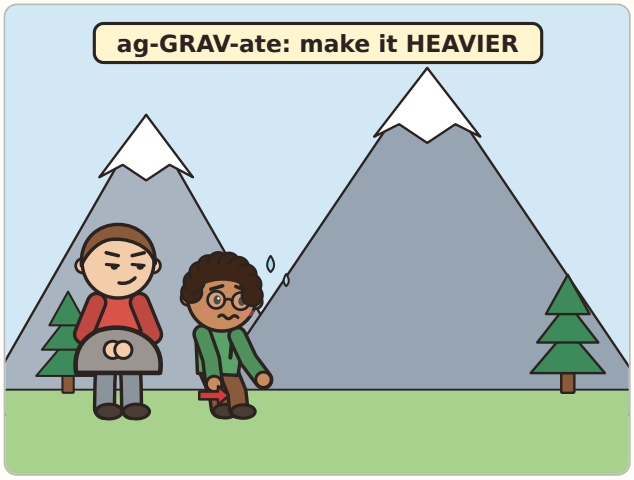
**PARTS** **ex** thoroughly + **acerb** harsh, bitter (Latin acerbus) + **-ate** to make

**SIMILAR** worsen, aggravate, intensify, inflame

**OPPOSITE** alleviate, ease, mitigate



## aggravate **AG**-ruh-vayt *verb*




**MEANING** to make worse; also, in everyday speech, to annoy

**MEMORY HOOK** **ag-GRAV-ate: make it HEAVIER.** Sami's backpack is already heavy, and then Jonah sneaks a big rock into it. Grav means heavy: to **aggravate** a problem is to make it heavier.

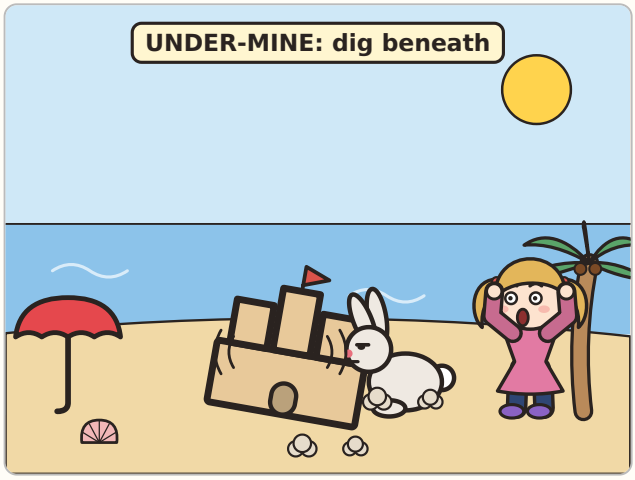
*Lifting heavy boxes* **aggravated** *the coach's sore back.*

**PARTS** **ag** to (from ad) + **grav** heavy + **-ate** to make

**SIMILAR** worsen, exacerbate, inflame, compound

**OPPOSITE** alleviate, ease, improve

## undermine un-der-**MINE** *verb*




**MEANING** to weaken gradually or secretly

**MEMORY HOOK** **UNDER-MINE: dig beneath it.** A rabbit tunnels under the sandcastle's tallest tower, and day by day the tower leans a little more. Weakening something from underneath is to **undermine** it.

*Constant teasing can* **undermine** *a child's confidence.*

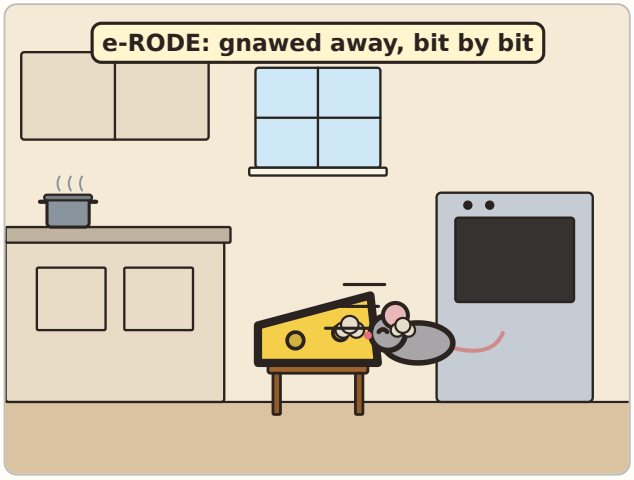
**PARTS** **under** beneath + **mine** dig a tunnel

**SIMILAR** weaken, erode, subvert, sabotage

**OPPOSITE** strengthen, support, bolster



## erode ih-**ROHD** *verb*




**MEANING** to wear away slowly

**MEMORY HOOK** **e-RODE: gnawed away, as by a RODent.** Night after night, a little mouse nibbles the big wheel of cheese until only a sliver is left. Rodere means to gnaw: water, wind and time **erode** things the same slow way.

*Waves* **eroded** *the cliff a little more each winter.*

**PARTS** **e** away (from ex) + **rod** gnaw (Latin rodere)

**SIMILAR** wear away, wear down, corrode, undermine

**OPPOSITE** build up, strengthen



## deteriorate dih-**TEER**-ee-uh-rayt *verb*




**MEANING** to become worse

**MEMORY HOOK** **de-TEAR-iorate: one TEAR, then more.** Kai's old kite starts with one small tear; after a week of wind, it is more holes than kite. It has **deteriorated**.

*Left out in the rain, the old book* **deteriorated** *until its pages stuck together.*

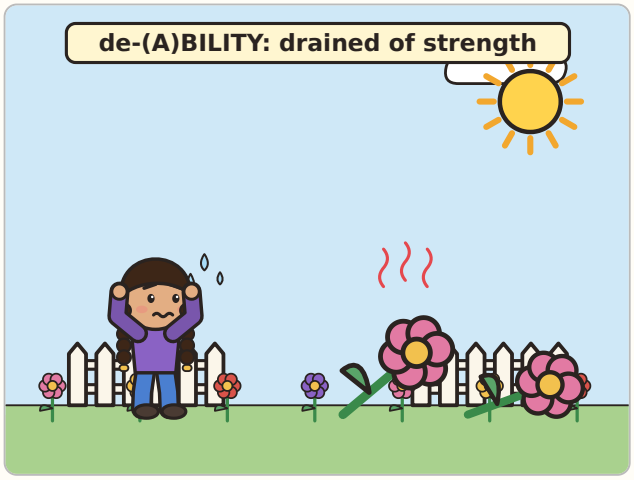
**PARTS** **deterior** worse (Latin deterior) + **-ate** to become

**SIMILAR** worsen, decline, decay, degenerate

**OPPOSITE** improve, recover



## debilitate dih-**BIL**-ih-tayt *verb*




**MEANING** to weaken severely

**MEMORY HOOK** **de-(A)BILITY-ate: takes away all ABILITY.** Day after day of blazing heat drains every bit of strength from the sunflowers until they droop to the ground. A heat wave can **debilitate** a garden.

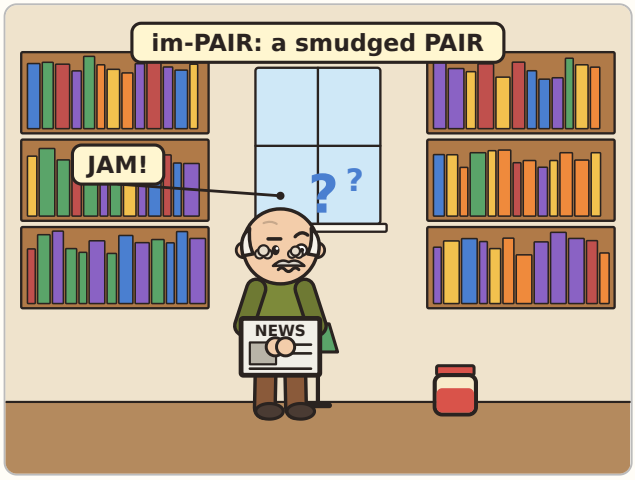
*The long heat wave* **debilitated** *the garden's tomato plants.*

**PARTS** **debil** weak (Latin debilis) + **-itate** to make

**SIMILAR** weaken, enfeeble, sap, exhaust

**OPPOSITE** strengthen, invigorate, energize

## impair im-**PAIR** *verb*




**MEANING** to damage or weaken

**MEMORY HOOK** **im-PAIR: a smudged PAIR of glasses.** Grandpa's pair of glasses is smeared with jam, and now he can barely read the paper. The smudges **impair** his sight.

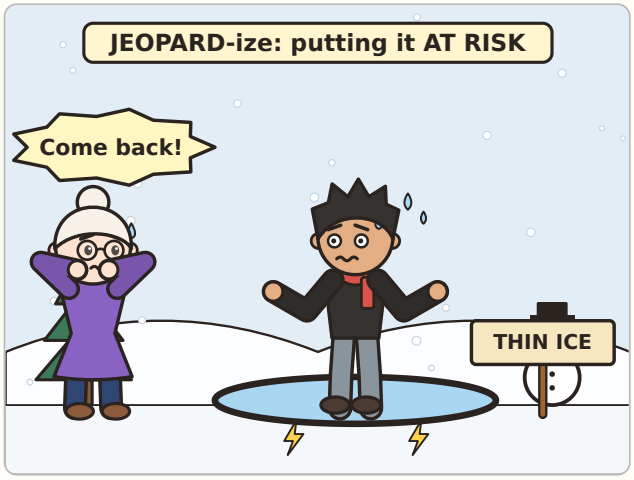
*Very loud music can* **impair** *your hearing over time.*

**PARTS** **im** in, into + **pair** worse (Latin pejor)

**SIMILAR** damage, weaken, harm, diminish
**OPPOSITE** improve, enhance, strengthen



## jeopardize **JEP**-er-dize *verb*




**MEANING** to put in danger or at risk

**MEMORY HOOK** **JEOPARD-ize: put in JEOPARDY.** Ignoring the THIN ICE sign, Rex skates right out to the middle of the pond, and every crack puts him in jeopardy. He chose to **jeopardize** his own safety.

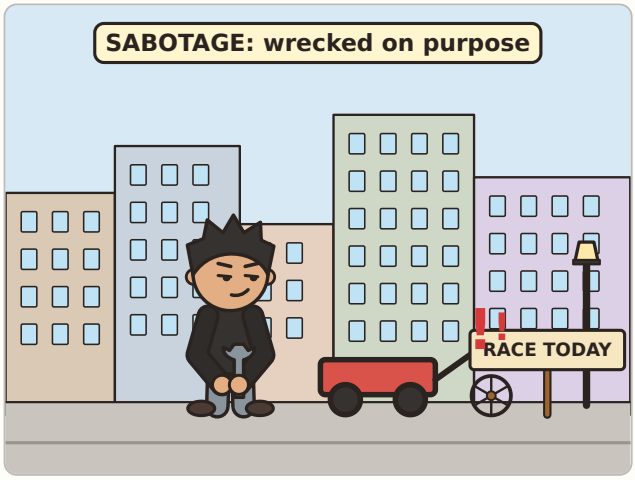
*Skipping practice could* **jeopardize** *Rosa's spot on the team.*

**PARTS** **-ize** to make, to put into

**SIMILAR** endanger, risk, threaten, imperil
**OPPOSITE** protect, safeguard, secure



## sabotage **SAB**-uh-tahzh *verb*




**MEANING** to damage or ruin on purpose

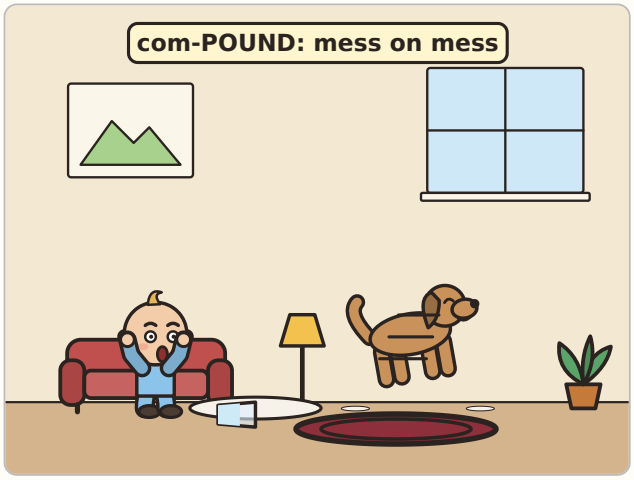
**MEMORY HOOK** **SAB-o-TAGE: a sneaky, secret wreck.** Before the wagon race, Rex creeps over and loosens a wheel on his rival's wagon. Wrecking something on purpose is to **sabotage** it.

*Someone* **sabotaged** *the science-fair volcano by swapping the baking soda for flour.*

**SIMILAR** undermine, wreck, spoil, disrupt
**OPPOSITE** support, protect, help



## compound kum-**POWND** *verb*




**MEANING** to make a problem worse by adding to it

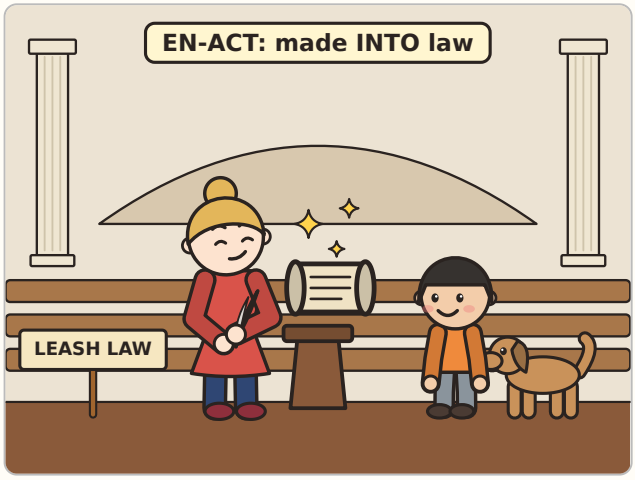
**MEMORY HOOK** **com-POUND: POUND more trouble on top.** Theo spills his milk, and then the puppy runs through the puddle and tracks white paw prints across the whole house. The puppy **compounded** the problem.

*Arriving late, Dev* **compounded** *the problem by forgetting his uniform.*

**PARTS** **com** together + **pound** put (Latin ponere)

**SIMILAR** worsen, aggravate, add to, exacerbate
**OPPOSITE** lessen, ease, alleviate

## enact en-**AKT** *verb*




**MEANING** to make into law

**MEMORY HOOK** **EN-ACT: turn a plan INTO an ACT (a law).** The town council votes yes, and the mayor signs the new leash rule with a flourish: now it is an official act. To make a plan into law is to **enact** it.

*The town council* **enacted** *a rule requiring dogs to be leashed in the park.*

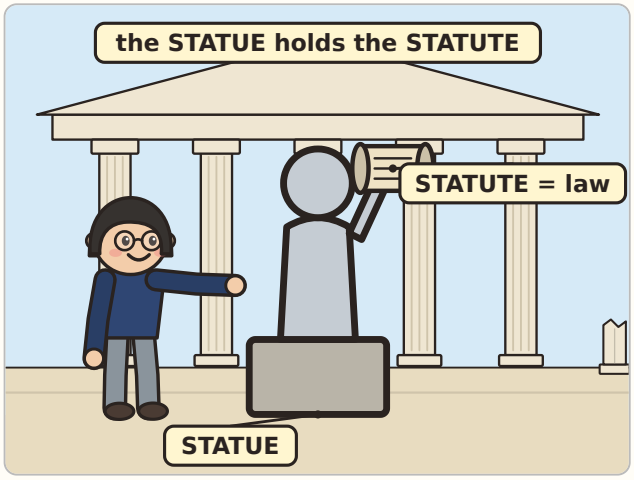
**PARTS** **en** into + **act** a law, a thing done

**SIMILAR** pass, establish, make law

**OPPOSITE** repeal, abolish, rescind



## statute **STACH**-oot *noun*




**MEANING** a written law

**MEMORY HOOK** **the STATUE holds the STATUTE.** In front of the courthouse, a stone statue holds up a scroll: the town's first written law. The statue is art; the scroll is a **statute**.

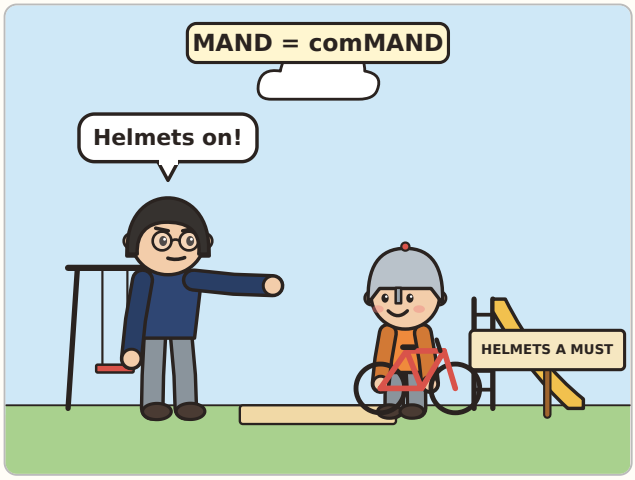
*A* **statute** *passed by the state lawmakers last spring bans fireworks after ten o'clock at night.*

**PARTS** **stat** set up, stand (Latin statuere)

**SIMILAR** law, act, regulation, ordinance



## mandate **MAN**-dayt *noun*




**MEANING** an official order; also, authority given by voters

**MEMORY HOOK** **MAND = comMAND: an official order.** The principal posts the new command by the bike path: "Helmets required." An official order like that is a **mandate**.

*The school board issued a* **mandate***: every student must wear a helmet on the bike path.*

**PARTS** **mand** order, entrust + **-ate** the result of (a noun ending)

**SIMILAR** order, command, directive, authority



## decree dih-**KREE** *noun*




**MEANING** an official order from a ruler or authority

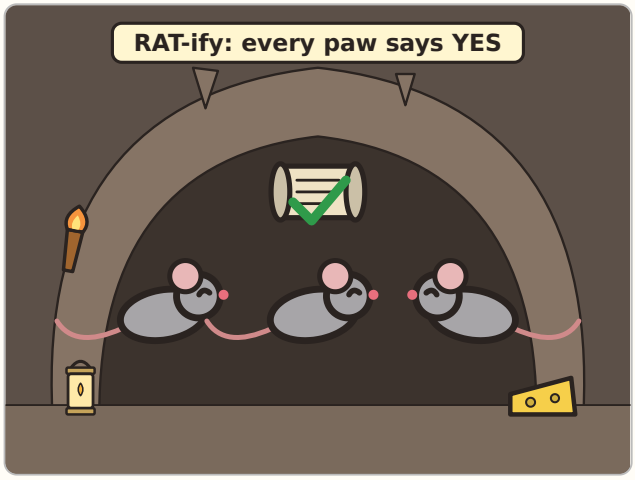
**MEMORY HOOK** **de-CREE: the king DECIDES, all AGREE.** The king raises his scepter: "From now on, every Friday is ice-cream day!" The king decides, and everyone must agree. A ruler's official order is a **decree**.

*By royal* **decree***, the last Friday in June became a holiday.*

**PARTS** **de** from + **cre** decide, sift (Latin cernere)

**SIMILAR** order, edict, command, proclamation

## ratify RAT-uh-fye *verb*




**MEANING** to formally approve an agreement or plan

**MEMORY HOOK** **RAT-ify: every RAT's paw says YES.** The rats hold a meeting on their new cheese-sharing rules, and every paw goes up. When a group formally approves an agreement, they **ratify** it.

*The club members voted to* **ratify** *the new rules.*

**PARTS** **rat** fixed, settled (Latin ratus) + **-ify** to make

**SIMILAR** approve, confirm, endorse, sanction

**OPPOSITE** reject, veto, repeal



## veto VEE-toh *noun*




**MEANING** the power to reject a decision or law, or such a rejection

**MEMORY HOOK** **VETO: Latin for "I FORBID!".** The kids vote three to nothing to adopt a goat, but Mom holds up one hand: "I forbid it." That single blocking vote is a **veto**.

*Mom used her* **veto** *on our plan to adopt a goat.*

**SIMILAR** rejection, refusal, ban, block

**OPPOSITE** approval, ratification, assent



## abolish uh-BOL-ish *verb*




**MEANING** to end something officially, completely and for good

**MEMORY HOOK** **a-BOWL-ish: BOWLED over for good.** The town bowls over the old toll gate on the bridge: no more stopping, no more paying, gone for good. To end something completely is to **abolish** it.

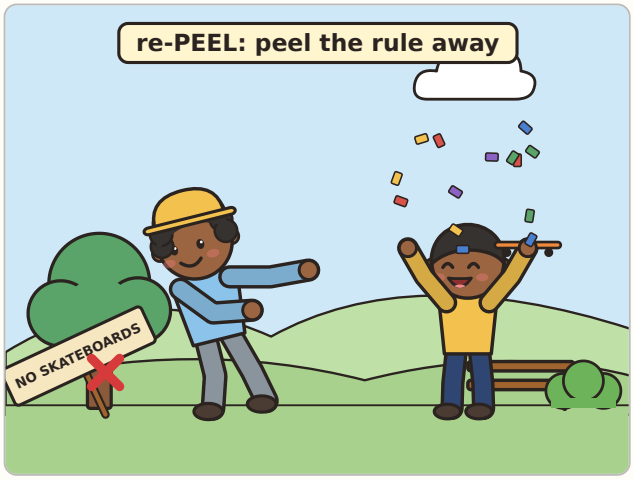
*The school* **abolished** *its old rule against wearing hats in the hallway.*

**SIMILAR** end, eliminate, do away with, scrap

**OPPOSITE** establish, create, institute



## repeal rih-PEEL *verb*




**MEANING** to cancel a law officially

**MEMORY HOOK** **re-PEEL: PEEL the old rule off the wall.** A worker peels the old "NO SKATEBOARDS" sign right off the park wall, and the skaters cheer. To officially cancel a law is to **repeal** it.

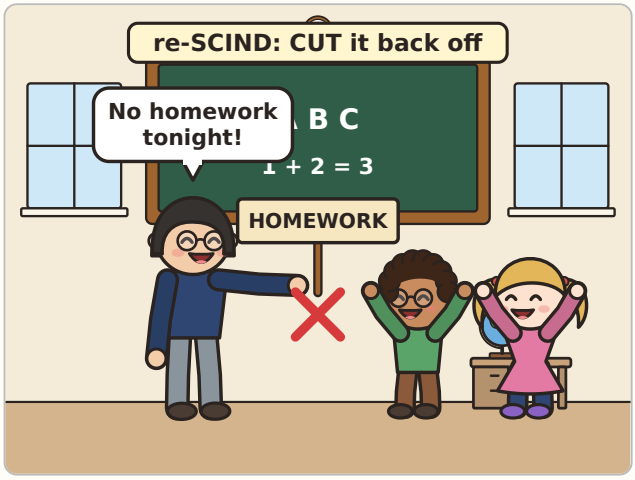
*The city* **repealed** *its old ban on skateboards in the park.*

**PARTS** **re** back + **peal** call (Old French apeler)

**SIMILAR** revoke, rescind, cancel, overturn

**OPPOSITE** enact, pass, ratify

## rescind rih-**SIND** *verb*




**MEANING** to take back or cancel an order, offer or decision

**MEMORY HOOK** **re-SCIND: CUT the order back off.** Ms. Ada writes HOMEWORK on the board, then the class wins the spelling bee, and she crosses it right off. To take back an order is to **rescind** it.

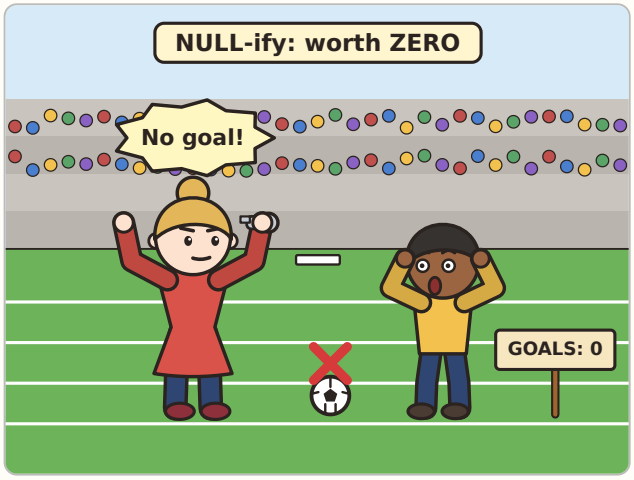
*The coach* **rescinded** *the extra laps after the team apologized.*

**PARTS** **re** back + **scind** cut (Latin scindere)

**SIMILAR** revoke, cancel, withdraw, take back
**OPPOSITE** grant, issue, enact



## nullify **NUL**-uh-fye *verb*




**MEANING** to make legally void; to cancel out

**MEMORY HOOK** **NULL-ify: make it NULL, worth ZERO.** Dev's goal flies in, but the referee blows her whistle and waves it off: offside. The goal now counts for zero; she has **nullified** it.

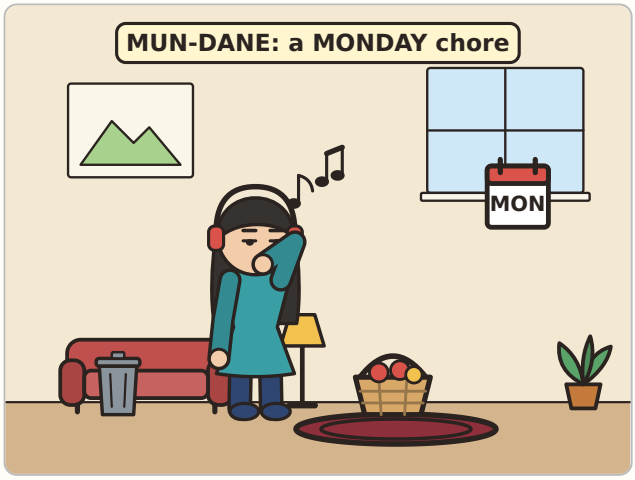
*A missing signature* **nullified** *the contract.*

**PARTS** **null** none, nothing (Latin nullus) + **-ify** to make

**SIMILAR** cancel, void, invalidate, negate
**OPPOSITE** validate, confirm



## mundane mun-**DAYN** *adjective*




**MEANING** ordinary and everyday; dull

**MEMORY HOOK** **MUN-DANE: a MONDAY chore.** Every Monday it is the same: fold the laundry, take out the trash, wash the dishes. Plain, everyday chores like these are **mundane**.

*Folding laundry is a* **mundane** *chore, so Lin listens to music while she does it.*

**PARTS** **mund** world (Latin mundus) + **-ane** having to do with

**SIMILAR** ordinary, everyday, routine, humdrum
**OPPOSITE** extraordinary, exciting, remarkable



## commonplace **KOM**-un-plays *adjective*




**MEANING** ordinary; not unusual

**MEMORY HOOK** **seen in COMMON PLACES everywhere.** A plane roars over the river, and nobody fishing even looks up; you can see planes in common places everywhere. They are **commonplace** now.

*Phones that take pictures, once a wonder, are now* **commonplace**.

**PARTS** **common** shared, ordinary + **place** spot

**SIMILAR** ordinary, common, everyday, routine
**OPPOSITE** rare, unusual, extraordinary

## conventional kun-**VEN**-shuh-nul *adjective*




**MEANING** following what is usually done; traditional

**MEMORY HOOK** **CONVENTION-al: the way everyone agreed on.** At the business convention, every guest wears the same gray jacket and tie, the way everyone agreed long ago. Their style is **conventional**.

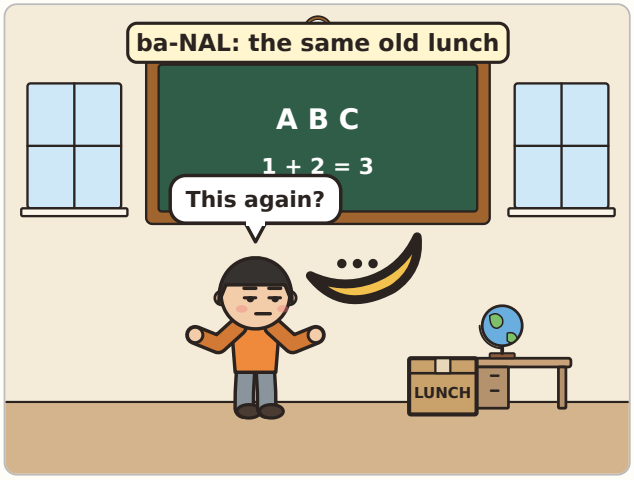
*Instead of a* **conventional** *birthday cake, Dev asked for a tower of pancakes.*

**PARTS** **con** together + **vent** come (Latin venire) + **-ion** the act of + **-al** having to do with

**SIMILAR** traditional, standard, customary, orthodox
**OPPOSITE** unconventional, unusual, original



## banal buh-**NAL** *adjective*




**MEANING** dull and unoriginal because so common

**MEMORY HOOK** **ba-NAL: the same old BANANA.** Every single day, Kai's lunch is one plain banana: no surprise, no change, nothing new. A lunch that dull and predictable is **banal**.

*The movie's ending was* **banal***: the hero won, the villain lost, and everyone cheered, just as we expected.*

**SIMILAR** trite, hackneyed, unoriginal, dull
**OPPOSITE** original, fresh, novel



## trite **TRITE** *adjective*




**MEANING** used so often that it is no longer interesting

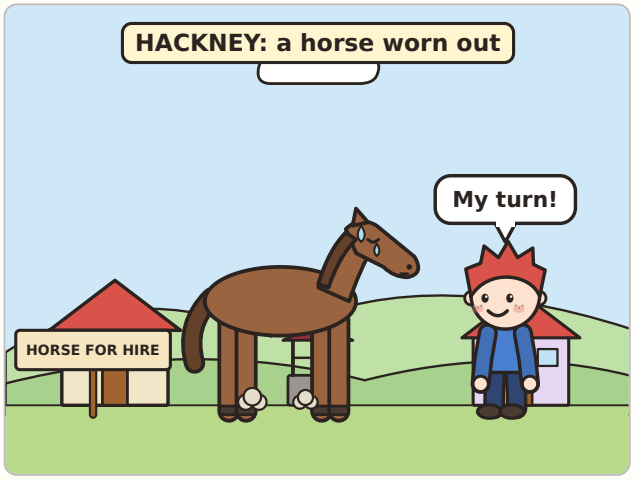
**MEMORY HOOK** **TRITE: TRIED and TRIED and TRIED.** Grandpa tells his favorite joke for the hundredth time, and the whole family groans: it has been tried too many times. The joke is **trite**.

*"Every cloud has a silver lining" felt* **trite** *to Maya right after she lost the match.*

**SIMILAR** overused, hackneyed, stale, clichéd
**OPPOSITE** original, fresh, novel



## hackneyed **HAK**-need *adjective*



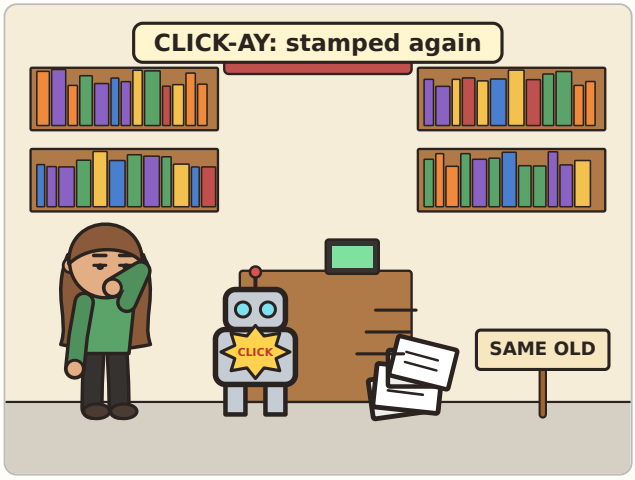

**MEANING** overused and unoriginal

**MEMORY HOOK** **HACKNEY: a hired horse worn out by use.** The old hired horse has carried every tourist in town and now plods along, worn out by use. An idea worn out the same way is **hackneyed**.

*The* **hackneyed** *plot, a lost dog finds its way home, had been filmed a dozen times.*

**SIMILAR** overused, trite, stale, clichéd
**OPPOSITE** original, fresh, innovative

## cliché klee-**SHAY** *noun*




**MEANING** an overused phrase or idea

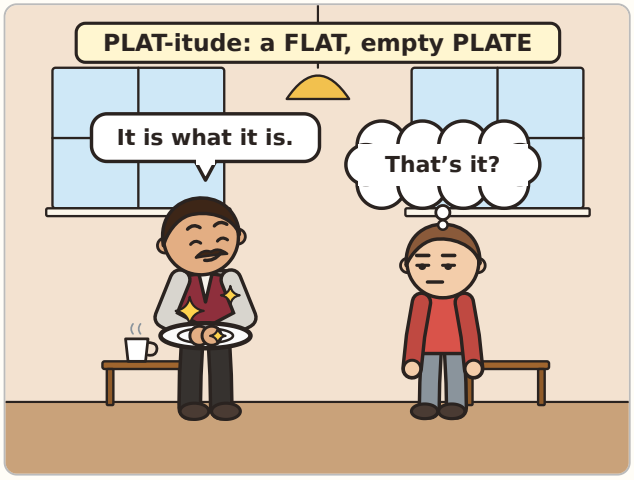
**MEMORY HOOK** **CLICK-AY: CLICK, the same stamp again.** Click! Click! Click! The old printing plate stamps the very same phrase on page after page. A phrase repeated that often is a **cliché**.

*"At the end of the day" is a* **cliché** *that adds nothing to most sentences.*

**SIMILAR** stock phrase, platitude, worn-out saying, commonplace



## platitude **PLAT**-ih-tood *noun*




**MEANING** a dull, obvious remark offered as if it were wise or new

**MEMORY HOOK** **PLAT-itude: a FLAT, empty PLATE.** Uncle Victor serves up an empty plate of wisdom: "Well, it is what it is." A flat, obvious remark offered as if it were deep is a **platitude**.

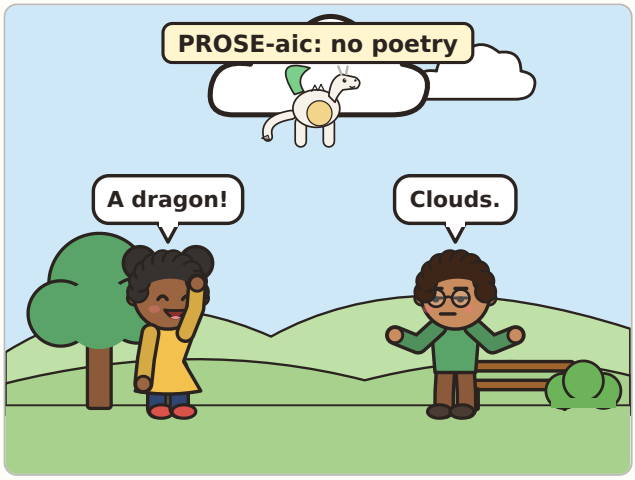
*"Everything happens for a reason" was the only* **platitude** *the coach could offer after the loss.*

**PARTS** **plat** flat (French plat) + **-itude** the state of

**SIMILAR** cliché, truism, commonplace, banality



## prosaic proh-**ZAY**-ik *adjective*




**MEANING** dull and unimaginative; lacking poetry

**MEMORY HOOK** **PROSE-aic: plain PROSE, no poetry.** Zoe looks up and sees a dragon, a castle and a ship in the clouds. Sami looks up and says, "Those are clouds." His plain, unpoetic answer is **prosaic**.

*Asked what the clouds looked like, the* **prosaic** *boy said only, "Clouds."*

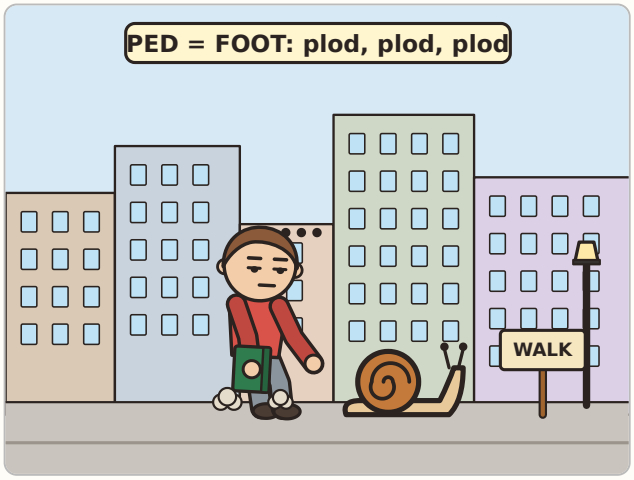
**PARTS** **prosa** prose, plain writing + **-ic** having to do with

**SIMILAR** dull, unimaginative, ordinary, matter-of-fact

**OPPOSITE** imaginative, poetic, inspired



## pedestrian puh-**DES**-tree-un *adjective*




**MEANING** ordinary and dull; lacking imagination

**MEMORY HOOK** **PED = FOOT: plods along, never flies.** Jonah's story plods along like a tired walker, step, step, step, with a snail for company. Writing that never takes flight is **pedestrian**.

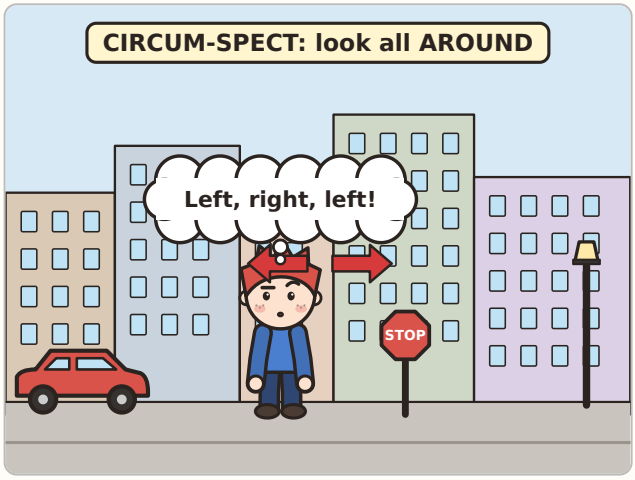
*The band's second album was* **pedestrian** *compared with its brilliant first one.*

**PARTS** **ped** foot

**SIMILAR** dull, uninspired, ordinary, mediocre

**OPPOSITE** inspired, exciting, original

## circumspect **SUR**-kum-spekt *adjective*




**MEANING** careful to think about risks before acting

**MEMORY HOOK** **CIRCUM-SPECT: look all AROUND.** Before Pip crosses the busy street, he looks all around: left, right and left again. Looking all around before you act is being **circumspect**.

*A* **circumspect** *hiker checks the weather twice before setting out.*

**PARTS** **circum** around + **spect** look

**SIMILAR** cautious, careful, wary, prudent
**OPPOSITE** rash, reckless, careless



## introspective in-truh-**SPEK**-tiv *adjective*




**MEANING** looking inward at your own thoughts and feelings

**MEMORY HOOK** **INTRO-SPECT: look IN.** Lila holds a magnifying glass up to her own heart: she is looking inside herself. A person who looks in like that is **introspective**.

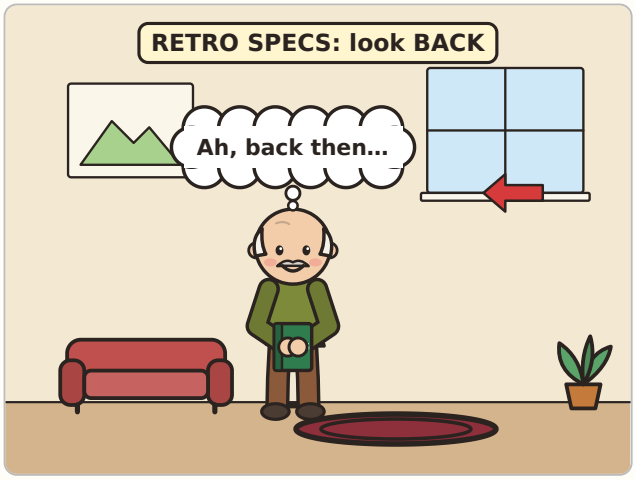
*After the game, the* **introspective** *pitcher sat alone, replaying every choice he had made.*

**PARTS** **intro** inward, within + **spect** look + **-ive** tending to (an adjective ending)

**SIMILAR** reflective, thoughtful, self-examining, contemplative
**OPPOSITE** unreflective, outward-looking



## retrospect **RET**-ruh-spekt *noun*




**MEANING** a look back at things that have already happened

**MEMORY HOOK** **RETRO SPECS: glasses that look back.** Grandpa Gus puts on his old-fashioned specs and pages through photos from fifty years ago. Looking back like that is **retrospect**.

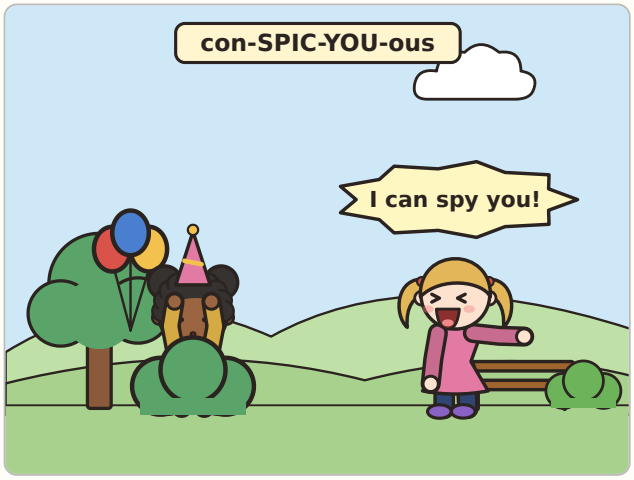
*In* **retrospect**, *packing three sweaters for a beach trip was silly.*

**PARTS** **retro** backward + **spect** look

**SIMILAR** hindsight, looking back, review, remembrance
**OPPOSITE** foresight, prospect



## conspicuous kun-**SPIK**-yoo-us *adjective*




**MEANING** easy to see or notice; standing out

**MEMORY HOOK** **I CAN SPY YOU: con-SPIC-YOU-ous.** Zoe hides behind a little bush, but her balloons and party hat stick out. “I can spy you!” Ivy calls. Zoe is **conspicuous**.

*Dad’s orange hat made him* **conspicuous** *in the crowd at the airport.*

**PARTS** **con** thoroughly + **spic** look + **-uous** having (an adjective ending)

**SIMILAR** noticeable, obvious, eye-catching, prominent
**OPPOSITE** inconspicuous, hidden, unnoticeable

## auspicious aw-**SPISH**-us *adjective*




**MEANING** promising good things to come; favorable

**MEMORY HOOK** **AW, SPECIAL! a rainbow on race day.** On the morning of the big race, a rainbow arches over the track and Tia gasps, "Aw, special!" A sign that things will go well is **auspicious**.

*A sunny sky on opening day was an* **auspicious** *start for the new farmers' market.*

**PARTS** **au** bird + **spic** look + **-ious** full of

**SIMILAR** promising, favorable, hopeful, encouraging
**OPPOSITE** ominous, unpromising, inauspicious



## specious **SPEE**-shus *adjective*




**MEANING** seeming true or right at first but false underneath

**MEMORY HOOK** **SEE? SHUSH! Don't check it.** "See? Shush, don't check!" says the salesman, because his claim only sounds right until someone looks closely. It is **specious**.

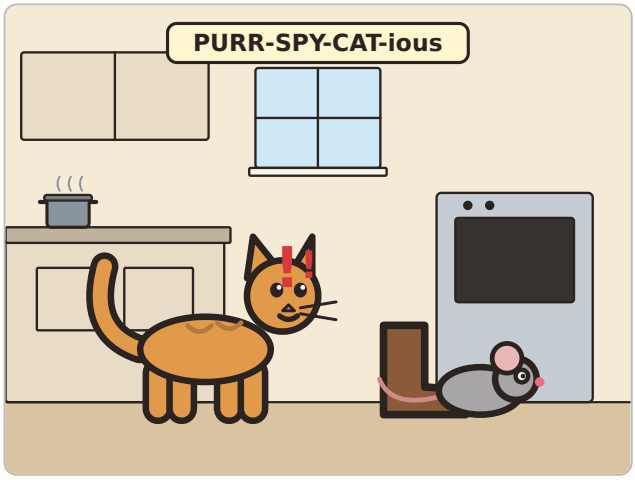
*The ad's* **specious** *promise that the shoes would make anyone run faster fooled no one on the track team.*

**PARTS** **spec** look, appearance + **-ious** full of

**SIMILAR** misleading, deceptive, false, hollow
**OPPOSITE** sound, valid, genuine



## perspicacious pur-spih-**KAY**-shus *adjective*




**MEANING** quick to notice and understand things; sharp-minded

**MEMORY HOOK** **PURR-SPY-CAT: she sees through it all.** The Purr-Spy Cat spots the mouse hiding by the boot that everyone else walked right past. A sharp noticer like her is **perspicacious**.

*The* **perspicacious** *detective noticed that the muddy boots were two sizes too small.*

**PARTS** **per** through + **spic** look + **-acious** inclined to, full of

**SIMILAR** perceptive, sharp, shrewd, insightful
**OPPOSITE** obtuse, dull, slow-witted



## provident **PROV**-ih-dunt *adjective*




**MEANING** planning wisely for the future, especially by saving

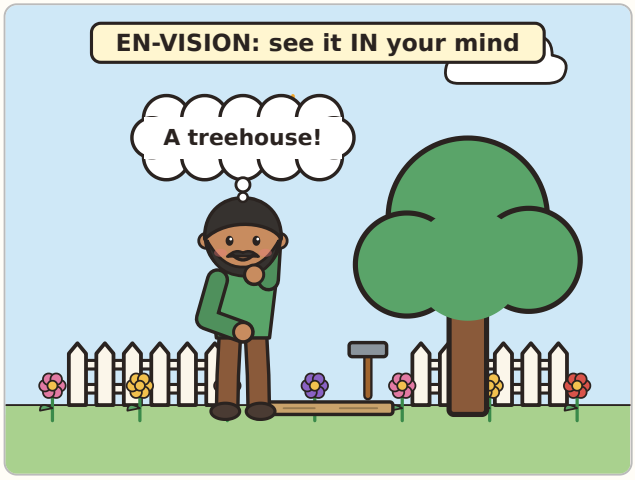
**MEMORY HOOK** **PROVIDE-ent: see winter coming, PROVIDE for it.** The squirrel sees winter coming and provides for it, one basket of food at a time. Seeing ahead and saving is being **provident**.

*The* **provident** *squirrel buried nuts all autumn and ate well all winter.*

**PARTS** **pro** ahead, forward + **vid** see + **-ent** being or doing (an adjective ending)

**SIMILAR** prudent, thrifty, farsighted, careful
**OPPOSITE** improvident, wasteful, shortsighted

## envision en-**VIZH**-un *verb*




**MEANING** to picture something in the mind, especially something that could happen

**MEMORY HOOK** **EN-VISION: see it IN your head.** Before Omar saws a single board, he can see the whole treehouse in his head. To **envision** is to see it in your mind first.

*Ada could* **envision** *the empty lot as a garden full of sunflowers.*

**PARTS** **en** in, into + **vis** see + **-ion** the act of (a noun ending)

**SIMILAR** imagine, picture, visualize, foresee



## visage **viz**-ij *noun*




**MEANING** a person's face, or the look on it

**MEMORY HOOK** **VIS-AGE: the face shows your AGE.** Grandpa's face in the mirror shows his age: every smile line from eighty happy years. That face is his **visage**.

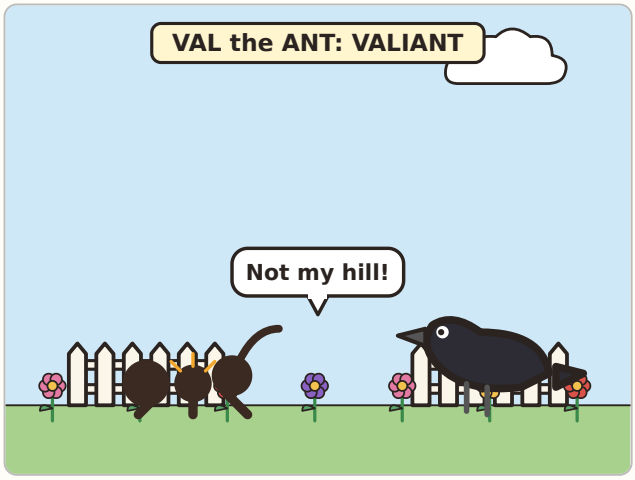
*The old captain's weathered* **visage** *broke into a wide grin.*

**PARTS** **vis** see, a look

**SIMILAR** face, countenance, features, expression



## valiant **val**-yunt *adjective*




**MEANING** brave and determined, especially in a hard fight

**MEMORY HOOK** **VAL the ANT: small but VALIANT.** Val the ant plants her feet and faces the hungry crow to guard her hill. Tiny Val is **valiant**.

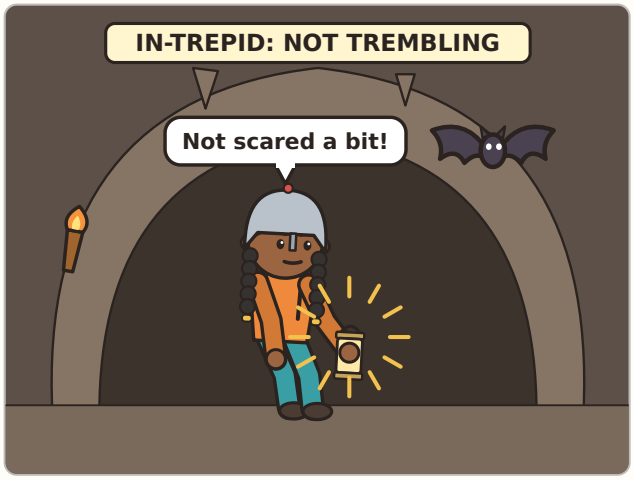
*The* **valiant** *firefighters carried every last puppy out of the burning shelter.*

**SIMILAR** brave, courageous, heroic, bold

**OPPOSITE** cowardly, craven, timid



## intrepid in-**trep**-id *adjective*




**MEANING** fearless and adventurous

**MEMORY HOOK** **IN-TREPID: NOT TREMBLING.** Trepid means trembling, and in- means not. Tia steps into the dark cave with her lantern without a single shiver: she is **intrepid**.

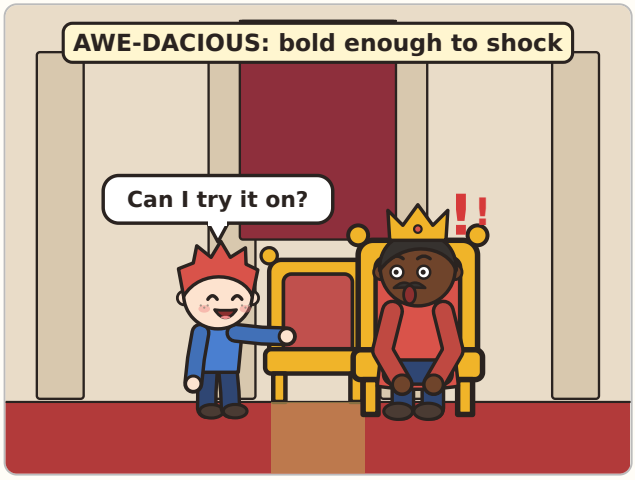
*The* **intrepid** *explorer paddled alone up the unmapped river.*

**PARTS** **in-** not + **trepid** trembling, alarmed

**SIMILAR** fearless, brave, bold, daring

**OPPOSITE** timid, fearful, timorous

## audacious aw-**DAY**-shus *adjective*




**MEANING** boldly daring, sometimes to the point of rudeness

**MEMORY HOOK** **AWE-DACIOUS: so bold it leaves us in AWE.** Little Pip marches up to the king and asks to try on his crown. The whole court gasps in awe at such an **audacious** request.

*Asking the famous chef for her secret recipe on live TV was an* **audacious** *move.*

**PARTS** **aud** dare (from Latin audere) + **-acious** full of, inclined to

**SIMILAR** daring, bold, brazen, gutsy

**OPPOSITE** timid, cautious, meek



## dauntless **DAWNT**-lis *adjective*




**MEANING** not discouraged by danger or difficulty

**MEMORY HOOK** **DAWN-TLESS: out at DAWN in any storm.** Every day at dawn, through snow and howling wind, Greta delivers the mail. No storm can discourage her: she is **dauntless**.

*The* **dauntless** *mail carrier delivered every letter through the blizzard.*

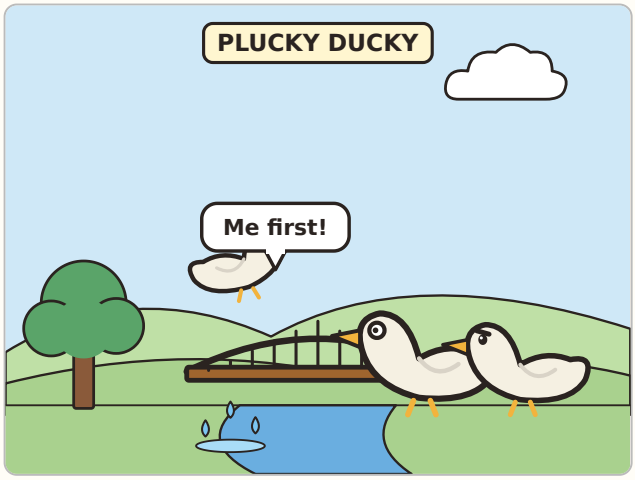
**PARTS** **daunt** to frighten, discourage + **-less** without

**SIMILAR** undaunted, fearless, brave, unflinching

**OPPOSITE** fainthearted, timid, discouraged



## plucky **PLUK**-ee *adjective*




**MEANING** brave and spirited, especially against the odds

**MEMORY HOOK** **PLUCKY DUCKY.** The smallest duckling plucks up her courage and leaps into the pond first, ahead of all the big ducks. That brave little bird is **plucky**.

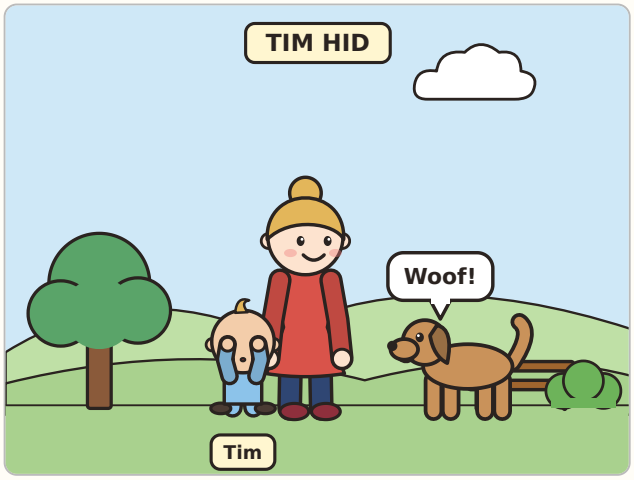
*The* **plucky** *little goalie stopped shot after shot from the older team.*

**SIMILAR** spirited, gutsy, brave, spunky

**OPPOSITE** timid, fainthearted, cowardly



## timid **TIM**-id *adjective*




**MEANING** easily frightened; shy

**MEMORY HOOK** **TIM HID behind Mom.** When the friendly puppy trots up, little Tim hides behind his mom's legs. Shy, easily frightened Tim is **timid**.

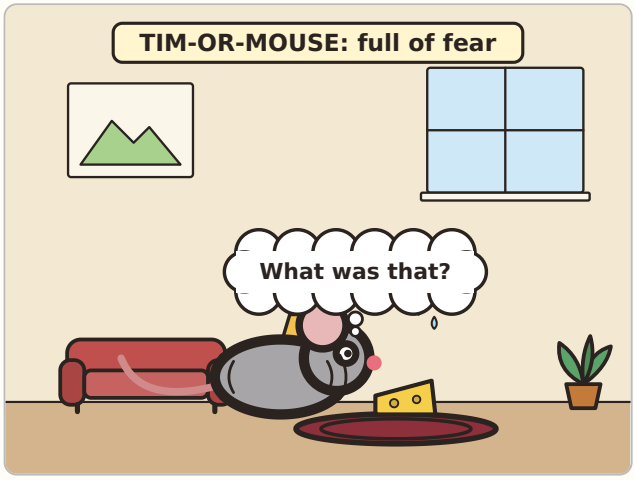
*The* **timid** *kitten hid under the bed whenever the doorbell rang.*

**PARTS** **tim** fear + **-id** having a quality (an adjective ending)

**SIMILAR** shy, fearful, timorous, nervous

**OPPOSITE** bold, confident, brave

## timorous TIM-er-us *adjective*




**MEANING** fearful and nervous by nature

**MEMORY HOOK** **TIM-OR-MOUSE: a mouse full of fear.** Timmy the mouse trembles at every creak of the floor and every shadow on the wall. A creature that is always afraid is **timorous**.

*The* **timorous** *deer froze at the snap of a twig.*

**PARTS** **tim** fear + **-orous** full of

**SIMILAR** fearful, timid, nervous, jumpy
**OPPOSITE** bold, brave, fearless



## apprehensive ap-rih-**HEN**-siv *adjective*




**MEANING** worried that something bad may happen

**MEMORY HOOK** **a-pre-HEN-sive: a worried HEN.** The hen spots a fox sniffing around the coop and cannot sleep all night, worrying about what he might do. She is **apprehensive**.

*Jonah was* **apprehensive** *about his first day at the new school.*

**PARTS** **ad** to, toward + **prehend** seize, grasp + **-ive** tending to

**SIMILAR** uneasy, anxious, worried, nervous
**OPPOSITE** calm, confident, carefree



## trepidation trep-ih-**DAY**-shun *noun*




**MEANING** nervous fear about something that is about to happen

**MEMORY HOOK** **TREP-idation: TREMBLING before.** Before his solo, Kai's knees knock and his bow shakes. That trembling fear of what is about to happen is **trepidation**.

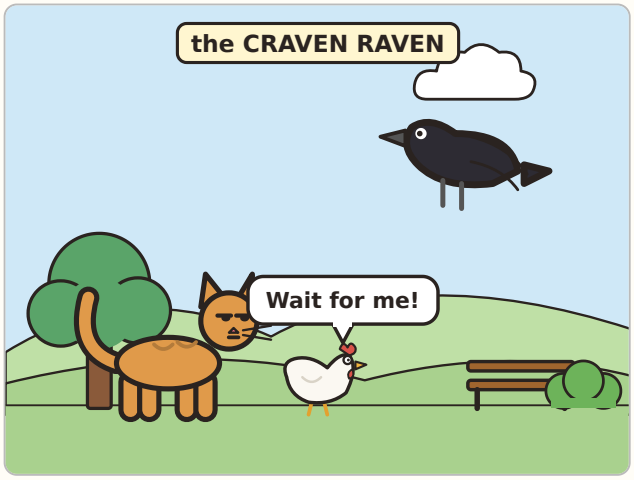
*With some* **trepidation**, *Kai stepped onto the stage for his first violin solo.*

**PARTS** **trepid** trembling, alarmed + **-ation** the act or state of

**SIMILAR** dread, apprehension, fear, alarm
**OPPOSITE** calm, confidence, composure



## craven **KRAY**-vun *adjective*



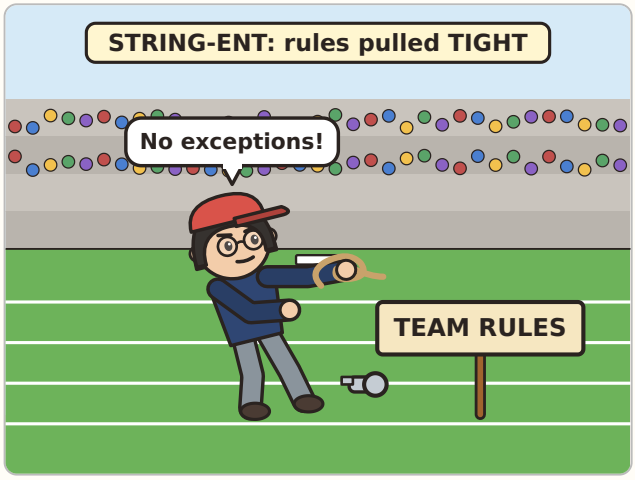

**MEANING** shamefully cowardly

**MEMORY HOOK** **the CRAVEN RAVEN.** When the cat creeps close, the raven flies off and leaves the little birds to fend for themselves. That shameful coward is a **craven** raven.

*The* **craven** *guard dropped his post and ran at the first sound of trouble.*

**SIMILAR** cowardly, spineless, fainthearted, fearful
**OPPOSITE** brave, valiant, courageous

## stringent **STRIN**-junt *adjective*




**MEANING** strict and exact about rules or standards

**MEMORY HOOK** **STRING-ent: rules pulled STRING-tight.** Coach Ada keeps her team rules pulled as tight as a string: no slack, no exceptions. Rules that tight are **stringent**.

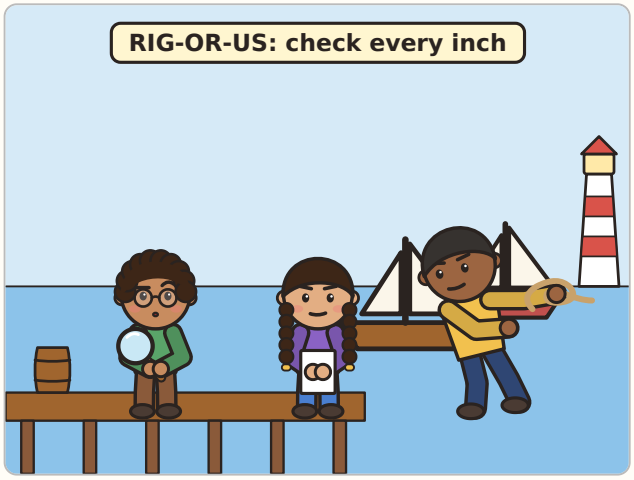
*The pool has* **stringent** *rules: no running, no glass and no swimming without a lifeguard.*

**PARTS** **string** draw tight (from Latin stringere) + **-ent** being or doing (an adjective ending)

**SIMILAR** strict, rigid, tight, demanding
**OPPOSITE** lax, lenient, loose



## rigorous **RIG**-er-us *adjective*




**MEANING** extremely thorough and careful

**MEMORY HOOK** **check the RIG, ALL of US.** Before the sailboat race, all of us check every rope and knot of the rig, then check them again. An inspection that careful is **rigorous**.

*After a* **rigorous** *search of the house, Mom found the missing key inside the cereal box.*

**PARTS** **rigor** stiffness, strictness + **-ous** full of

**SIMILAR** thorough, meticulous, strict, demanding
**OPPOSITE** sloppy, careless, lax



## exacting ig-**ZAK**-ting *adjective*




**MEANING** demanding great effort, care or skill

**MEMORY HOOK** **EXACT-ing: it must be EXACT.** Chef Lin makes her new cook measure the sugar again and again until it is exact. A boss who demands that much care is **exacting**.

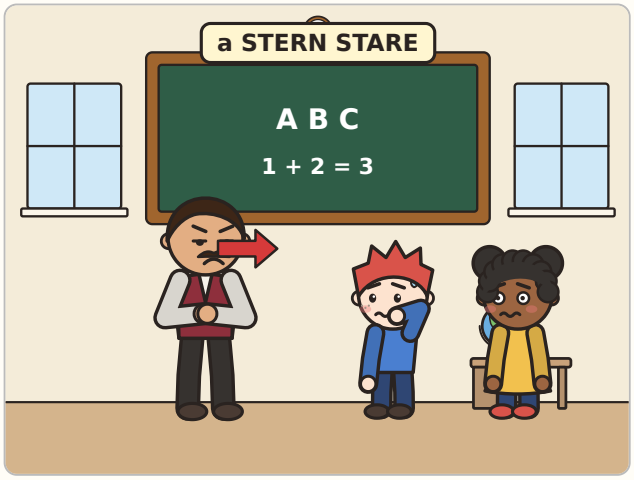
*The* **exacting** *piano teacher made Rosa play the hard measure twenty times.*

**PARTS** **ex** out + **act** drive, do (from Latin agere)

**SIMILAR** demanding, strict, painstaking, tough
**OPPOSITE** easy, undemanding, lax



## stern **STURN** *adjective*




**MEANING** serious and strict in manner

**MEMORY HOOK** **a STERN STARE.** Principal Victor gives the noisy hallway one long stare, and everyone falls silent. A serious, strict look like that is **stern**.

*One* **stern** *look from the librarian quieted the whole table.*

**SIMILAR** strict, severe, serious, grim
**OPPOSITE** gentle, lenient, kindly

## draconian dray-**KOH**-nee-un *adjective*




**MEANING** far too harsh and severe

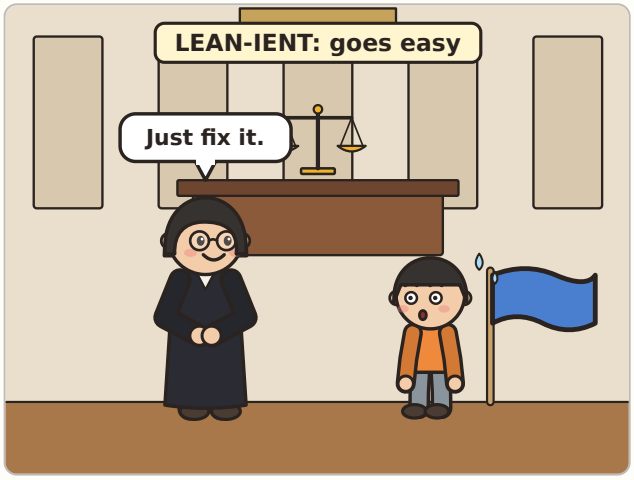
**MEMORY HOOK** **DRAGON-IAN rules: way too harsh.** In the dragon's castle the rule is: take one cookie and get no dessert for a whole year. Rules that harsh are **draconian**.

*Taking away recess for a whole month for one late homework is* **draconian**.

**SIMILAR** harsh, severe, strict, brutal
**OPPOSITE** lenient, mild, merciful



## lenient **LEE**-nee-unt *adjective*




**MEANING** merciful; less strict or harsh than expected

**MEMORY HOOK** **LEAN-IENT: the judge LEANS toward mercy.** The judge leans down, smiles at the nervous boy who broke a window, and says, "Just fix it and say sorry." She is **lenient**.

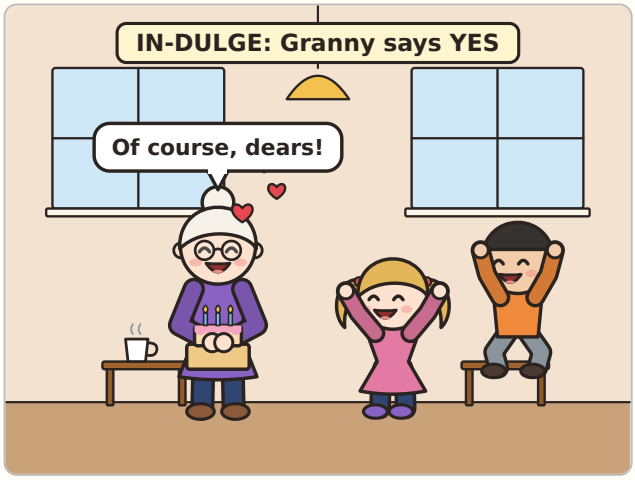
*The* **lenient** *referee let the little kids redo their throw-ins.*

**PARTS** **leni** soft, mild (from Latin lenis) + **-ent** being or doing (an adjective ending)

**SIMILAR** merciful, forgiving, easygoing, tolerant
**OPPOSITE** strict, harsh, stern



## indulgent in-**DUL**-junt *adjective*




**MEANING** quick to give others what they want; not strict

**MEMORY HOOK** **IN-DULGE: Granny says yes to everything.** Granny Mae indulges every wish: cake for breakfast, a pony ride, staying up late. A granny who gives the kids whatever they want is **indulgent**.

*The* **indulgent** *aunt let the twins eat birthday cake for breakfast.*

**SIMILAR** easygoing, doting, permissive, soft
**OPPOSITE** strict, stern, stringent



## permissive per-**MIS**-iv *adjective*




**MEANING** allowing a great deal of freedom

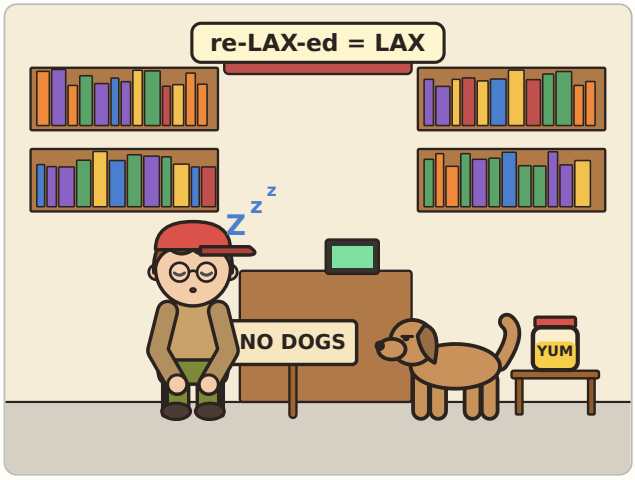
**MEMORY HOOK** **PERMISS-IVE: PERMISSION for everything.** At Uncle Omar's house you have permission for everything: pillow fights, pancakes at midnight, a fort in the living room. His house is **permissive**.

*The camp had a* **permissive** *bedtime: campers could stay up as long as they were quiet.*

**PARTS** **per** through + **miss** let go, send + **-ive** tending to

**SIMILAR** easygoing, liberal, tolerant, indulgent
**OPPOSITE** strict, restrictive, stringent

## lax **LAKS** *adjective*




**MEANING** not strict or careful enough; loose

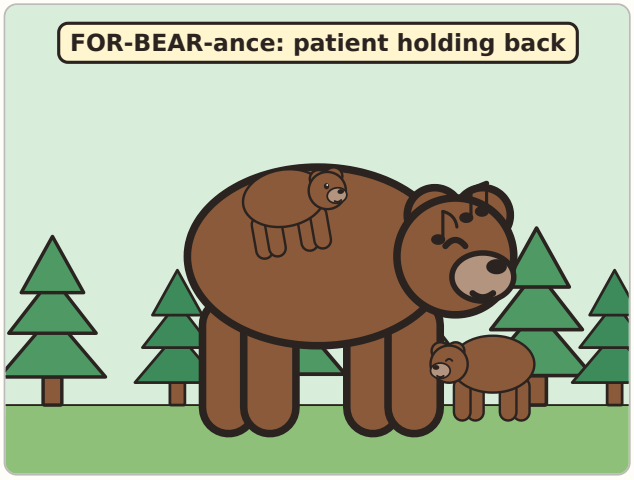
**MEMORY HOOK** **reLAXed: too relaxed to do the job.** The guard is so relaxed that he naps in his chair while the dog helps himself to the cookies. That careless guard is **lax**.

*Security at the cookie jar was* **lax**, *and the dog took full advantage.*

**SIMILAR** slack, loose, careless, easygoing
**OPPOSITE** strict, rigorous, careful



## forbearance for-**BAIR**-uns *noun*




**MEANING** patient self-control; holding back from anger or punishment

**MEMORY HOOK** **FOR-BEAR-ance: the patient BEAR.** The cubs tug the big bear's ears and climb on his back, but he never growls; he just waits. That patient holding back is **forbearance**.

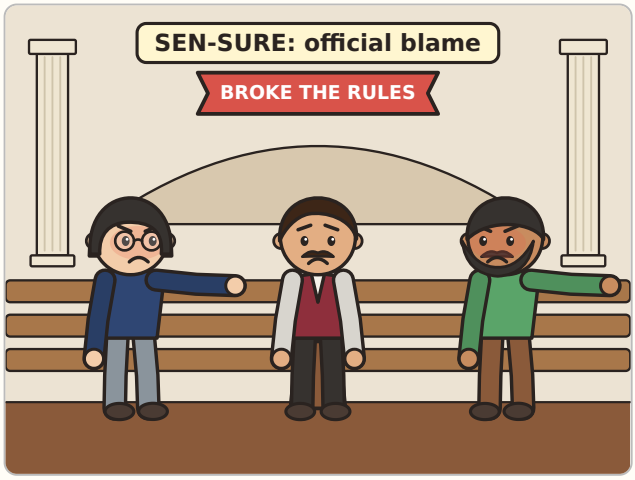
*The babysitter showed great* **forbearance** *when the twins painted the kitchen door blue.*

**PARTS** **forbear** to hold back + **-ance** the act or state of

**SIMILAR** patience, restraint, tolerance, self-control
**OPPOSITE** impatience, intolerance



## censure **SEN**-sher *verb*




**MEANING** to criticize strongly and officially

**MEMORY HOOK** **SEN-SURE: the council is SURE you were wrong.** The whole council stands up and votes together: they are sure their member broke the rules. To **censure** is to blame someone officially.

*The school board voted to* **censure** *the member who leaked the private report.*

**SIMILAR** condemn, criticize, reprove, denounce
**OPPOSITE** praise, commend, approve



## rebuke rih-**BYOOK** *verb*



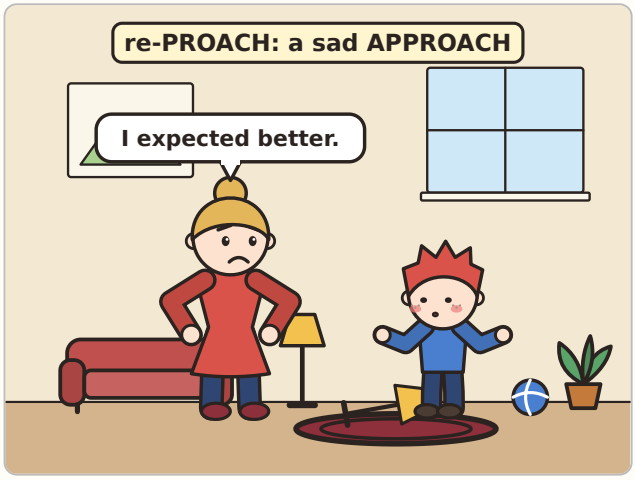

**MEANING** to scold someone sharply

**MEMORY HOOK** **RE-BOOK: the BOOKS fell AGAIN.** When Kai knocks the books off the shelf a second time, the librarian snaps, "Not again, young man!" She **rebukes** him sharply.

*The lifeguard* **rebuked** *the boys for running on the wet deck.*

**SIMILAR** scold, reprove, reprimand, upbraid
**OPPOSITE** praise, compliment, commend

## reproach rih-**PROHCH** *verb*




**MEANING** to tell someone you are disappointed in what they did

**MEMORY HOOK** **the sad APPROACH: re-PROACH.** Mom approaches the broken lamp, sighs and says, "I expected better from you." To **reproach** someone is to show your disappointment in them.

*Grandma did not yell; she simply* **reproached** *him with a sad shake of her head.*

**SIMILAR** scold, reprove, upbraid, blame
**OPPOSITE** praise, commend



## admonish ad-**MON**-ish *verb*




**MEANING** to warn or scold gently but firmly

**MEMORY HOOK** **ad-MOM-ish: a gentle MOM-ish warning.** "Helmet on, please," says Mom, in her gentle but firm Mom-ish way. To **admonish** is to warn someone gently but firmly.

*The coach* **admonished** *the players to drink water before practice.*

**PARTS** **ad** to, toward + **mon** warn, remind

**SIMILAR** warn, caution, counsel, advise
**OPPOSITE** praise, encourage



## reprimand **REP**-ruh-mand *verb*




**MEANING** to scold formally, as a boss or official does

**MEMORY HOOK** **a RAP on the HAND from the boss.** The boss calls Dev into her office and gives him a formal rap on the hand for the late report. To **reprimand** is to scold officially.

*The manager* **reprimanded** *the clerk for leaving the register open.*

**PARTS** **re** back + **prim** press (from Latin premere)

**SIMILAR** scold, rebuke, reprove, discipline
**OPPOSITE** praise, commend, reward



## chastise chas-**TIZE** *verb*



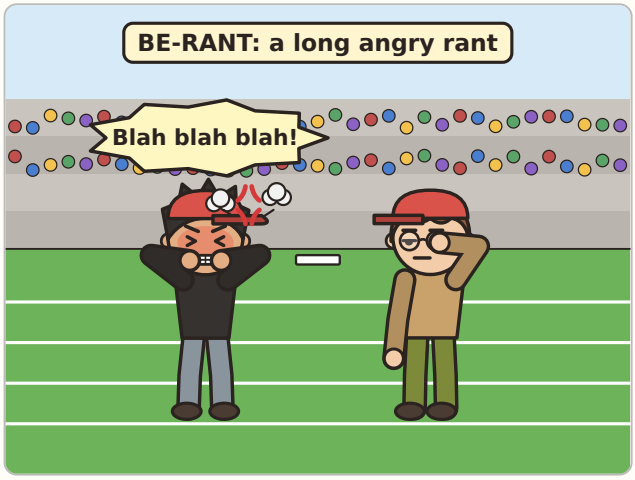

**MEANING** to scold or punish severely

**MEMORY HOOK** **CHASE-TISE: chased and scolded.** The farmer chases the goats out of his garden, scolding them hard the whole way. To **chastise** is to scold or punish severely.

*The farmer* **chastised** *his son for leaving the barn door open all night.*

**SIMILAR** scold, castigate, punish, discipline
**OPPOSITE** praise, reward, commend

## berate bih-**RAYT** *verb*




**MEANING** to scold angrily and at length

**MEMORY HOOK** **BE-RANT: a long, angry rant.** Rex rants at the umpire for ten whole minutes over one call, shouting and stomping. To **berate** someone is to scold them angrily and at length.

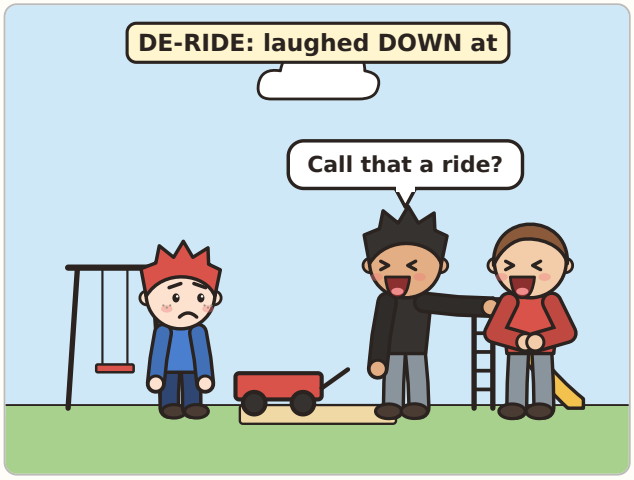
*The fan* **berated** *the umpire for ten straight minutes over one call.*

**PARTS** **be-** thoroughly (an English prefix) + **rate** to scold (an old verb)

**SIMILAR** scold, upbraid, rail at, yell at
**OPPOSITE** praise, compliment



## deride dih-**RIDE** *verb*




**MEANING** to mock and make fun of with scorn

**MEMORY HOOK** **DE-RIDE: "You call that a RIDE?".** The older kids point and laugh at Pip's homemade cart: "Ha! You call that a ride?" To **deride** is to mock with scorn.

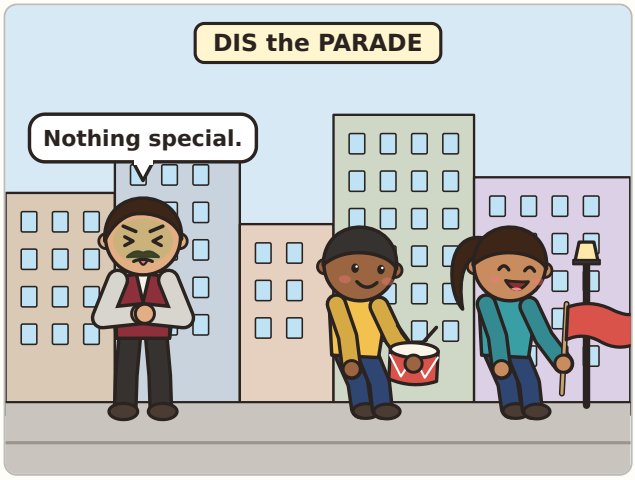
*Some kids* **derided** *her homemade costume, but it won first prize.*

**PARTS** **de** down + **rid** laugh

**SIMILAR** mock, ridicule, scorn, jeer at
**OPPOSITE** praise, admire, respect



## disparage dih-**SPAIR**-ij *verb*




**MEANING** to speak of something as if it had little worth

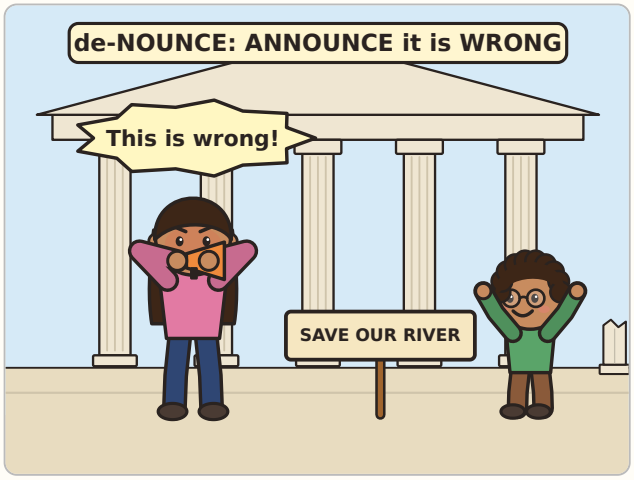
**MEMORY HOOK** **DIS the PARADE.** Victor stands at the curb and disses the whole parade: "Silly floats, tiny band, nothing special." To **disparage** something is to talk about it as if it had little worth.

*He* **disparaged** *his sister's painting as "just a bunch of blobs."*

**SIMILAR** belittle, run down, put down, scorn
**OPPOSITE** praise, extol, celebrate



## denounce dih-**NOWNS** *verb*




**MEANING** to declare publicly that something is wrong or evil

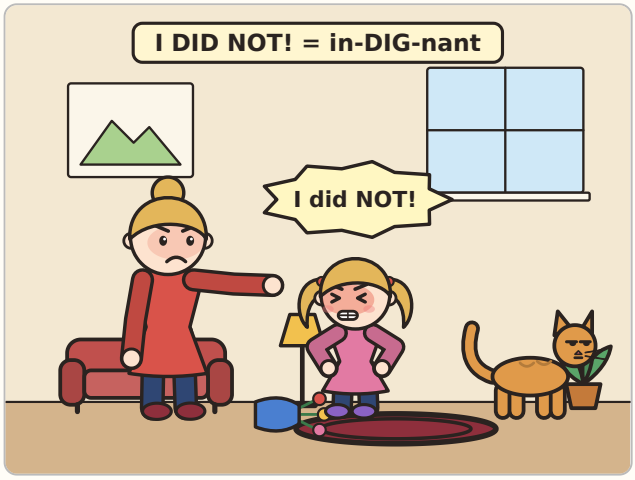
**MEMORY HOOK** **de-NOUNCE: ANNOUNCE it is WRONG.** From the town hall steps, the mayor announces to everyone that dumping trash in the river is wrong and must stop. To **denounce** is to declare publicly that something is wrong.

*The mayor* **denounced** *the dumping of trash in the river.*

**PARTS** **de** down, completely + **nounce** announce, report

**SIMILAR** condemn, decry, criticize, speak out against
**OPPOSITE** praise, support, defend

## indignant in-**DIG**-nunt *adjective*




**MEANING** angry because something seems unfair

**MEMORY HOOK** **in-DIG-NANT: "I did NOT!".** Ivy is blamed for the broken vase she never touched. "I did NOT!" she cries, angry at the unfairness. She is **indignant**.

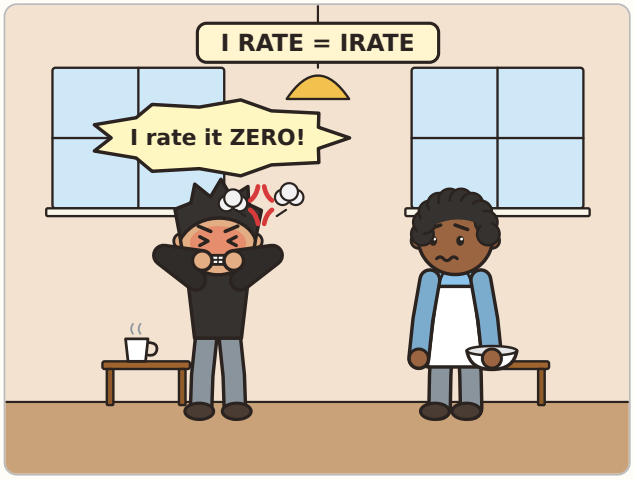
*Ivy was* **indignant** *when she was blamed for the vase the cat had broken.*

**PARTS** **in-** not + **dign** worthy + **-ant** being or doing (an adjective ending)

**SIMILAR** outraged, offended, resentful, aggrieved
**OPPOSITE** pleased, content, satisfied



## irate eye-**RAYT** *adjective*




**MEANING** very angry, often loudly so

**MEMORY HOOK** **"I RATE it ZERO!".** Rex finds his soup stone cold, turns red and shouts, "I rate this place zero stars!" He is **irate**.

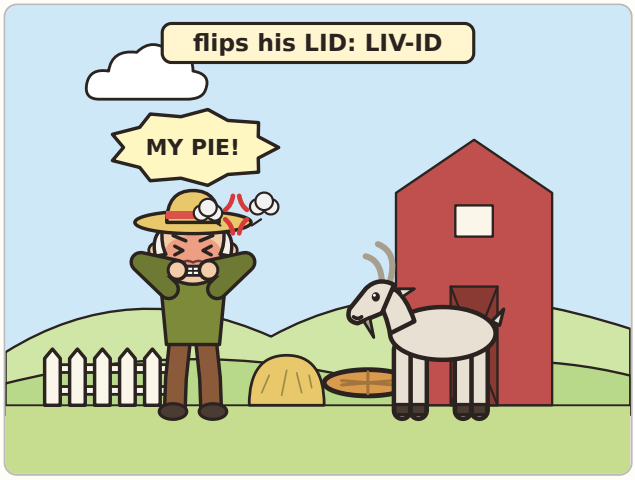
*Usually the calmest man on the street, Mr. Lee was* **irate** *when he found his garden trampled.*

**PARTS** **ira** anger + **-ate** having (an adjective ending)

**SIMILAR** furious, enraged, outraged, fuming
**OPPOSITE** calm, pleased, content



## livid **LIV**-id *adjective*




**MEANING** furious; also, bluish-gray in color

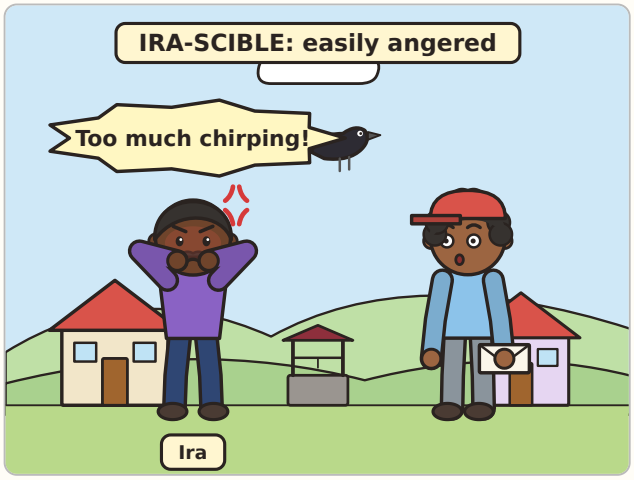
**MEMORY HOOK** **he flips his LID: LIV-ID.** When the goat eats his prize pie, Farmer Gus is so furious he flips his lid. He is **livid**.

*Dad was* **livid** *when he saw the scratch on his new car.*

**SIMILAR** furious, enraged, fuming, outraged
**OPPOSITE** calm, pleased



## irascible ih-**RAS**-uh-bul *adjective*




**MEANING** easily angered; quick-tempered

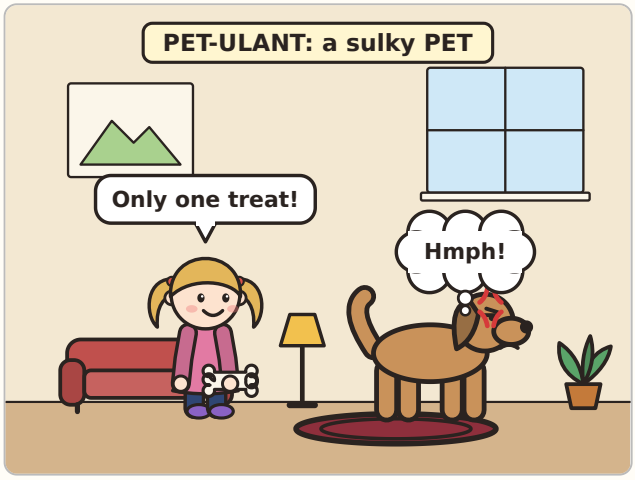
**MEMORY HOOK** **IRA-SCIBLE: IRA flares up at everything.** Old Ira snaps at the mail carrier, the wind and even the birds; the smallest thing sets him off. Ira is **irascible**.

*The* **irascible** *old cat hissed at anyone who came near its basket.*

**PARTS** **ira** anger + **-ible** apt to, able to

**SIMILAR** hot-tempered, testy, cranky, touchy
**OPPOSITE** easygoing, good-natured, calm

## petulant **PECH**-uh-lunt *adjective*




**MEANING** childishly sulky and bad-tempered

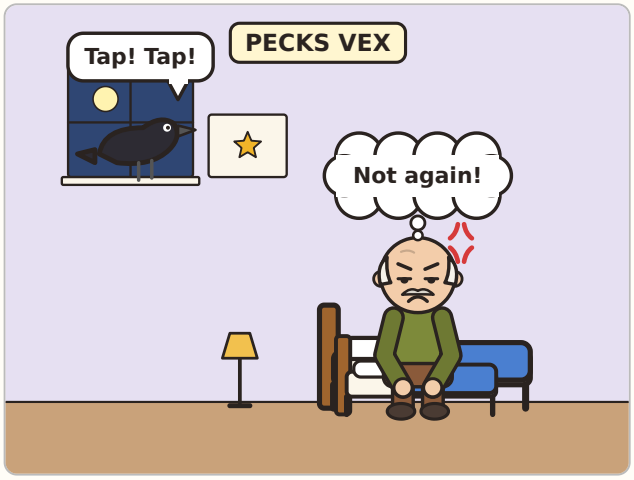
**MEMORY HOOK** **PET-ulant: sulks like a spoiled PET.** When he doesn't get a second treat, Biscuit the puppy turns his back and sulks. What a **petulant** pet!

*Told to turn off his game, the* **petulant** *boy pouted, sulked and stomped up the stairs.*

**SIMILAR** sulky, peevish, cranky, testy
**OPPOSITE** good-humored, cheerful, easygoing



## vex **VEKS** *verb*




**MEANING** to annoy, puzzle or frustrate

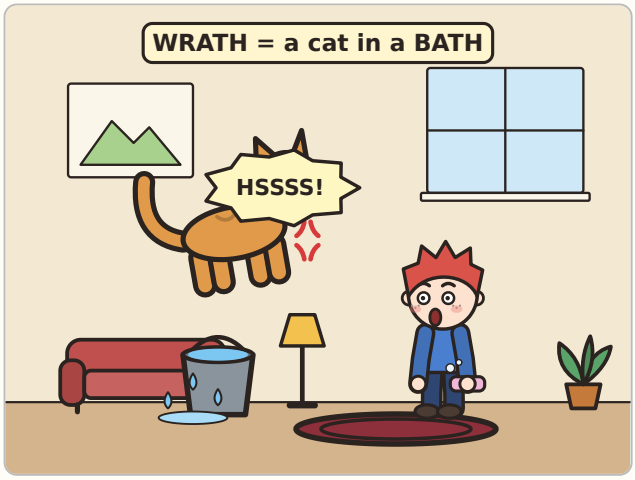
**MEMORY HOOK** **PECKS VEX.** Tap, tap, tap: every morning at five, a crow pecks at Grandpa's window. Those pecks **vex** him no end.

*The squeaky door* **vexed** *Grandpa all winter.*

**SIMILAR** annoy, irritate, bother, frustrate
**OPPOSITE** please, soothe, delight



## wrath **RATH** *noun*




**MEANING** fierce anger

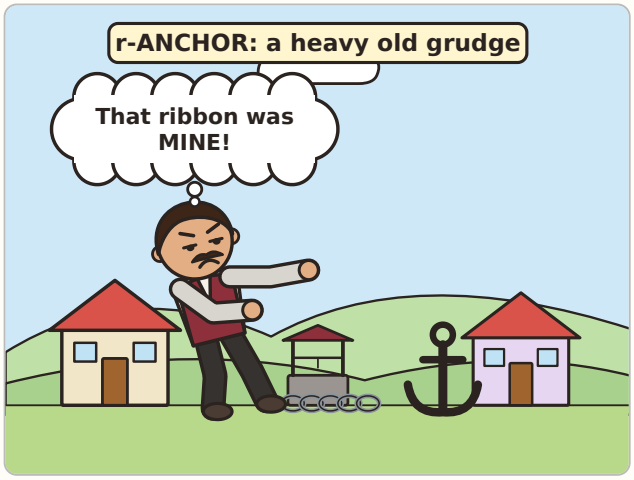
**MEMORY HOOK** **WRATH rhymes with BATH.** Try to give the cat a bath and you will see true **wrath**: hissing, splashing, fur-on-end fury.

*The cat's* **wrath** *was terrible when it was lifted into the bathtub.*

**SIMILAR** rage, fury, anger, ire
**OPPOSITE** calm, forgiveness, delight



## rancor **RANG**-ker *noun*



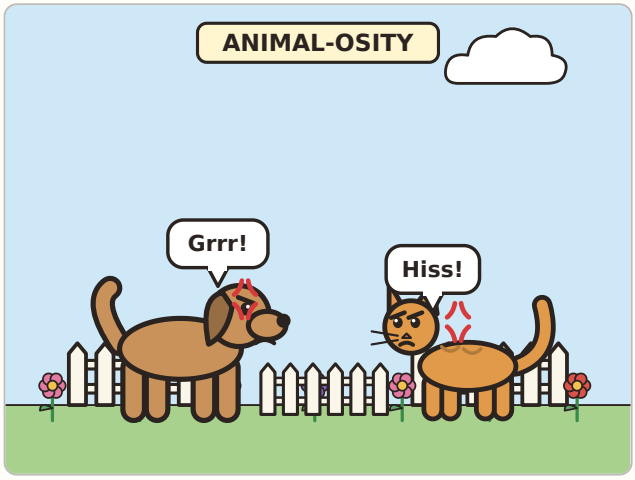

**MEANING** bitter resentment that lasts a long time

**MEMORY HOOK** **r-ANCHOR: a grudge you drag for years.** Thirty years after losing the pie contest, Victor still drags his grudge around like a heavy anchor. Bitter resentment that lasts that long is **rancor**.

*Years after the contest, he still spoke of the judges with* **rancor**, *a bitterness that never faded.*

**SIMILAR** bitterness, resentment, ill will, spite
**OPPOSITE** goodwill, friendliness, forgiveness

## animosity an-uh-**MOS**-ih-tee *noun*




**MEANING** strong dislike or hostility

**MEMORY HOOK** **ANIMAL-OSITY: cat versus dog.** The cat and the dog next door hiss and growl at each other across the fence every single day. Their **animosity** is plain to see.

*There was no* **animosity** *between the rivals; they shook hands after every match.*

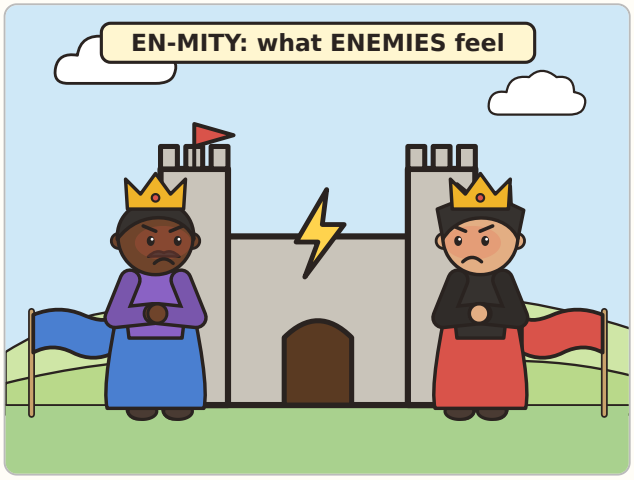
**PARTS** **anim** spirit, mind + **-osity** the quality of being full of

**SIMILAR** hostility, ill will, antagonism, dislike

**OPPOSITE** friendship, goodwill, affection



## enmity **EN**-mih-tee *noun*




**MEANING** deep, lasting hatred between enemies

**MEMORY HOOK** **EN-MITY: what ENEMIES feel.** The kings of the two castles have been enemies for a hundred years, and neither will even nod to the other. Their **enmity** never fades.

*The* **enmity** *between the two families lasted three generations.*

**PARTS** **-ity** the state or quality of

**SIMILAR** hatred, hostility, ill will, feud

**OPPOSITE** friendship, amity, goodwill